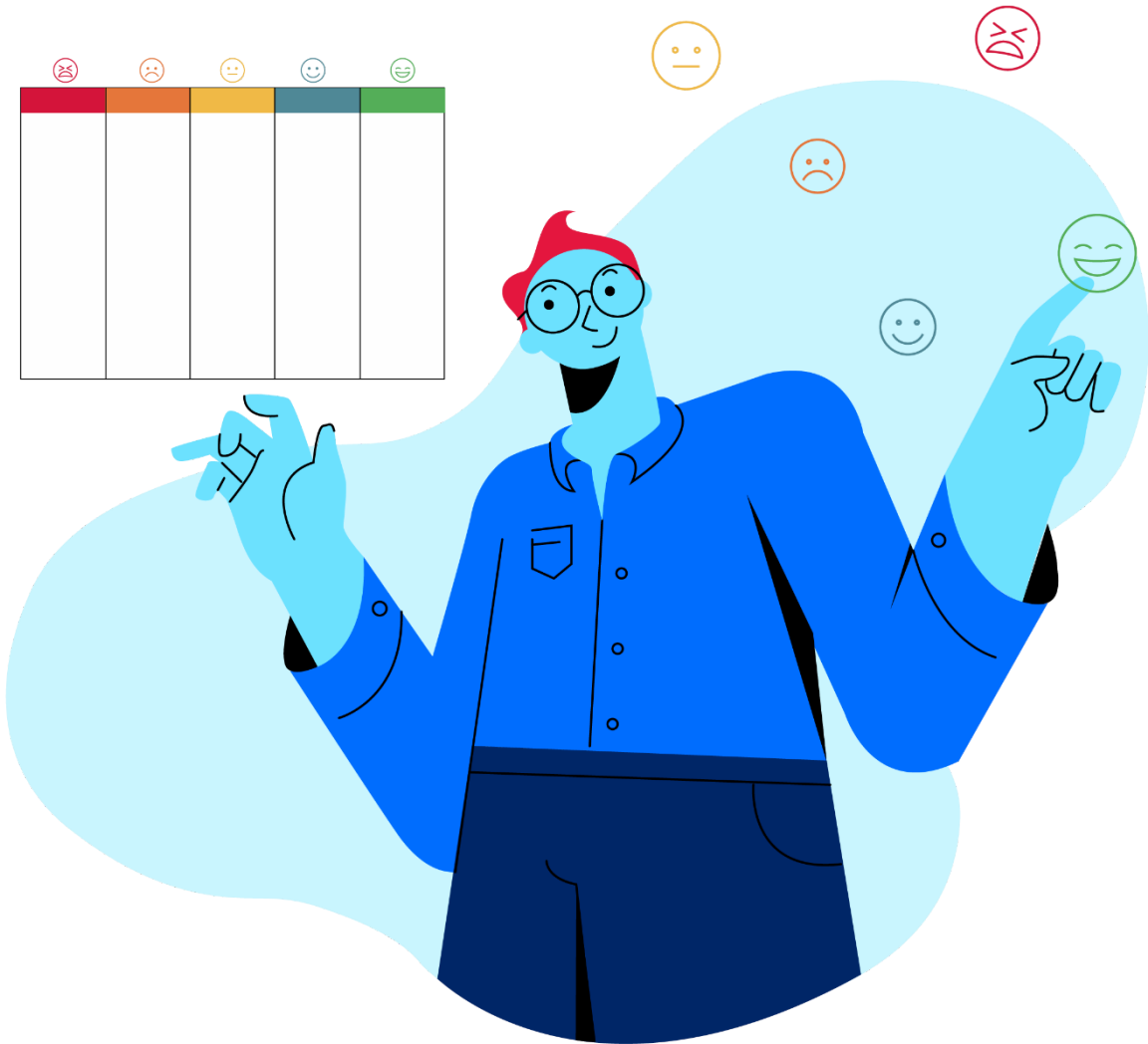


Sludge scales



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What are the sludge scales?

The sludge scales are criteria you can use to assess the customer experience and quantify the impact of sludge.

For every behaviour in your process, the scales provide a score that will tell you how difficult it is for customers to complete. Each scale has a score of 'easy' (the best score) to 'very difficult' (the worst score). This score will help you identify the parts of your process that are most difficult for customers to complete and where there are opportunities to improve the customer experience.

The sludge scales are based on the [NSW Government Customer Commitments](#), the [NSW Government Customer Experience Survey](#), evidence from behavioural insights research and practice, as well as customer experience design principles.

Example of a sludge scale – Read text message / Content and next steps

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Relevant Does the text message contain clear and relevant content?	It does not - Most content is irrelevant and is not structured clearly. - The text message is very hard to understand (e.g. long sentences/words, jargon, passive voice, no personalisation). - Flesch reading ease score: < 50.	It is not very clear nor relevant - Most content is irrelevant or not structured clearly. - The text message uses some plain English, with active voice, personalisation and/or short sentences. However, it is hard to understand. - Flesch reading ease score: 50-60.	It is mostly clear and relevant - Most content is relevant and structured clearly. - The text message is mostly written in plain English, with active voice, personalisation and short sentences. However, some parts are hard to understand. - Flesch reading ease score: 60-70.	It is clear and relevant - All content is relevant and structured clearly. - The text message is written in plain English, with active voice, personalisation and short sentences. However, some customers may find it hard to understand. - Flesch reading ease score: 70-80.	It is very clear and relevant - All content is relevant and structured clearly. - The text message is written in plain English, with active voice, personalisation, short sentences and no technical jargon. - Flesch reading ease score: 80+ (70+ if topic is technical).
Next steps Does the text message clearly outline the next steps?	It does not - The text message does not include a list nor explanation of the next steps. - The text message does not include any links to the next step or further information.	It does, but it is unclear - The text message includes a brief explanation of the next steps, but it is unclear. - The text message does not include any links to the next step or further information.	It does - The text message includes a brief explanation of the next steps, but it may be unclear. - The text message includes a link to a website where the customer can find the next step and/or further information, but it takes 2+ clicks.	It does clearly - The text message includes a list of the next steps. - The text message includes a link to a website where the customer can easily find the next step and/or further information in 1-2 clicks.	It does very clearly - The text message includes a clear list of the next steps. - The text message includes a link that takes the customer directly to the next step and/or further information (where applicable).

How can I use the sludge scales?

You can use the sludge scales for two purposes: assessing existing processes and setting a standard for 'what good looks like' when designing new processes.

Assessing existing processes

The sludge scales have been built into the NSW Government [Sludge Finder](#) tool. If you are planning on doing a sludge audit, we recommend that you use Sludge Finder to assess your process. Sludge Finder will automatically link your behaviours to the relevant scales and criteria.

To use the sludge scales, move through the behaviours in your behavioural journey map and assess them against the relevant sludge scales. You see what constitutes a score of 'easy', a score of 'very difficult' and all the scores in between. Using the data you have gathered, particularly from cognitive walkthroughs and customer interviews, give a score to each consideration in the criteria, or each criterion overall.

If you want to quickly assess a specific part of a process (e.g. a form) you can find the relevant scales in this document and use them to assess the effort required to complete it.

Setting standards for new processes

You can use the descriptors in the 'easy' column of the sludge scales to get an idea of 'what good looks like' when you are designing new processes.

For example, if you are designing a new form, you might look at the criteria for 'complete form' and use the descriptors in the 'easy' column as a checklist for what you want to include in your form. You can also use them as a rubric to assess your progress. If you have covered off on all the criteria, then you know you have made a good start at creating a sludge-free customer experience.

Navigating the sludge scales

The sludge scales are organised around broad categories (e.g. reading and understanding, seeking and navigating, preparing and providing information), then into behaviour types (e.g. read website, read email) and finally into criteria – so ‘read website’ includes criteria for design, language, and content.

Category	Behaviour type	Criteria
Reading and understanding	Read website	Design
Seeking and navigating	Read email	Language
Preparing and providing information	Read text message	Content
Interacting	Read letter	
Help seeking	Read confirmation (text/email)	
Waiting	Read notification	
Deciding	Read signage	
Miscellaneous	Read factsheet/brochure	
Non-customer actions	Check eligibility	
	Use website FAQs	

To make it easy for you to find the scale you need, we have indexed the sludge scales in two ways – by behaviour category (e.g. reading and understanding) and by channel (e.g. forms). You can find these indexes on page 6 and 7.

How to respond to the sludge scales

The sludge scales can help you identify where there are opportunities to improve the customer experience.

For example, you might review a form against the relevant scales and find that the instructions for how to complete the form are unclear. The scales will tell you what the problem is and give you an idea of what to aim for, but it helps to know what techniques to use to get there.

This is where the sludge guides come in. There are six sludge guides, each covering different channels that government uses to interact with customers. These are:

- Letters and emails
- Websites
- Forms
- Phone and face-to-face
- Text messages
- Apps

The guides are full of evidence-based tips and techniques for removing sludge, examples and case studies showing how you can use them, and tips and insights for making your processes as sludge free as possible.

You can find our sludge guides on the [Sludge Toolkit](#) website.

Help us refine the sludge scales

We want to hear from you!

The NSW Behavioural Insights Unit built these sludge scales based on available evidence. We are continuously looking to improve and refine the scales based on new evidence and benchmarked practice.

If you identify an inconsistency in a scale, are aware of additional evidence about a scale, or believe there are scales missing, please email us at sludge@customerservice.nsw.gov.au.

We also welcome further research, testing or validation of the scales. Please let us know if you would like to work with us more closely to do this, or if you have findings you can share to help us improve and refine the sludge scales.



Find your scale by **behaviour category**



Reading and understanding

[Read website](#)

[Read email](#)

[Read letter](#)

[Read text message](#)

[Read confirmation \(text/email\)](#)

[Read notification](#)

[Read signage](#)

[Read factsheet/brochure](#)

[Check eligibility](#)

[Use website FAQs](#)



Seeking and navigating

[Search for a website](#)

[Navigate website](#)

[Use phone app](#)



Preparing or providing information

[Complete form](#)

[Gather documents](#)

[Provide documents](#)

[Apply for rebate](#)

[Provide consent](#)

[Login or enter password](#)



Interacting

[Face-to-face interaction](#)

[Receive phone call from Government](#)

[Negotiation process](#)

[Physical access](#)

[Paying for something](#)

[Submit complaint](#)



Help seeking

[Accessing support \(via email\)](#)

[Accessing support \(via phone\)](#)



Waiting

[Wait \(active\)](#)

[Wait \(idle\)](#)



Deciding

[Make a decision](#)



Miscellaneous

[Miscellaneous step](#)



Non-customer actions

[Government action](#)

[Third-party action or decision](#)

Find your scale **by channel**



Apps

[Use phone app](#)
[Read notification](#)



Forms

[Check eligibility](#)
[Complete form](#)
[Gather documents](#)
[Provide documents](#)
[Apply for rebate](#)
[Provide consent](#)
[Submit complaint](#)



Letters and emails

[Read email](#)
[Read letter](#)
[Read confirmation \(text/email\)](#)
[Provide documents](#)
[Accessing support \(via email\)](#)



Phone and face-to-face

[Face-to-face interaction](#)
[Receive phone call from Government](#)
[Wait \(active\)](#)
[Accessing support \(via phone\)](#)
[Paying for something](#)



Websites

[Read website](#)
[Check eligibility](#)
[Use website FAQs](#)
[Search for a website](#)
[Navigate website](#)
[Login or enter password](#)
[Paying for something](#)



Text messages

[Read text message](#)
[Read confirmation \(text/email\)](#)



Other

[Read signage](#)
[Read factsheet/brochure](#)
[Check eligibility](#)
[Gather documents](#)
[Negotiation process](#)
[Physical access](#)
[Paying for something](#)
[Wait \(idle\)](#)
[Make a decision](#)
[Miscellaneous step](#)
[Government action](#)
[Third-party action or decision](#)

1 Reading and understanding



In this section

[1.1 Read website](#)

[1.2 Read email](#)

[1.3 Read letter](#)

[1.4 Read text message](#)

[1.5 Read confirmation \(text/email\)](#)

[1.6 Read notification](#)

[1.7 Read signage](#)

[1.8 Read factsheet/brochure](#)

[1.9 Check eligibility](#)

[1.10 Use website FAQs](#)

Categories



1 Reading and understanding



2 Seeking and navigating



3 Preparing or providing information



4 Interacting



5 Help seeking



6 Waiting



7 Deciding



8 Miscellaneous



9 Non-customer actions

1.1 Read website

Viewing or reading information on a website

- Reading information about an application process (e.g. eligibility, timeframes)
- Reading information about a service, benefit, or compliance requirements

1.1.1 Design

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Chunking Is the webpage chunked into short digestible paragraphs?	It is not chunked at all • The webpage has bulk text and/or long paragraphs with multiple topics (5+ sentences). • No bullet points nor numbered lists are used.	It is somewhat chunked • The webpage is broken up into chunks, however, the paragraphs are long with multiple topics (4+ sentences). • Bullet points and/or numbered lists are used to list some key information. However, the lists are too long (7+ items), dense and/or inconsistent.	It is mostly chunked • The webpage is broken up into readable chunks. Some paragraphs are long or have multiple topics. • Bullet points and/or numbered lists are used appropriately to list key information. However, some lists are too long (7+ items), dense or inconsistent.	It is chunked • The webpage is clearly broken up into readable chunks. Most paragraphs are 1-2 sentences with one topic. • Bullet points and/or numbered lists are used appropriately to list and highlight key information.	It is chunked very effectively • The webpage is clearly broken up into readable and logical chunks. All paragraphs are 1-2 sentences with one topic. • Bullet points and/or numbered lists are used effectively to list and highlight key information.
Headings Are there clear headings to help the customer navigate and understand the website?	There are no headings • No headings are used to break up information.	There are headings, but they are very unclear • Headings are used but they are not descriptive and/or they are too short to describe what is in the paragraph (e.g. "Introduction").	There are headings, but they are unclear • Headings are used, but they are hard to understand or do not succinctly describe the information in the paragraph.	There are clear headings • The headings are short, clear and descriptive, but customers may be unsure about whether the information in the paragraph is relevant to them.	There are very clear headings • The headings are short, clear and descriptive. Where relevant, the headings use a question-and-answer format.
White space Is there empty space around the content and elements to make the webpage easier to read?	It is very difficult to read • There is limited white space on the webpage, making it difficult to read or identify key information. • There are elements on the webpage that distract customers or are used ineffectively. For example, a floating menu bar or header/footer that gets in the way of content.	It is difficult to read • There is limited white space on the webpage, making it difficult to read or identify key information. • There may be some elements on the webpage that distract customers or are used ineffectively.	It is sometimes difficult to read • There is some white space around and between text to make it readable. But there is clutter, due to the proximity of other elements like images, boxes and tables. • The white space is not consistent and does not balance elements across the page.	It is easy to read • There is white space around and between paragraphs to make the text easy to read. However, there is some clutter caused by other elements (e.g. images, graphics, boxes, tables). • The white space is not clearly and consistently balanced across the page.	It is very easy to read • There is white space around and between paragraphs to make the text easy to read. • White space is used around images, graphics and boxes/tables to clearly organise and highlight key information. • White space is used consistently to balance

			Some related elements (e.g. an image and its caption) are far apart.	Related elements (e.g. an image and its caption) are close together.	- elements across the page. - Related elements and text are visually grouped together.
Icons/images Do icons/images help customers find and understand key information?	They are not used There are no icons/images on the webpage, making it unengaging and difficult for customers to quickly find and understand key information.	They are rarely used There are little to no icons/images on the webpage, making it difficult for customers to quickly find and understand key information. Icons/images may unclear (e.g. because they are too big, too small, poor quality, or not clearly related to the information).	They are sometimes used Icons/images are used to help customers find and understand some key information. However, some icons/images may unclear (e.g. because they are too big, too small, poor quality, or not clearly related to the information).	They are used Clear and engaging icons/images are used to help customers find and understand most key information.	They are used very effectively Clear and engaging icons/images are used to help customers find and understand key information quickly (e.g. relevant icons paired with text or statistics, a process visualised as a step-by-step infographic).
Text format Are colouring/bolding used sparingly and consistently to highlight key information?	They are not used No use of colouring nor bolding, making it hard for customers to quickly identify and understand key information.	They are rarely used Colouring and bolding of words is inconsistent or does not highlight key information.	They are sometimes used Colouring and bolding of words helps customers identify some key information, but it is used inconsistently.	They are used Colouring and bolding of words helps customers identify and understand all key information.	They are used very effectively Colouring and bolding of words helps customers quickly identify and understand key information.
Format Is the website compatible with different screen sizes and devices?	It is not Only available in desktop format.	It is, but not always functional Available in all formats but not all parts functional.	It is, but not optimised Available in all formats and functional.	It is mostly optimised Available in all formats and mostly optimised, however, some elements may not be fully responsive.	It is highly optimised Responsive design: available in all formats and all elements have been optimised.

1.1.2 Language

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Readability Is the website easy to read?	It is very difficult to read - Most of the webpage is written with long and complex sentences, with a lot of unnecessary information. - Flesch reading ease score: < 50.	It is difficult to read - Some of the webpage is written with long and complex sentences, with a lot of unnecessary information. - Flesch reading ease score: 50-54.	It is somewhat easy to read - Most of the webpage is written with short sentences, however, there is some unnecessary information. - Flesch reading ease score: 55-60.	It is easy to read - The whole webpage is written with short sentences, with limited unnecessary information. - Flesch reading ease score: 61-70.	It is very easy to read - The whole webpage is written with clear and concise sentences, with limited to no unnecessary information. - Flesch reading ease score: 70+.
Simplicity Is the website written in plain	It is not Most of the webpage is	It mostly is not Some of the webpage is	It mostly is Most of the webpage is	Almost all of it is Almost all the webpage is	It is The whole webpage is

English?	written with very complex and inconsistent language. Most parts of the webpage are difficult to understand (e.g. due to unexplained jargon, inconsistent terminology).	written with very complex and inconsistent language. Many parts of the webpage are difficult to understand (e.g. due to unexplained jargon, inconsistent terminology).	written in plain English, however, some parts of the webpage are difficult to understand (e.g. due to unexplained jargon, inconsistent terminology).	written in plain English. All technical terms are explained, but some explanations may be hard to understand.	written in plain English, with all technical terms explained clearly and consistently.
Personalisation Does the website use first/second pronouns and other personalisation?	It does not Limited to no personalisation is used on the website.	It rarely does The webpage makes limited use of personal pronouns, but they do not direct customers to the call to action.	It sometimes does The webpage uses personal pronouns, but they do not direct customers to the call to action.	It does The webpage uses personal pronouns to effectively direct customers to the call to action (e.g. "Complete your application"). Pronouns are used in headings.	It does very effectively The webpage uses personal pronouns to quickly engage and direct customers to the call to action. Pronouns are used in headings (e.g. "What do I need to bring to my appointment?").
Tone Is the webpage written in the active voice*? *In a sentence written in the active voice, the subject of sentence performs the action. In a sentence written in the passive voice, the subject receives the action.	Almost all of it is not Most sentences are written in the passive voice (e.g. "Your application will be reviewed by the Department")	The majority is not Most sentences are written in the passive voice. Some active sentences provide limited clarity.	Some of it is not Some of the sentences are written in the passive voice. The active sentences help customers to understand key information.	The majority is Most sentences are written in the active voice. However, some passive sentences are used inappropriately.	Almost all of it is Most sentences are written in the active voice (e.g. "The Department will review your application"). The passive sentences are used sparingly and where appropriate.

1.1.3 Content

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Purpose Is the purpose of the webpage clearly visible and understandable?	It is not The webpage does not include a clear purpose. It is not clear what the customers are supposed to do with the information on the page.	It is, but is very unclear The webpage includes a purpose, but it is not clearly visible or easy to understand. It is not clear what the customers are supposed to do with the information on the page.	It is, but is unclear - The first paragraph on the page indicates the purpose of the page, but it is not clear what the customers are supposed to do with the information on the page. - The webpage includes some relevant keywords, making it easier for customers to find the information they are looking for.	It is clear - The first paragraph on the page clearly explains the purpose of the page and how the page can be used. - The webpage includes relevant keywords, making it easier for customers to find the information they are looking for.	It is very clear - The webpage has a clear call to action at the top of the page. The first paragraph clearly explains the purpose of the page and how the page can be used. - The webpage consistently includes relevant keywords, making it easier for customers to find the information they are looking for.
Sufficient information Is there enough information on the webpage for the customer to	There is not There is not enough information to help	There mostly is, but it is difficult to find Most information to help	The majority is Almost all information to help customers make a decision	There is All information to help customers make a decision	There very clearly is All the information to help customers make a decision

make an informed decision and/or know what to do next?	customers make a decision or understand the next steps. Information is scattered across multiple pages and is very hard to find.	customers make a decision or understand the next steps is on the website. However, the information is scattered across multiple pages and is hard to find.	or understand the next steps is on the website. However, customers must navigate to one or two other pages to find all the information.	or understand the next steps is on one webpage. Little to no website navigation is required to find all the information.	or understand the next steps is on one webpage. No website navigation is required to find all the information, or the navigation is very simple and intuitive.
Links Does the website have hyperlinks/navigation buttons to help customers find related information and go to the next step(s)?	It does not There are no hyperlinks nor navigation buttons to help customers navigate to related information or go to the next steps.	It mostly does not There are almost no hyperlinks nor navigation buttons to help customers find related information or go to the next steps.	It does, but they are unclear There are some hyperlinks and navigation buttons to help customers find related information and go to the next steps.	It does, and they are clear - Hyperlinks and navigation buttons make it easy for customers to find related information and go to the next steps. - When customers hover over a technical term with their cursor, a definition is provided.	It does, and they are very clear - Hyperlinks and navigation buttons make it easy for customers to seamlessly find related information (e.g. external websites, definitions) and go to the next steps. - When customers hover over a technical term with their cursor, a clear definition is provided.
Consistency Is information consistent across different websites/webpages?	It is very inconsistent There are inconsistencies and redundant information across many related websites/webpages.	It is inconsistent There are inconsistencies across related websites/webpages, impacting customers' understanding of information and next steps.	It is mostly consistent Information is consistent across related websites/webpages. However, there is some redundant or duplicate information that could confuse customers.	It is almost all consistent Information is consistent across related websites/webpages. However, there is some redundant information.	It is very consistent All information is consistent across related websites/webpages. All related websites/webpages have a clear purpose, reducing unnecessary duplication.
Accuracy Is the information accurate and up to date?	It is very inaccurate - Most or all content is inaccurate and/or outdated. - The website is rarely (if ever) updated and there is no process in place to update it.	It is inaccurate - Some content is inaccurate and/or outdated. - The website is updated on an ad hoc basis.	It is mostly accurate - Most content is accurate and up to date. - The website is updated on an ad hoc basis.	It is accurate - All content is accurate and up to date. - There is a process in place to update the website occasionally.	It is very accurate - All content is accurate and up to date. - There is a process in place to update the website regularly.

1.2 Read email

Reading an email sent from government

- To request further information as part of an application process
- To tell the customer about the outcome of an application or the next steps in a process
- To inform customers about a government service

- To remind customers to complete an action

1.2.1 Introduction and call to action

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Personalisation Where possible, is the customer addressed by name?	It is incorrectly personalised • The email is personalised to a cohort that many customers are not a part of (e.g. customers who are renting are addressed as homeowners).	It is not personalised • The email is not personalised to the customer.	It is somewhat personalised • The email is personalised to a cohort that the customer is a part of (e.g. homeowners, parents).	It is personalised • The email addresses the customer by name, but it is not immediately visible when the customer opens the email.	It is clearly personalised • The email addresses the customer by name, and it is immediately visible when the customer opens the email.
Subject line and source Is the subject clear and sender recognisable?	It is very unclear • The subject line is long (6+ words) and very unclear. • The email does not appear to be from a recognisable sender and is almost always automatically classified as spam. The email appears suspicious.	It is unclear • The subject line is either long (6+ words) or very unclear. • Some customers may recognise the sender, but the email is often automatically classified as spam. The email may appear suspicious.	It can be unclear • The subject line is either long (6+ words) or unclear. • The email is from a recognisable sender, but it is sometimes automatically classified as spam.	It is mostly clear • The subject line is short (3-6 words), but it may be unclear to some customers. • The email is from a recognisable sender and is unlikely to be automatically classified as spam.	It is very clear • The subject line is short (3-4 words) and is clear to all customers. • The email is from a very recognisable sender and is very unlikely to be automatically classified as spam.
Purpose Is the purpose of the email clearly visible and easy to understand?	It is very unclear • No purpose for the email is provided, nor is it clear what the customers are supposed to do with the information in the email.	It is unclear • The email includes a purpose, but it is not clearly visible or understandable. Nor is it clear what the customers are supposed to do with the information in the email.	It can be unclear • The first paragraph indicates the purpose of the email, but it isn't clear what the customer is supposed to do with the information in the email.	It is clear • The first paragraph clearly explains the purpose of the email and identifies how the information can be used.	It is very clear • The email has a clear purpose at the top of the email. The first paragraph clearly explains the purpose of the email and how the information can be used.
Call to action If the email asks the customer to take a specific action, is there a clear call to action?	There is no call to action • Either no call to action is provided, or it is likely to backfire.	It is unclear • The call to action is unclear and difficult to find (e.g. in the body of the email).	It is clear, but may be difficult to find • The call to action is clear, but difficult to find. Or it is prominent in the email, but difficult to understand.	It is clear • The call to action is clear and prominent in the email. However, some customers may find it difficult to understand.	It is very clear • The call to action is very clear and prominent in the email.

1.2.2 Design

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
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Chunking Is the email chunked into short digestible paragraphs?	It is not chunked at all - The email has bulk text and/or long paragraphs with multiple topics (5+ sentences). - No bullet points nor numbered lists are used	It is somewhat chunked - The email is broken up into chunks, however, the paragraphs are long with multiple topics (4+ sentences). - Bullet points and/or numbered lists are used to list some key information. However, the lists are too long (7+ items), dense and/or inconsistent.	It is mostly chunked - The email is broken up into readable chunks. Some paragraphs are long or have multiple topics. - Bullet points and/or numbered lists are used appropriately to list key information. However, some lists are too long (7+ items), dense or inconsistent.	It is chunked - The email is clearly broken up into readable chunks. Most paragraphs are 1-2 sentences with one topic. - Bullet points and/or numbered lists are used appropriately to list and highlight key information	It is chunked very effectively - The email is clearly broken up into readable and logical chunks. All paragraphs are 1-2 sentences with one topic. - Bullet points and/or numbered lists are used effectively to list and highlight key information
Headings Are there clear subheadings to help the customer navigate and understand the email?	There are no subheadings No subheadings are used to break up information.	There are subheadings, but they are very unclear Subheadings are used but they are not descriptive and/or they are too short to describe what is in the paragraph (e.g. "Introduction").	There are subheadings, but they are unclear Subheadings are used, but they are hard to understand or do not succinctly describe the information in the paragraph.	There are clear subheadings The subheadings are short, clear and descriptive, but may not be relevant to the specific customer.	There are very clear subheadings The subheadings are short, clear and relevant to the specific customer. They are descriptive and/or use a question-and-answer format.
White space Is there empty space around the content and elements to make the email easier to read?	It is very difficult to read - There is limited white space in the email, making it very difficult to read or identify key information. - There are elements in the email that distract customers or are used ineffectively. For example, too many images/graphics, causing clutter and making it hard to read the text.	It is difficult to read - There is limited white space in the email, making it difficult to read or identify key information. - There may be some elements in the email that distract customers or are used ineffectively.	It is sometimes difficult to read - There is some white space around and between text to make it readable. But there is clutter, due to the proximity of other elements like images, boxes and tables. - The white space is not consistent and does not balance elements across the email. - Some related elements (e.g. an image and its caption) are far apart.	It is easy to read - There is white space around and between paragraphs to make the email easy to read. However, there is some clutter caused by other elements (images, graphics, boxes, tables). - The white space is not clearly and consistently balanced across the email. - Related elements (e.g. an image and its caption) are close together.	It is very easy to read - There is white space around and between paragraphs to make the email easy to read. White space is used around images, graphics and boxes/tables to clearly organise and highlight key information. - There is consistent use of white space to balance elements across the email (e.g. between paragraphs). - Related elements and text are visually grouped together.
Icons/images Are icons/images used to help customers identify and understand key information?	They are not used There are no icons/images in the email, making it unengaging and difficult for customers to quickly identify and understand key information.	They are rarely used There are little to no icons/images in the email, making it difficult for customers to quickly identify and understand key information. Icons/images may unclear (e.g. because	They are sometimes used Icons/images are used to help customers identify and understand some key information. However, some icons/images may unclear (e.g. because they are too big, too small, poor quality,	They are used Clear and engaging icons/images are used to help customers identify and understand most key information.	They are used very effectively Clear and engaging icons/images are used to help customers identify and understand key information quickly (e.g. relevant icons paired with text or statistics, a process visualised as a

		they are too big, too small, poor quality, or not clearly related to the information).	or not clearly related to the information).		step-by-step infographic).
Colouring/bolding Are colouring/bolding used sparingly and consistently to highlight key information?	They are not used There is no use of colouring nor bolding, making it hard for customers to identify key information.	They are rarely used Colouring and bolding of words is inconsistent or does not highlight key information.	They are sometimes used Colouring and bolding of words highlights most key information, but is used inconsistently.	They are used Colouring and bolding of words makes it easy for customers to identify and understand all key information.	They are used very effectively Colouring and bolding of words makes it easy for customers to quickly identify and understand key information accurately.
Format Does the formatting/html of the email appear correctly?	It appears with major issues - Major formatting issues with confusing text, images or shapes. - The email looks very unprofessional.	It appears with minor issues - Some formatting issues on most browsers, email clients and devices. - The email looks unprofessional.	It mostly appears correctly Some formatting issues identified for some browsers, email clients or devices, but not all.	It appears correctly Formatting displays correctly on all common browsers, email clients and devices.	It appears correctly and effectively - Formatting displays correctly on all common browsers, email clients and devices. - The email looks visually engaging and professional.

1.2.3 Language

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Readability Is the email easy to read?	It is very difficult to read - Most of the email is written with long and complex sentences, with a lot of unnecessary information. - Flesch reading ease score: < 50.	It is difficult to read - Some of the email is written with long and complex sentences, with a lot of unnecessary information. - Flesch reading ease score: 50-54.	It is sometimes difficult to read - Most of the email is written with short sentences, however, there is some unnecessary information. - Flesch reading ease score: 55-60.	It is easy to read - The whole email is written with short sentences, with limited unnecessary information. - Flesch reading ease score: 61-70.	It is very easy to read - The whole email is written with clear and concise sentences, with limited to no unnecessary information. - Flesch reading ease score: 70+.
Simplicity Is the email written in plain English?	It is not Most of the email is written with very complex and inconsistent language. Most parts of the email are difficult to understand (e.g. due to unexplained jargon, inconsistent terminology).	It mostly is not Some of the email is written with very complex and inconsistent language. Many parts of the email are difficult to understand (e.g. due to unexplained jargon, inconsistent terminology).	It mostly is Most of the email is written in plain English, however, some parts of the email are difficult to understand (e.g. due to unexplained jargon, inconsistent terminology).	Almost all of it is Almost all the email is written in plain English. All technical terms are explained, but some explanations may be hard to understand.	It is The whole email is written in plain English, with all technical terms explained clearly and consistently.
Personalisation Does the email use first/second pronouns and other personalisation?	It does not Limited to no personalisation used in the email.	It rarely does The email makes limited use of personal pronouns, but they do not direct customers to act.	It sometimes does The email uses some personal pronouns.	It does The email uses personal pronouns to effectively engage and direct customers to act. Pronouns are used in	It does very effectively The email uses personal pronouns to quickly engage and direct customers to act. Pronouns are used in

				headings.	headings (e.g. "What are my next steps?"). The email uses personal information to engage the customer (e.g. relevant personal details or a photo of an offence the email is referencing).
Tone Is the email written in the active voice*? *In a sentence written in the active voice, the subject of sentence performs the action. In a sentence written in the passive voice, the subject receives the action.	Almost all of it is not Most sentences are written in the passive voice (e.g. "Your application will be reviewed by the Department").	The majority is not Most sentences are written in the passive voice. Some active sentences provide limited clarity.	Some of it is not Some of the sentences are written in the passive voice. The active sentences help customers to understand key information.	The majority is Most sentences are written in the active voice. However, some passive sentences are used inappropriately.	Almost all of it is Most sentences are written in the active voice (e.g. "The Department will review your application"). The passive sentences are used sparingly and where appropriate.

1.2.4 Next steps

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Instructions Does the email clearly explain what the customer should do?	It does not, or they are very hard to find There either are no instructions in the email, or they are very hard to find because they are hidden in a block of text. The instructions do not provide clear timings and most include more than one action.	It does, but they are unclear Where required, the email includes listed instructions. However, they are either unclear, hard to find or not presented in a logical order. The instructions do not provide clear timings and some include more than one action.	It does, but they are sometimes unclear Where required, the email includes step-by-step instructions on what the customer has to do. However, some instructions are unclear (e.g. no clear verb) and/or include more than one action. Some instructions do not provide clear timings (e.g. "10 business days from today").	It does, and they are clear - Where required, the email includes step-by-step instructions on what the customer has to do and by when. Each instruction includes only one action and uses a verb at the start of the sentence to explain what the customer has to do (e.g. "Go to the website..."). - There is no diagram, but there are other visuals (e.g. icons) to help customers understand the instructions.	It does, and they are very clear - Where required, the email includes clear step-by-step instructions on what customer has to do and by when. Each instruction includes only one action and uses a verb at the start of the sentence to explain what the customer has to do (e.g. "Go to the website..."). - There is a diagram that includes relevant icons for each action, and a clear logical flow.
Links Are hyperlinks/buttons available to take the customer directly to the next step(s)?	They are not available, or broken Where an online form and/or website is required for the next step, there are either no hyperlinks/buttons, or there are broken hyperlinks/buttons that do not work properly. The email	They are available, but very indirect - Hyperlinks/buttons take the customer to the correct website, but it is difficult to find or access the next step. - Assistance or access to support is very unclear.	They are available, but indirect - Hyperlinks/buttons take the customer to the correct website, but the customer has to search briefly for the next step. - Assistance and access to support is offered.	They are available and mostly direct - Hyperlinks/buttons take the customer to the website where the next step is clearly visible. - Assistance and access to support is clearly signposted.	They are available and direct - Hyperlinks/buttons take the customer directly to the website and/or form to complete the next step (no additional clicks required). - Assistance and access to support is very clearly

	instructs the customer to go online and search themselves. No assistance or access to support is offered.				signposted in an appropriate location.
Prompts Are planning prompts used to help the customer take action?	They are not used - The email does not prompt the customer to plan. The email does not say how many days the customer has to complete the action(s). - The email does not tell the customer what steps they have left in the process.	They are not used, but some information is provided - The email does not prompt the customer to plan. The email says how many days the customer has to complete the action(s). - The email tells the customer what steps they have left in the process.	They are used - The email prompts the customer to plan what they have to do. The email says how many days the customer has to complete the action(s). - The email tells the customer what steps they have left in the process.	They are used clearly - The email prompts the customer to plan what they have to do and by when. The email sets a deadline to complete the action(s). - The email shows the customer where they are in the process and what steps they have left.	They are used clearly and very effectively - The email prompts the customer to plan and write down or diarise what they have to do and by when. The email sets a clear deadline to complete the action(s). - The email clearly highlights how far the customer has come in a process and/or how close they are to completing it (e.g. create a checklist and tick off actions the customer has already completed).
Trusted messenger Is the email sent from a trusted messenger?	It is not, and there may be negative impacts The email is signed off by, or uses a quote from, a messenger that is likely to have a negative impact on the customer (e.g. by making them feel anxious or think that they are in trouble when they are not).	It is not, and is ineffective The email is signed off by, or uses a quote from, a messenger that customers are unlikely to recognise and/or is ineffective (e.g. because the messenger may not seem relevant to the process).	It is, but may be ineffective The email is signed off by, or uses a quote from, a messenger that is recognisable, but may be ineffective (e.g. because the messenger may not seem relevant to the process).	It is, and is effective The email is signed off by, or uses a quote from, a trusted and easily recognisable messenger.	It is, and is very effective The email is signed off by, or uses a quote from, a very trusted and easily recognisable messenger (this can include government staff with their credentials).
Choice Does the email help the customer make an informed choice?	It does not The email does not list/explain the different options. No defaults are prescribed, or the default would negatively impact the customer.	It mostly does not The email lists the different options. No defaults are prescribed, or the default is not in the best interests of the customer.	It does, but lacks information The email explains what the different options are. Where appropriate, the email prescribes a default choice, however, the option to make another choice is not explained.	It does The email explains the outcomes of different options. Where appropriate, the email prescribes a default choice that is in the customer's best interests. The option to choose another option is explained.	It does very effectively The email clearly explains the outcomes of different options, including highlighting the benefits of a preferred option. Where appropriate, the email prescribes a default choice that is in the customer's best interests. The email clearly explains the consequences of the default option and offers flexibility to choose other options.

Empathy Are unfavourable or unexpected outcomes communicated clearly and empathetically?	They are communicated coldly and without an offer of support - The outcome is unclear and/or misleading, and is delivered without explanation nor empathy. - Customers are not offered support.	They are communicated without clear explanation nor empathy - Unfavourable outcomes are communicated without clear explanation nor empathy. - Customers receive an offer of support, but it is unclear and/or hard to access.	They are communicated clearly, but without empathy - Unfavourable outcomes are explained clearly, but without empathy. - Customers receive an offer of support, but it may unclear and/or hard to access.	They are communicated clearly and somewhat empathetically - Unfavourable outcomes are explained clearly with some limited empathy. - Customers receive a clear offer of support.	They are communicated clearly and empathetically - Unfavourable outcomes (e.g. rejections) are explained clearly and empathetically. - Customers are given clear and accessible options to connect with support for their wellbeing.
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1.3 Read letter

Reading a letter sent from government

- To request further information as part of an application process
- To tell the customer about the outcome of an application or the next steps in a process
- To inform customers about a government service
- To remind customers to complete an action

1.3.1 Introduction and call to action

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Personalisation Where possible, is the customer addressed by name?	It is incorrectly personalised The letter is personalised to a cohort that many customers are not a part of (e.g. customers who are renting are addressed as homeowners).	It is not personalised The letter is not personalised to the customer.	It is somewhat personalised The letter is personalised to a cohort that the customer is a part of (e.g. homeowners, parents).	It is personalised The letter addresses the customer by name, but it is not immediately visible.	It is clearly personalised The letter addresses the customer by name, and it is immediately visible.
Source Is the sender recognisable and trustworthy?	It is not recognisable The letter does not obviously appear to be from a recognisable sender. The customer would probably think it was junk mail. The letter looks suspicious.	It is not always recognisable The sender could be recognised by customer, but the customer would probably think it was junk mail. The letter may look suspicious.	It is recognisable The letter is from a recognisable sender, but it could easily be confused for junk mail.	It is clearly recognisable The letter is from a clearly recognisable sender. It is unlikely to be confused for junk mail.	It is very clearly recognisable The letter is from a clearly recognisable sender. It is very unlikely to be confused for junk mail.
Purpose Is the purpose of the letter	It is very unclear No purpose for the letter is	It can be unclear The letter includes a	It can be unclear The first paragraph indicates	It is clear The first paragraph clearly	It is very clear The letter has a clear

clearly visible and straightforward?	provided, nor is it clear what the customer is supposed to do with the information in the letter.	purpose, but it is not clearly visible or understandable. It is not clear what the customer is supposed to do with the information in the letter.	the purpose of the letter, but it isn't clear what the customer is supposed to do with the information in the letter.	explains the purpose of the letter and identifies how the information can be used.	purpose at the top of the letter. The first paragraph clearly explains the purpose of the letter and how the information can be used.
Call to action Is there a clear call to action?	There is no call to action Either no call to action is provided, or it is likely to backfire.	It is unclear The call to action is unclear and difficult to find (e.g. in the body of the letter).	It is clear, but may be difficult to find The call to action is clear, but difficult to find. Or it is prominent in the letter, but difficult to understand.	It is clear The call to action is clear and prominent in the letter. However, some customers may find it difficult to understand.	It is very clear The call to action is very clear and prominent in the letter.

1.3.2 Design

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Chunking Is the letter chunked into short, digestible paragraphs?	It is not chunked at all - The letter has bulk text and/or long paragraphs with multiple topics (5+ sentences). - No bullet points nor numbered lists are used.	It is somewhat chunked - The letter is broken up into chunks, however, the paragraphs are long with multiple topics (4+ sentences). - Bullet points and/or numbered lists are used to list some key information. However, the lists are too long (7+ items), dense and/or inconsistent.	It is mostly chunked - The letter is broken up into readable chunks. Some paragraphs are long or have multiple topics. - Bullet points and/or numbered lists are used appropriately to list key information. However, some lists are too long (7+ items), dense or inconsistent.	It is chunked - The letter is clearly broken up into readable chunks. Most paragraphs are 1-2 sentences with one topic. - Bullet points and/or numbered lists are used appropriately to list and highlight key information.	It is chunked very effectively - The letter is clearly broken up into readable and logical chunks. All paragraphs are 1-2 sentences with one topic. - Bullet points and/or numbered lists are used effectively to list and highlight key information.
Headings Are there clear subheadings to help the customer quickly navigate and understand the letter?	It does not No headings are used to break up information.	It does, but they are very unclear Headings are used but they are too short to describe what is in the paragraph (e.g. introduction) or not descriptive.	It does, but they are unclear Headings are used, but they are hard to understand or do not succinctly describe the information in the paragraph.	It does The headings are short, clear and descriptive, but may not be relevant to the specific customer.	It does, and they are very clear The headings are short, clear and relevant to the specific customer. They are descriptive and/or use a question-and-answer format.
White space Is there empty space around the content and elements to make the letter easier to read?	It is very difficult to read - There is limited white space in the letter, making it very difficult to read or identify key information. - There are elements in the letter that distract customers	It is difficult to read - There is limited white space in the letter, making it difficult to read or identify key information. - There may be some elements in the letter that	It is sometimes difficult to read There is some white space around and between text to make it readable. But there is clutter, due to the proximity of other elements like images, boxes and tables.	It is easy to read There is white space around and between paragraphs to make the letter easy to read. However, there is some clutter caused by other elements (images, graphics, boxes, tables).	It is very easy to read There is white space around and between paragraphs to make the letter easy to read. White space is used around images, graphics and boxes/tables to clearly organise and highlight key

	or are used ineffectively. For example, too many images/graphics, causing clutter and making it hard to read the text.	distract customers or are used ineffectively.	- The white space is not consistent and does not balance elements across the letter. - Some related elements (e.g. an image and its caption) are far apart.	- The white space is not clearly and consistently balanced across the letter. - Related elements (e.g. an image and its caption) are close together.	information. - There is consistent use of white space to balance elements across the letter (e.g. between paragraphs). - Related elements and text are visually grouped together.
Icons/images Are icons/images used to help customers identify and understand key information?	They are not used There are no icons/images in the letter, making it unengaging and difficult for customers to quickly identify and understand key information.	They are rarely used There are little to no icons/images in the letter, making it difficult for customers to quickly identify and understand key information. Icons/images may unclear (e.g. because they are too big, too small, poor quality, or not clearly related to the information).	They are sometimes used Icons/images are used to help customers identify and understand some key information. However, some icons/images may unclear (e.g. because they are too big, too small, poor quality, or not clearly related to the information).	They are used Clear and engaging icons/images are used to help customers identify and understand most key information.	They are used very effectively Clear and engaging icons/images are used to help customers identify and understand key information quickly (e.g. relevant icons paired with text or statistics, a process visualised as a step-by-step infographic).
Colouring/bolding Is colouring/bolding used sparingly and consistently to highlight key information?	They are not used There is no use of colouring nor bolding, making it hard for customers to identify key information.	They are rarely used Colouring and bolding of words is inconsistent or does not highlight key information.	They are sometimes used Colouring and bolding of words highlights most key information, but is used inconsistently.	They are used Colouring and bolding of words makes it easy for customers to identify and understand all key information.	They are used very effectively Colouring and bolding of words makes it easy for customers to quickly identify and understand key information.

1.3.3 Language

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Readability Is the letter easy to read?	It is very difficult to read - Most of the letter is written with long and complex sentences, with a lot of unnecessary information. - Flesch reading ease score: < 50.	It is difficult to read - Some of the letter is written with long and complex sentences, with a lot of unnecessary information. - Flesch reading ease score: 50-54.	It is somewhat easy to read - Most of the letter is written with short sentences, however, there is some unnecessary information. - Flesch reading ease score: 55-60.	It is easy to read - The whole letter is written with short sentences, with limited unnecessary information. - Flesch reading ease score: 61-70.	It is very easy to read - The whole letter is written with clear and concise sentences, with limited to no unnecessary information. - Flesch reading ease score: 70+.
Simplicity Is the letter written in plain English?	It is not Most of the letter is written with very complex and inconsistent language. Most parts of the letter are difficult	It mostly is not Some of the letter is written with very complex and inconsistent language. Many parts of the letter are difficult	It mostly is Most of the letter is written in plain English, however, some parts of the letter are difficult to understand (e.g.	Almost all of it is Almost all the letter is written in plain English. All technical terms are explained, but some explanations may be	It is The whole letter is written in plain English, with all technical terms explained clearly and consistently.

	to understand (e.g. due to unexplained jargon, inconsistent terminology).	to understand (e.g. due to unexplained jargon, inconsistent terminology).	due to unexplained jargon, inconsistent terminology).	hard to understand.	
Personalisation Does the letter use first/second pronouns and other personalisation?	It does not Limited to no personalisation used in the letter.	It rarely does The letter makes limited use of personal pronouns, but they do not direct customers to act.	It sometimes does The letter uses some personal pronouns.	It does The letter uses personal pronouns to effectively engage and direct customers to act. Pronouns are used in headings.	It does very effectively - The letter uses personal pronouns to quickly engage and direct customers to act. Pronouns are used in headings (e.g. "What are my next steps?"). - The letter uses personal information to engage the customer (e.g. relevant personal details or a photo of an offence the letter is referencing).
Tone Is the letter written in the active voice*? *In a sentence written in the active voice, the subject of sentence performs the action. In a sentence written in the passive voice, the subject receives the action.	Almost all of it is not Most sentences are written in the passive voice (e.g. "Your application will be reviewed by the Department").	The majority is not Most sentences are written in the passive voice. Some active sentences provide limited clarity.	Some of it is not Some of the sentences are written in the passive voice. The active sentences help customers to understand key information.	The majority is Most sentences are written in the active voice. However, some passive sentences are used inappropriately.	Almost all of it is Most sentences are written in the active voice (e.g. "The Department will review your application"). The passive sentences are used sparingly and where appropriate.

1.3.4 Next steps

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Instructions Does the letter provide clear instructions?	It does not, or they are very hard to find There either are no instructions in the letter, or they are very hard to find because they are hidden in a block of text. The instructions do not provide clear timings and most include more than one action.	It does, but they are unclear Where required, the letter includes listed instructions. However, they are either unclear, hard to find or not presented in a logical order. The instructions do not provide clear timings and some include more than one action.	It does, but they are sometimes unclear Where required, the letter includes step-by-step instructions on what the customer has to do. However, some instructions are unclear (e.g. no clear verb) and/or include more than one action. Some instructions do not provide clear timings (e.g. "10 business days from today").	It does, and they are clear - Where required, the letter includes step-by-step instructions on what the customer has to do and by when. Each instruction includes only one action and uses a verb at the start of the sentence to explain what the customer has to do (e.g. "Go to the website..."). - There is no diagram, but there are other visuals (e.g. icons) to help customers understand the instructions.	It does, and they are very clear - Where required, the letter includes clear step-by-step instructions on what customer has to do and by when. Each instruction includes only one action and uses a verb at the start of the sentence to explain what the customer has to do (e.g. "Go to the website..."). - There is a diagram that includes relevant icons for each action, and a clear logical flow.

Links Does the letter have QR codes and/or short web addresses to take the customer directly to the next step(s)? -	There are none, or they are broken - Where an online form and/or website is required for the next step, there is either no QR code, or the QR code does not work properly (e.g. because it is too small, or the link is broken). The letter instructs the customer to go online and search themselves. - Web addresses are very long, and difficult to remember. - No assistance or access to support is offered.	They are available, but very indirect - A QR code takes the customer to the correct website, but it is difficult to find or access the next step. - Web addresses are long and difficult to remember. - Assistance or access to support is very unclear	They are available, but indirect - A QR code takes the customer to the correct website, but the customer has to search briefly for the next step. - Web addresses are relatively long and might be difficult to remember. - Assistance and access to support is offered.	They are available and mostly direct - A QR code takes the customer to the website where the next step is very easy to find and access. - Web addresses are relatively short and easy to remember. - Assistance and access to support is clearly signposted.	They are available and direct - A QR code takes the customer directly to the website and/or form to complete the next step (no additional clicks required). - Web addresses are short and easy to remember. - Assistance and access to support is very clearly signposted in an appropriate location.
Prompts Are planning prompts used to help the customer complete the next steps?	They are not used - The letter does not prompt the customer to plan. The email does not say how many days the customer has to complete the action(s). - The letter does not tell the customer what steps they have left in the process.	They are not used, but some information is provided - The letter does not prompt the customer to plan. The letter says how many days the customer has to complete the action(s). - The letter tells the customer what steps they have left in the process.	They are used - The letter prompts the customer to plan what they have to do. The letter says how many days the customer has to complete the action(s). - The letter tells the customer what steps they have left in the process.	They are used clearly - The letter prompts the customer to plan what they have to do and by when. The letter sets a deadline to complete the action(s). - The letter shows the customer where they are in the process and what steps they have left.	They are used clearly and very effectively - The letter prompts the customer to plan and write down or diarise what they have to do and by when. The letter sets a clear deadline to complete the action(s). - The letter clearly highlights how far the customer has come in the process and/or how close they are to completing it (e.g. it includes a checklist with the completed actions/steps checked off).
Trusted messenger Is the letter sent by a trusted messenger?	It is not, and there may be negative impacts The letter is signed off by, or uses a quote from, a messenger that is likely to have a negative impact on the customer (e.g. by making them feel anxious or think that they are in trouble when they are not).	It is not, and is ineffective The letter is signed off by, or uses a quote from, a messenger that customers are unlikely to recognise and/or is ineffective (e.g. because the messenger may not seem relevant to the process).	It is, but may be ineffective The letter is signed off by, or uses a quote from, a messenger that is recognisable, but may be ineffective (e.g. because the messenger may not seem relevant to the process).	It is, and is effective The letter is signed off by, or uses a quote from, a trusted and easily recognisable messenger.	It is, and is very effective The letter is signed off by, or uses a quote from, a very trusted and easily recognisable messenger (this can include government staff with their credentials). If the letter uses a quote from an influencer/celebrity, the customer is likely to know and respect them.
Choice	It does not	It mostly does not	It does, but lacks information	It does	It does very effectively

Does the letter help the customer can make an informed choice?	- The letter does not list/explain the different options. - No defaults are prescribed, or the default would negatively impact the customer.	- The letter lists the different options. - No defaults are prescribed, or the default is not in the best interests of the customer.	- The letter explains what the different options are. - Where appropriate, the letter prescribes a default choice, however, the option to make another choice is not explained.	- The letter explains the outcomes of different options. - Where appropriate, the letter prescribes a default choice that is in the customer's best interests. The option to choose another option is explained.	- The letter clearly explains the outcomes of different options, including highlighting the benefits of a preferred option. - Where appropriate, the letter prescribes a default choice that is in the customer's best interests. The letter clearly explains the consequences of the default option and offers flexibility to choose other options.
Empathy Are unfavourable or unexpected outcomes communicated clearly and empathetically?	They are communicated coldly and without an offer of support - The outcome is unclear and/or misleading, and is delivered without explanation nor empathy. - Customers are not offered support.	They are communicated without clear explanation nor empathy - Unfavourable outcomes are communicated without clear explanation nor empathy. - Customers receive an offer of support, but it is unclear and/or hard to access.	They are communicated clearly, but without empathy - Unfavourable outcomes are explained clearly, but without empathy. - Customers receive an offer of support, but it may unclear and/or hard to access.	They are communicated clearly and somewhat empathetically - Unfavourable outcomes are explained clearly with some limited empathy. - Customers receive a clear offer of support.	They are communicated clearly and empathetically - Unfavourable outcomes (e.g. rejections) are explained clearly and empathetically. - Customers are given clear and accessible options to connect with support for their wellbeing.

1.4 Read text message

Reading a text message/SMS sent from government

- To give customers an update on the status of an application
- To remind customers to complete an action

1.4.1 Reason and call to action

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Reason Does the text message have a clear purpose?	It is very unclear - The text message is sent on an ad-hoc basis and may be sent at an inappropriate time. - No reason for the text message is provided. - There is no call to action.	It is unclear - The text message is sent on an ad-hoc basis. - Reason for the text message is provided, but it is unclear. - There is no call to action.	It is mostly clear - The text message is not automated and is sent manually. However, it relates to an event in the process and it sent at an appropriate time. - Reason for the text message is provided, but it may be	It is clear - The text message is automated. It is triggered by an event in the process and is sent at an appropriate time. - Clear reason for the text message is provided early.	It is very clear - The text message is automated. It is triggered by an event in the process (e.g. one day before a scheduled appointment) and is sent at an appropriate time. - Clear reason for the text message is provided early

			unclear. There is a call to action, but it is unclear.	There is a call to action.	and links directly to call to action. There is a clear call to action.
Personalisation Does the text message use personalisation?	It is not personalised at all - The text message is not personalised. It does not include the customer's name. - The sender is not identified.	It is not personalised - The text message is not personalised. It does not include the customer's name. - The sender is identified in the body of the text.	It is somewhat personalised - The text message includes the customer's name. - The sender is identified in the body of the text.	It is personalised - The text message includes the customer's name. - The sender is identified in the contact.	It is very personalised - The text message addresses the customer by name. - The sender is identified in the contact.

1.4.2 Content and next steps

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Relevant Does the text message contain clear and relevant content?	It does not - Most content is irrelevant and is not structured clearly. - The text message is very hard to understand (e.g. long sentences/words, jargon, passive voice, no personalisation). - Flesch reading ease score: < 50.	It is not very clear nor relevant - Most content is irrelevant or not structured clearly. - The text message uses some plain English, with active voice, personalisation and/or short sentences. However, it is hard to understand. - Flesch reading ease score: 50-60.	It is mostly clear and relevant - Most content is relevant and structured clearly. - The text message is mostly written in plain English, with active voice, personalisation and short sentences. However, some parts are hard to understand. - Flesch reading ease score: 60-70.	It is clear and relevant - All content is relevant and structured clearly. - The text message is written in plain English, with active voice, personalisation and short sentences. However, some customers may find it hard to understand. - Flesch reading ease score: 70-80.	It is very clear and relevant - All content is relevant and structured clearly. - The text message is written in plain English, with active voice, personalisation, short sentences and no technical jargon. - Flesch reading ease score: 80+ (70+ if topic is technical).
Next steps Does the text message clearly outline the next steps?	It does not - The text message does not include a list nor explanation of the next steps. - The text message does not include any links to the next step or further information.	It does, but it is unclear - The text message includes a brief explanation of the next steps, but it is unclear. - The text message does not include any links to the next step or further information.	It does - The text message includes a brief explanation of the next steps, but it may be unclear. - The text message includes a link to a website where the customer can find the next step and/or further information, but it takes 2+ clicks.	It does clearly - The text message includes a list of the next steps. - The text message includes a link to a website where the customer can easily find the next step and/or further information in 1-2 clicks.	It does very clearly - The text message includes a clear list of the next steps. - The text message includes a link that takes the customer directly to the next step and/or further information (where applicable).

1.5 Read confirmation (text/email)

Reading a text or email sent from government to acknowledge receipt/confirm submission, and communicate next steps

- To acknowledge receipt of feedback or complaint
- To confirm submission of an application

1.5.1 Timing

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Confirmation timing Is a confirmation sent immediately after submission?	It is not sent at all, or significantly delayed • No confirmation is sent, or is very delayed (i.e. more than 24 hours).	It is delayed • Confirmation is delayed (i.e. not within 10 minutes).	It is not immediate • Confirmation is not instantaneous (i.e. 5 to 10 minutes).	It is almost immediate • Confirmation is almost instantaneous (i.e. 1 to 5 minutes).	It is immediate • Confirmation is effectively instantaneous.
Channel Is the customer told how they will receive the confirmation?	It is very unclear • Customers are not told they will receive a confirmation, nor where it will be sent to. • Many customers contact the agency enquiring about confirmation.	It is unclear • Customers are told they will receive a confirmation, but not where it will be sent to. • Some customers contact the agency enquiring about confirmation.	It is mostly clear • Customers are told they will receive confirmation via one channel (e.g. via email). • Customers occasionally contact the agency enquiring about confirmation.	It is clear • Customers are told they will receive confirmation and offered 2 channel options to receive it. • Customers occasionally contact the agency enquiring about confirmation.	It is very clear • Customers are told they will receive confirmation and are offered 2+ channel options to receive it. • Customers rarely, if ever, contact the agency enquiring about confirmation.

1.5.2 Reason

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Subject line Is the subject line short, simple and direct?	It is very unclear • The subject line is very unclear and longer than 6 words.	It is unclear • The subject line is unclear and longer than 6 words.	It can be unclear • The subject line is either unclear or longer than 6 words.	It is mostly clear • The subject line is short (3-6 words), but may be unclear to some customers.	It is very clear • The subject line is clear and short (3-4 words). The text/email clearly relates to the customer request/submission.
Source Is the sender recognisable and trustworthy?	It is not recognisable • The text/email does not obviously appear to be from a recognisable source. The text/email is automatically classified as spam/junk most of the time. • The text/email appears	It is not always recognisable • The sender could be recognised by customers, but the text/email is often automatically classified as spam/junk. • The text/email appears suspicious and comes	It is recognisable • The text/email is sent from a recognisable source, but it is sometimes automatically classified as spam/junk.	It is clearly recognisable • The text/email is sent from a clearly recognisable and trustworthy source. It is rarely automatically classified as spam/junk.	It is very clearly recognisable • The text/email is sent from a clearly recognisable and trustworthy source. It is almost never automatically classified as spam/junk.

	suspicious and comes across as spam.	across as spam.			
Purpose Is the purpose of the confirmation clearly visible and straightforward?	It is very unclear The text/email does not confirm the customer's specific request or submission. No purpose for the text/email is provided, nor is it clear what the customer is supposed to do with the information.	It is unclear Confirmation of the request or submission is hard to find or understand. The text/email includes a purpose, but it is not clearly visible or understandable. It is not clear what the customer is supposed to do with the information.	It can be unclear The text/email confirms the request or submission. The first paragraph indicates the purpose of the text/email, but it isn't clear what the customer is supposed to do with the information.	It is clear The text/email confirms the customer's request or submission in the first sentence. The first paragraph clearly explains the purpose of the text/email and identifies how the information can be used.	It is very clear The text/email clearly confirms the customer's request or submission in the first sentence. The confirmation is personalised (e.g. includes name and specifies their request). The first paragraph clearly explains the purpose of the text/email and how the information can be used.

1.5.3 Next steps

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Next steps and waiting time Does the confirmation clearly explain the next steps in the process?	The next steps are very unclear The confirmation does not explain the next steps in the process, where the customer is in the process, nor what the customer has to do. The confirmation does not provide any expected wait times for the next steps in the process.	The next steps are unclear Next steps are provided, but are difficult to understand and do not explain what the customer has to do. The confirmation does not explain where the customer is in the process. The confirmation provides a vague estimated waiting time for the next steps in the process.	The next steps are sometimes unclear Next steps are provided, but they may be difficult to understand or do not explain what the customer has to do. The confirmation does not explain where the customer is in the process. The confirmation provides a vague estimated waiting time for the next steps in the process.	The next steps are clear The confirmation clearly explains the next steps in the process, including what the customer has to do, where they are in the process and how long they can expect to wait.	The next steps are very clear The confirmation clearly explains the next steps in the process, including what the customer has to do and by when, where they are in the process and how long they can expect to wait. The information is either clearly structured or visualised. The confirmation also clearly states when and how the customer should make contact if the estimated waiting time has been exceeded.
Instructions Where required, does the confirmation include clear step-by-step instructions?	It does not, or they are very hard to find There either are no instructions in the confirmation, or they are very hard to find because they are hidden in a block of text. The instructions do not provide clear timings and most include more than one action.	It does, but they are unclear Where required, the confirmation includes listed instructions. However, they are either unclear, hard to find or not presented in a logical order. The instructions do not provide clear timings and some include more than one action.	It does, but they are sometimes unclear Where required, the confirmation includes step-by-step instructions on what the customer has to do. However, some instructions are unclear (e.g. no clear verb) and/or include more than one action. Some instructions do not provide clear timings (e.g. "10	It does, and they are clear Where required, the confirmation includes step-by-step instructions on what the customer has to do and by when. Each instruction includes only one action and uses a verb at the start of the sentence to explain what the customer has to do (e.g. "Go to the website...").	It does, and they are very clear Where required, the confirmation includes clear step-by-step instructions on what customer has to do and by when. Each instruction includes only one action and uses a verb at the start of the sentence to explain what the customer has to do (e.g. "Go to the website...").

			business days from today").	For email confirmations, there is no diagram, but there are other visuals (e.g. icons) to help customers understand the instructions.	For email confirmations, there is a diagram that includes relevant icons for each action, and a clear logical flow.
Links Are hyperlinks/buttons available to take the customer directly to the next step(s)?	They are not available, or broken - Where an online form and/or website is required for the next step, there are either no hyperlinks/buttons, or there are broken hyperlinks/buttons that do not work properly. The confirmation instructs the customer to go online and search themselves. - No assistance or access to support is offered. - The customer cannot select a preferred channel for further communication.	They are available, but very indirect - Hyperlinks/buttons take the customer to the correct website, but it is difficult to find or access the next step. - Assistance or access to support is very unclear. - Other channels are available, but this is not communicated to the customer.	They are available, but indirect - Hyperlinks/buttons take the customer to the correct website, but the customer has to search briefly for the next step. - Assistance and access to support is offered. - The customer can choose a preferred channel, but the process is difficult and/or not communicated clearly.	They are available and mostly direct - Hyperlinks/buttons take the customer to the website where the next step is very easy to find and access. - Assistance and access to support is clearly signposted. - The customer can choose a preferred channel and the steps for doing so are communicated.	They are available and direct - Hyperlinks/buttons take the customer directly to the website and/or form to complete the next step (no additional click-throughs are required). - Assistance and access to support is very clearly signposted in an appropriate location. - The customer can choose a preferred channel and the steps for doing so are very clearly and consistently communicated.

1.6 Read notification

Reading an app notification or reminder

- Notification that an application is due
- Reminder to attend an appointment

1.6.1 Status / Reminder

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Relevance Is the notification relevant and helpful?	It is not - The notification does not relate to the process and is unhelpful. - The notification does not include a call to action. - When selected, the notification takes the customer to the home page	It is somewhat relevant, but not helpful - The notification relates to the process but is unhelpful. - The notification does not include a call to action. - When selected, the notification takes the customer to the home page	It is relevant and sometimes helpful - The notification relates to the process but may not be helpful. - The notification includes a call to action. - When selected, the notification takes the	It is relevant and helpful - The notification is relevant and helpful. - The notification is mostly written in plain English and includes a call to action. - When selected, the notification takes the customer directly to the	It is very relevant and helpful - The notification is relevant and helpful. - The notification is written in plain English and includes a clear call to action. - When selected, the notification takes the customer directly to the

	of the app. It takes a long time to load.	of the app.	customer directly to the relevant page/section of the app, but it can take a long time to load.	relevant page/section of the app.	relevant page/section of the app.
Timing Is the notification sent at an appropriate time?	It is not, and is very ineffective The notification is not sent at an appropriate time. It is usually sent too early or too late. It is very ineffective at prompting customers to complete the next step.	It is not, and is ineffective The notification is sent at a time where customers are unlikely to have the time to engage with it. It is ineffective at prompting customers to complete the next step.	It is, and it is mostly effective The notification is sent at an appropriate time for most customers. It is mostly effective at prompting customers to complete the next step.	It is, and it is effective The notification is sent at an appropriate time and is effective at prompting customers to complete the next step.	It is, and it is very effective - The notification is sent at an appropriate time and is very effective at prompting customers to complete the next step. - The notification is sent at a time when the customer is likely to have the time to complete the next step immediately (informed by customer research/data).
Choice Can customers choose which notifications they would like to receive?	They cannot change notification settings in the app Customers can only turn off notifications in the phone settings, not the app. Customers cannot customise their notification preferences.	They can turn off notifications, but it is difficult Customers can turn off notifications in the app but cannot customise them. The settings are hard to find.	They can customise notifications, but it is difficult Customers have limited options to customise their notifications in the app. The settings may be hard to find.	They can customise notifications easily Customers can customise or turn off their notifications in the app. The settings are relatively easy to find.	They are prompted to customise notifications - Customers can customise or turn off their notifications seamlessly in the app. The settings are very easy to find. - Customers are prompted to select their notification preferences while setting up the app.

1.7 Read signage

Reading signs in a physical location. Excludes legally mandated exit signs which have existing rules

- Signs directing customers to a specific location
- Signs communicating rules for a physical location (e.g. wearing a face mask, queuing)

1.7.1 Position

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Position Are the signs clearly positioned?	They are not positioned clearly at all Signs are placed near or	They are not positioned clearly at all Most of these criteria are not met:	They are positioned visibly Most of these criteria are partly met:	They are positioned clearly Most of these criteria are met:	They are positioned very clearly All signs are positioned free of obstructions.

	behind obstructions (e.g. in corners, behind objects). - Signs are not placed at or near eye-level. - Signs are not placed in a context that makes sense. - Signage is incomplete, redundant, missing, or contradictory.	- All signs are positioned free of obstructions. - All signs are placed near or at eye-level. - All signs are placed in a context that makes sense. - Signage is complete and consistent.	- All signs are positioned free of obstructions. - All signs are placed near or at eye-level. - All signs are placed in a context that makes sense. - Signage is complete and consistent.	- All signs are positioned free of obstructions. - All signs are placed near or at eye-level. - All signs are placed in a context that makes sense. - Signage is complete and consistent.	- All signs are placed near or at eye-level. - All signs are placed in a context that makes sense. - Signage is complete and consistent.	- All signs are placed near or at eye-level. - All signs are placed in a context that makes sense (e.g. a sign about handwashing is placed above a sink). - Signage is complete and consistent.
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1.7.2 Design and content

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Simplicity Are the signs written in plain English?	They are not - Signs are not written in plain English, and there is use of jargon, passive voice and/or unnecessary detail. - There is no call to action. - Where contextually appropriate, translations are not displayed in common community language(s).	They mostly are not - Signs are generally not written in plain English, and there is some use of jargon, passive voice, and/or unnecessary detail. - There is a call to action, but it is unclear. - Where contextually appropriate, translations are not displayed in common community language(s).	They mostly are - Signs are generally written in plain English, but there is some use of jargon, passive voice, or unnecessary detail. - There is a call to action. - Where contextually appropriate, translations are displayed in common community language(s). However, they are hard to read.	They almost all are - Signs are written in plain English, but there is some minimal use of jargon, passive voice, or unnecessary detail. - There is a clear call to action. - Where contextually appropriate, translations are displayed in common community language(s).	They are - Signs are written in plain English, with active voice, no (inappropriate) use of jargon, and no unnecessary detail. - There is a clear and specific call to action. - Where contextually appropriate, translations are displayed in common community language(s).
Visual techniques Do the signs use visual techniques for clarity and visibility?	None are used - Signs do not use any imagery/symbols, or use imagery/symbols that are often misinterpreted. - Signage is branded inconsistently (e.g. variations in colour, size, logo, and font). - Signs do not stand out or demand attention.	Some are used - Signs do not use easily recognisable and understood imagery/symbols. - Signage is branded inconsistently. - Signs use some visual techniques to demand attention, but are not aesthetically pleasing.	They are used - Signs mostly use easily recognisable and understood imagery/symbols to communicate messages. - Signage is mostly branded consistently (e.g. using the same colours, logo and font, but perhaps inconsistent or outdated logos or colour schemes). - Signs mostly stand out and demand attention, but are not aesthetically pleasing.	They are used well - Signs use easily recognisable and understood imagery/symbols to communicate messages. - All signage is branded consistently (i.e. same colours, size, logo, font). - Signs stand out and demand attention, but are not very aesthetically pleasing.	They are used clearly and effectively - Signs use easily recognisable and understood imagery/symbols to communicate clear messages. - All signage is branded consistently (i.e. same colours, size, logo, font). - Signs stand out and demand attention (i.e. use of contrasting colours and large, clear font) and are aesthetically pleasing.

1.8 Read factsheet/brochure

Reading a short informational document, like a factsheet or brochure

- To provide information about a government service, including eligibility and benefits
- To encourage customers to sign up for a government service or program as part of an outreach program
- To provide information about a topic or issue (e.g. about a disease)

1.8.1 Design

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Headings Are there clear headings to help the customer navigate and understand?	There are no headings • No headings are used to break up information.	There are headings, but they are very unclear • Headings are used but they are not descriptive and/or they are too short to describe what is in the paragraph (e.g. "Introduction").	There are headings, but they are unclear • Headings are used, but they are hard to understand or do not succinctly describe the information in the paragraph.	There are clear headings • The headings are short, clear and descriptive, but customers may be unsure if the information in the paragraph is relevant to them.	There are very clear headings • The headings are short, clear and descriptive. Where relevant, the headings use a question-and-answer format.
Chunking Is the factsheet/brochure broken up into clear sections?	It is not chunked at all • The factsheet/brochure has bulk text and/or long paragraphs with multiple topics (5+ sentences). • No bullet points nor numbered lists are used.	It is somewhat chunked • The factsheet/brochure is broken up into chunks, however, the paragraphs are long with multiple topics (4+ sentences). • Bullet points and/or numbered lists are used to list some key information. However, the lists are too long (7+ items), dense and/or inconsistent.	It is mostly chunked • The factsheet/brochure is broken up into readable chunks. Some paragraphs are long or have multiple topics. • Bullet points and/or numbered lists are used appropriately to list key information. However, some lists are too long (7+ items), dense or inconsistent.	It is chunked • The factsheet/brochure is clearly broken up into readable chunks. Most paragraphs are 1-2 sentences with one topic. • Bullet points and/or numbered lists are used appropriately to list and highlight key information.	It is chunked very effectively • The factsheet/brochure is clearly broken up into readable and logical chunks. All paragraphs are 1-2 sentences with one topic. • Bullet points and/or numbered lists are used effectively to list and highlight key information
White space Is there empty space around the content and elements to make the webpage easier to read?	It is very difficult to read • There is limited white space on the factsheet/brochure, making it difficult to read or identify key information. • There are elements in the factsheet/brochure that distract customers or are used ineffectively. For example, too many	It is difficult to read • There is limited white space on the factsheet/brochure, making it difficult to read or identify key information. • There may be some elements on the factsheet/brochure that distract customers or are used ineffectively.	It is sometimes difficult to read • There is some white space around and between text to make it readable. But there is clutter, due to the proximity of other elements like images, boxes and tables. • The white space is not consistent and does not	It is easy to read • There is white space around and between paragraphs to make the text easy to read. However, there is some clutter caused by other elements (images, icons, boxes, tables). • The white space is not clearly and consistently	It is very easy to read • There is white space around and between paragraphs to make the text easy to read. • White space is used around images, icons and boxes/tables to clearly organise and highlight key information.

	images/graphics, causing clutter and making it hard to read the text.		balance elements across the factsheet/brochure. Some related elements (e.g. an image and its caption) are far apart.	balanced across the factsheet/brochure. Related elements (e.g. an image and its caption) are close together.	- White space is used consistently to balance elements across the factsheet/brochure (e.g. margins). - Related elements and text are visually grouped together.
Icons/images Are icons/images used to help customers identify and understand key information?	They are not used There are no icons/images in the factsheet/brochure, making it unengaging and difficult for customers to quickly identify and understand key information.	They are rarely used There are little to no icons/images in the factsheet/brochure, making it difficult for customers to quickly identify and understand key information. Icons/images may unclear (e.g. because they are too big, too small, poor quality, or not clearly related to the information).	They are sometimes used Icons/images are used to help customers identify and understand some key information. However, some icons/images may unclear (e.g. because they are too big, too small, poor quality, or not clearly related to the information).	They are used Clear and engaging icons/images are used to help customers identify and understand most key information.	They are used very effectively Clear and engaging icons/images are used to help customers identify and understand key information quickly (e.g. relevant icons paired with text or statistics, a process visualised as a step-by-step infographic).
Text format Are colouring/bolding used sparingly and consistently to highlight key information?	They are not used No use of colouring nor bolding, making it hard for customers to quickly identify and understand key information.	They are rarely used Colouring and bolding of words is inconsistent or does not highlight key information.	They are sometimes used Colouring and bolding of words helps customers identify some key information, but it is used inconsistently.	They are used Colouring and bolding of words helps customers identify and understand all key information.	They are used very effectively Colouring and bolding of words helps customers quickly identify and understand key information.

1.8.2 Language

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Readability Is the factsheet/brochure easy to read?	It is very difficult to read - Most of the factsheet/brochure is written with long and complex sentences, with a lot of unnecessary information. - Flesch reading ease score: < 50.	It is difficult to read - Some of the factsheet/brochure is written with long and complex sentences, with a lot of unnecessary information. - Flesch reading ease score: 50-54.	It is somewhat easy to read - Most of the factsheet/brochure is written with short sentences, however, there is some unnecessary information. - Flesch reading ease score: 55-60.	It is easy to read - The whole factsheet/brochure is written with short sentences, with limited unnecessary information. - Flesch reading ease score: 61-70.	It is very easy to read - The whole factsheet/brochure is written with clear and concise sentences, with limited to no unnecessary information. - Flesch reading ease score: 70+.
Simplicity Is the factsheet/brochure written in plain English?	It is not Most of the factsheet/brochure is written with very complex and	It mostly is not Some of the factsheet/brochure is written with very complex and	It mostly is Most of the factsheet/brochure is written in plain English, however,	Almost all of it is Almost all the factsheet/brochure is written in plain English. All technical	It is The whole factsheet/brochure is written in plain English, with all

	inconsistent language. Most parts of the factsheet/brochure are difficult to understand (e.g. due to unexplained jargon, inconsistent terminology).	inconsistent language. Many parts of the factsheet/brochure are difficult to understand (e.g. due to unexplained jargon, inconsistent terminology).	some parts of the letter are difficult to understand (e.g. due to unexplained jargon, inconsistent terminology).	terms are explained, but some explanations may be hard to understand.	technical terms explained clearly and consistently.
Personalisation Does the factsheet/brochure use first/second pronouns and other personalisation?	It does not Limited to no personalisation is used in the factsheet/brochure.	It rarely does The factsheet/brochure makes limited use of personal pronouns, but they do not direct customers to the call to action.	It sometimes does The factsheet/brochure uses personal pronouns, but they do not direct customers to the call to action.	It does The factsheet/brochure uses personal pronouns to effectively direct customers to the call to action (e.g. "Complete your application"). Pronouns are used in headings.	It does very effectively The factsheet/brochure uses personal pronouns to quickly engage and direct customers to the call to action. Pronouns are used in headings (e.g. "What do I need to bring to my appointment?").
Tone Is the factsheet/brochure written in the active voice*? *In a sentence written in the active voice, the subject of sentence performs the action. In a sentence written in the passive voice, the subject receives the action.	Almost all of it is not Most sentences are written in the passive voice (e.g. "Your application will be reviewed by the Department")	The majority is not Most sentences are written in the passive voice. Some active sentences provide limited clarity.	Some of it is not Some of the sentences are written in the passive voice. The active sentences help customers to understand key information.	The majority is Most sentences are written in the active voice. However, some passive sentences are used inappropriately.	Almost all of it is Most sentences are written in the active voice (e.g. "The Department will review your application"). The passive sentences are used sparingly and where appropriate.

1.8.3 Content

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Accuracy Is the information accurate and up to date?	It is very inaccurate - Most or all content is inaccurate and/or outdated. - The factsheet/brochure is rarely (if ever) updated and there is no process in place to update it.	It is inaccurate - Some content is inaccurate and/or outdated. - The factsheet/brochure is updated on an ad hoc basis.	It is mostly accurate - Most content is accurate and up to date. - The factsheet/brochure is updated on an ad hoc basis.	It is accurate - All content is accurate and up to date. - There is a process in place to update the factsheet/brochure occasionally.	It is very accurate - All content is accurate and up to date. - There is a process in place to update the factsheet/brochure regularly.
Links Does the factsheet/brochure have QR codes and/or short web addresses to take the customer directly to the next step(s)?	There are none, or they are broken Where an online form and/or website is required for the next step, there is either no QR code, or the QR code does not work properly (e.g. because it is too small, or the link is broken). The	They are available, but very indirect - A QR code takes the customer to the correct website, but it is difficult to find or access the next step. - Web addresses are long and difficult to remember.	They are available, but indirect - A QR code takes the customer to the correct website, but the customer has to search briefly for the next step. - Web addresses are relatively long and might be difficult to	They are available and mostly direct - A QR code takes the customer to the website where the next step is very easy to find and access. - Web addresses are relatively short and easy to remember.	They are available and direct - A QR code takes the customer directly to the website and/or form to complete the next step (no additional clicks required). - Web addresses are short and easy to remember.

	factsheet/brochure instructs the customer to go online and search themselves. - Web addresses are very long and difficult to remember. - No assistance or access to support is offered.	Assistance or access to support is very unclear.	remember. Assistance and access to support is offered.	Assistance and access to support is clearly signposted.	Assistance and access to support is very clearly signposted in an appropriate location.
Sufficient information Is there enough information in the factsheet/brochure?	There is not enough information, or information is misleading - The factsheet/brochure does not provide enough information about the process/service for the customer to make an informed decision, understand if they are eligible and/or do the next step. Customers must search online or contact support to get more information. - The factsheet/brochure may be misleading (e.g. by leading customers to believe they are eligible when they are not).	There is rarely enough information The factsheet/brochure rarely provides enough information about the process/service for the customer to make an informed decision, understand if they are eligible and/or do the next step. Most customers need to search online or contact support to get more information.	There is sometimes enough information The factsheet/brochure sometimes provides enough information about the process/service for the customer to make an informed decision, understand if they are eligible and/or do the next step. However, many customers need to search online or contact support for more information.	There is usually enough information The factsheet/brochure usually provides enough information about the process/service for the customer to make an informed decision, understand if they are eligible and/or do the next step. However, some customers may need to search online or contact support for more information.	There is enough information The factsheet/brochure provides enough information about the process/service for the customer to make an informed decision, understand if they are eligible and/or do the next step. Customers rarely need to search online or contact support for more information.

1.9 Check eligibility

Checking eligibility for a government service, licence or benefit

- Reading eligibility criteria for a rebate
- Using an online eligibility checker

1.9.1 Check eligibility

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Eligibility criteria Is there a decision aid or clear eligibility criteria to help	There is no decision aid nor eligibility criteria No eligibility criteria nor	There are eligibility criteria, but they are unclear Eligibility criteria is difficult to	There are clear eligibility criteria Eligibility criteria is clearly listed on the form or relevant	There is a decision aid Eligibility criteria is provided in a static decision aid (e.g. a	There is a decision aid, and it is very clear An interactive decision aid

customers determine their eligibility?	decision aid is provided. Customers do not find out if they are eligible until after they have applied.	find or understand, making it difficult for customers to determine their own eligibility (e.g. it is hidden in the fine print of a form or website).	website.	checklist or list of questions) that helps customers determine their eligibility easily.	(e.g. an online eligibility checker) helps customers determine their eligibility seamlessly. Customers are directed to use the decision aid to determine their eligibility before they apply (or early in the application process).
Automated eligibility check Where possible, is the eligibility check automated?	It is not at all automated Customers must answer all eligibility questions, regardless of what information they have already provided. Other available customer data could have been used to automate some or all parts of the eligibility check, e.g. customers validate their ID, but neither the data on the ID nor other available customer data is used to automatically answer eligibility questions.	It is somewhat automated, using data provided by customer Eligibility is checked using data provided by the customer in the application. However, existing customer data could have been used to automate the eligibility check, e.g. customers validate their ID, but its data is not linked to other available customer data.	It is mostly automated, using available data Some eligibility questions are automatically answered using existing customer data e.g. the customer validates their ID, and some eligibility questions are automatically answered. However, there are other eligibility questions that could have been answered with other available customer data.	It is automated Eligibility is checked automatically using existing customer data and some additional customer input, e.g. the customer validates their ID, and some eligibility questions are automatically answered based on data from the ID and other available customer data.	It is effectively automated, using all sources of possible data Eligibility is checked automatically using existing customer data' and minimal additional customer input (if any), e.g. where eligibility is determined using information on an existing customer account and a validated ID.
Easy to understand Are the eligibility criteria easy to understand?	It is very hard to understand The eligibility criteria is not written in plain English. It contains extensive unexplained and unnecessary complex terminology that is very hard to understand.	It is hard to understand The eligibility criteria is not written in plain English. It contains unexplained and unnecessary complex terminology that is hard to understand.	It is mostly easy to understand Most of the eligibility criteria and/or decision aid is in plain English, but it may not be personalised (e.g. it does not use first-person pronouns). There is some unexplained complex terminology that is hard to understand.	It is easy to understand The eligibility criteria/decision aid is written in plain English and is personalised (e.g. it uses first-person pronouns). However, there may be some unexplained complex terminology that it is hard to understand.	It is very easy to understand The eligibility criteria/decision aid is written in plain English and is personalised (e.g. it uses first-person pronouns). Any complex terminology has been replaced or is clearly explained so it is very easy to understand.
Ineligibility data How many customers are rejected due to ineligibility?	Many customers are rejected 20%+ of customers' applications are rejected due to ineligibility.	Some customers are rejected 10-20% of customers' applications are rejected due to ineligibility.	A few customers are rejected 5-10% of customers' applications are rejected due to ineligibility.	Very few customers are rejected 0-5% of customers' applications are rejected due to ineligibility.	No customers are rejected No customers' applications are rejected due to ineligibility.

1.10 Use website FAQs

Viewing or reading a FAQ page on a website

- Reading FAQs about an application process
- Reading FAQs about a service or licence

1.10.1 Design and navigation

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Structure Are the FAQs structured logically and clearly?	It has little to no structure • Questions/issues are not grouped nor ordered logically. The most common questions are not highlighted nor ordered first. • Questions with multiple answers are not organised and are spread across different pages.	It is structured poorly • Some questions/issues are grouped, but with little logical flow. The most common questions are not clearly highlighted or ordered first. • Questions with multiple answers are generally not organised and are sometimes spread across different pages.	It is structured reasonably well • Most questions/issues are grouped, but some are out of place or not ordered logically. The most common questions are highlighted or ordered first. • Questions with multiple answers are mostly organised and merged under one article/response.	It is structured well • Most questions/issues are clearly grouped and ordered logically, with the most common questions highlighted or ordered first. • Questions with multiple answers are organised and generally merged under one article/response.	It is structured very well • All questions/issues are clearly grouped and ordered logically, with the most common questions clearly highlighted and ordered first. • Questions with multiple answers are clearly organised and always merged under one article/response.
Formatting Is formatting used to help customers find answers quickly?	It is not used at all • No subheadings are used to help customers quickly find answers to their questions. • There is limited white space on the FAQs. It is cluttered. There may be elements that distract the customer or are used ineffectively, making it difficult to find or understand information. • Information is not broken up into small chunks. It is bulky, with little to no use of headings, lists, tables or boxes to help customers identify and understand key information quickly.	It is sometimes used • Some subheadings are used to help customers find answers to their questions, but they are vague (e.g. "Information about the process"). • There is limited white space, making the FAQs difficult to read or identify key information. It is cluttered. • Information is broken up to make the FAQs easier to read, but there are no clear headings, lists, tables or boxes to help customers identify and understand key information quickly.	It is used • Subheadings are used to help customers find answers to their questions, but they are either too long, too short, or not descriptive enough • There is some white space around and between text to make the FAQs readable. However, some elements (e.g. images, boxes, tables) are too close together, causing clutter. • Information is structured using chunking, lists, tables and/or boxes, but it can be hard to identify and understand key information quickly.	It is used well • Subheadings are used to help customers quickly find answers to their questions. The subheadings are short and descriptive, but do not clearly speak to different kinds of customers who visit the FAQs. • White space is used consistently to balance elements across the FAQs. However, there may be some clutter caused by other elements (e.g. images, boxes, tables) being too close together. • Information is structured effectively using chunking, lists, tables and/or boxes, making it easy to identify and understand key information quickly.	It is used very well • Subheadings are used effectively to help customers quickly find answers to their questions. The subheadings are short, descriptive, and clearly speak to different kinds of customers who visit the FAQs (e.g. customers applying for a new licence vs. customers renewing a licence). • White space is used consistently to balance elements across the FAQs. • Information is structured effectively using chunking, lists, tables and/or boxes, making it very easy to identify and understand key information quickly.
Visual techniques Are visual techniques used to highlight and communicate	None are used • No visual techniques are used, making it hard to	Some are used • Some visual techniques are used to highlight key	They are used • Visual techniques are used to highlight key information,	They are used well • Visual techniques are used effectively to make it easy to	They are used clearly and effectively • Visual techniques (e.g.

information?	identify and understand key information. No icons are used.	information, but they are confusing, overused or unhelpful. Icons, if used, do not help customers navigate or understand content.	but some may be confusing, overused or unhelpful. Icons are used to help customers navigate and understand content, but some may be unclear or poorly positioned.	identify and understand key information. Icons are used to help customers navigate and understand content, but some may not be immediately recognisable.	colouring, bolding, icons) are used effectively to make it easy to quickly identify and understand key information. Immediately recognisable icons are used to help customers navigate and understand content.
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1.10.2 Content

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Simplicity Are the FAQs written in plain English?	They are not - The FAQs are very difficult to understand due to passive voice, long sentences/words and jargon/inconsistent terms. - Most or all responses/articles have unnecessary information that does not directly relate to the question. - Flesch reading ease score: < 50.	They mostly are not - Some of content in the FAQs is written in plain English, with active voice and short sentences. However, most of the content is still difficult to understand (e.g. due to jargon, long sentences/words, inconsistent terms). - Many responses/articles have unnecessary information that does not directly relate to the question. - Flesch reading ease score: 50-54.	They mostly are - Most of the content in the FAQs is written in plain English, with active voice and short sentences. However, some parts may be hard to understand (e.g. due to jargon and/or long sentences/words and/or inconsistent terms). Some technical terms may not be explained. - Some responses/articles have unnecessary information that does not directly relate to the question. - Flesch reading ease score: 55-60.	They almost all are - The FAQs are written in plain English, with active voice, consistent language and short sentences. All technical terms are explained, but some explanations may be hard to understand. - Some responses/articles may have unnecessary information that does not directly relate to the question. - Flesch reading ease score: 61-70.	They are - The FAQs are entirely written in plain English, with active voice, consistent language and short sentences. All technical terms are explained consistently and clearly, making it easy for all customers to understand. - There is little to no unnecessary information. All responses/articles directly relate to the question. - There are different language options for the most common customer languages. They are professionally translated and easy to access/switch between. - Flesch reading ease score: 70+.
Clarity Are responses to the FAQs relevant and easy to read?	They are very irrelevant and hard to read Most or all responses in the FAQs are irrelevant. They do not answer common customer questions, or do not answer them fully. Where they would be appropriate, no step-by-step instructions are provided.	They are mostly irrelevant and hard to read Some responses in the FAQs address and answer common customer questions, but most are unnecessary or do not fully answer the question. Where they would be appropriate, no step-by-step instructions are provided.	They are sometimes irrelevant and hard to read Most responses in the FAQs clearly address and answer common customer questions, but some may be unnecessary or do not fully answer the question. Where appropriate, some responses give step-by-step instructions.	They are mostly relevant and easy to read - Almost all responses in the FAQs clearly address and answer common customer questions. Where appropriate, responses give clear step-by-step instructions. - The FAQs are broken up into	They are all relevant and easy to read - All responses in the FAQs clearly address and answer common customer questions. Where appropriate, responses give clear step-by-step instructions. - The FAQs are broken up into

	- The FAQs have bulk text and/or paragraphs are very long, with multiple topics (e.g. 5+ sentences). - Where they would be helpful, no bullet points nor numbered lists are used to structure information.	- The FAQs are mostly broken up into chunks, but the paragraphs are long, with multiple topics (e.g. 4+ sentences). - Bullet points and/or numbered lists are used, but they are too long or hard to read (e.g. due to cramped formatting).	- The FAQs are mostly broken up into chunks, but some paragraphs are long or have multiple topics. - Bullet points and/or numbered lists are used appropriately to list key information.	clear, readable chunks. Most paragraphs are one to two sentences with one topic. Bullet points and/or numbered lists are used appropriately to list and highlight key information.	clear, readable chunks. All paragraphs are one to two sentences with one topic. Bullet points and/or numbered lists are used appropriately to list and highlight key information.
Accuracy Is the information accurate and up to date?	It is very inaccurate - Most or all content is inaccurate and/or outdated. - The FAQs are rarely (if ever) updated and there is no process in place to update them.	It is inaccurate - Some content is inaccurate and/or outdated. - The FAQs are updated on an ad hoc basis.	It is mostly accurate - Most content is accurate and up to date. - The FAQs are updated on an ad hoc basis.	It is accurate - All content is accurate and up to date. - There is a process in place to update the FAQs occasionally.	It is very accurate - All content is accurate and up to date. - There is a process in place to update the FAQs regularly.

1.10.1 Outcome

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Resolution Do customers enquire about issues that are addressed in the FAQs?	Frequently Customers frequently contact support to ask questions that are answered in the FAQs.	Usually Customers usually contact support to ask questions that are answered in the FAQs.	Sometimes Customers sometimes contact support to ask questions that are answered in the FAQs.	Rarely Customers rarely contact support to ask questions that are answered in the FAQs.	Never, or almost never Customers never or almost never contact support to ask questions that are answered in the FAQs.
Feedback Can customers provide feedback on the FAQs?	No channels for customers to provide feedback - Customers cannot provide feedback. - There is no process in place for staff to monitor, review, action nor respond to customer feedback.	No clear channels for customers to provide feedback - There is no clear way for customers to provide feedback. - Staff monitor, review and action customer feedback on an ad hoc basis.	Customers can provide feedback, but channels are hard to access and not transparent - Customers can provide feedback, but the channels are not easily accessible. - There is a process in place for staff to occasionally monitor, review and action customer feedback.	Customers can provide feedback through accessible channels - Customers can provide feedback through easily accessible channels. - There is a process in place for staff to regularly monitor, review, action and respond to customer feedback.	Customers can provide feedback through easily accessible, transparent, channels - Customers are encouraged to provide feedback and channels are easily accessible, transparent, and promoted. - There is a process in place for staff to quickly monitor, review, action and respond to customer feedback.

2 Seeking and navigating



In this section

[2.1 Search for a website](#)

[2.2 Navigate website](#)

[2.3 Use phone app](#)

Categories



1 Reading and understanding



2 Seeking and navigating



3 Preparing or providing information



4 Interacting



5 Help seeking



6 Waiting



7 Deciding



8 Miscellaneous



9 Non-customer actions

2.1 Search for a website

Searching for and accessing a website

- Using Google to search for and access a website
- Using the search bar on a government website to find information

2.1.1 Search and access

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Search Is it easy to search for the website?	It is very difficult • The website is very hard to search for on Google. Exact wording is needed. • The website is not linked on a government website. • It takes more than two clicks to navigate to the relevant webpage from the search results.	It is difficult • The website is hard to search for on Google. Exact wording is needed. • The website is linked on a government website. • Customers can navigate to the relevant webpage from the search results in two clicks.	It is sometimes difficult • The website is moderately easy to search for on Google. 3-5 keywords are needed. • The website is linked on multiple government websites. • Customers can navigate to the relevant webpage from the search results in one click.	It is easy • The website is easy to search for on Google. Only 2-3 keywords are needed. • The website is linked and promoted on multiple government websites. • Customers can navigate to the relevant webpage from the search results in one click.	It is very easy • The website is very easy to search for on Google. Only 1-2 keywords are needed. • The website is linked and promoted on multiple government websites and other websites. • Customers can navigate to the relevant webpage from the search results in one click.
Access Is the website easy to access?	It is very difficult • Customers almost always experience problems accessing the website. • Relevant information is very difficult to find, with many customers dropping off.	It is difficult • Customers often experience problems accessing the website. • Relevant information is difficult to find, with some customers dropping off.	It is mostly easy • Customers sometimes experience problems accessing the website. • Relevant information is sometimes difficult to find, with customers occasionally dropping off	It is easy • Customers rarely experience problems accessing the website. • Relevant information is easy to find, with customers rarely dropping off.	It is very easy • Customers almost never experience problems accessing the website. • Relevant information is highlighted and very easy to find, with customers almost never dropping off.
Headings Does the website have clear headings to help the customer navigate?	It does not • The webpages do not have headings, making it very difficult for customers to find the information they are looking for.	It does, but they are not very helpful • The webpages have headings, but they are hard to understand and are not descriptive enough for customers to easily find the information they are looking for.	It does, but they may not be helpful • The webpages have headings, but they are sometimes hard to understand or do not accurately describe the information on the webpage.	It does, and they are generally helpful • The webpages have short and descriptive headings that generally make it easy for customers to find the information they are looking for.	It does, and they are very helpful • The webpages have very clear and descriptive headings, making it easy for customers to quickly find the information they are looking for.

2.2 Navigate website

Navigating to specific webpage(s) on a website to find information or the next step in a process

- Navigating a website to find an application form
- Navigating to find instructions

2.2.1 Navigation

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Navigation Is the website easy to move through?	It is very difficult • The menu bar is difficult to find and use. There are 12+ menu items that are not chunked appropriately using dropdown menus. • There are many dead/broken links that make site navigation difficult. Links are not organised logically nor based on what links are used most.	It is difficult • Customers can access a menu bar to navigate the website, but it is sometimes hard to find. There are 9+ menu items that are not chunked appropriately using dropdown menus. • There are some dead/broken links that impact site navigation. Links are not organised logically nor based on what links are used most.	It is sometimes difficult • Customers can access a menu bar to navigate the website. There are 7+ menu items that are not chunked appropriately using dropdown menus, or the dropdown menus are unclear. • There are a few dead/broken links that sometimes impact site navigation. Links are ordered but not optimised based on what links are used most.	It is easy • Customers can access a menu bar to quickly navigate the website. There are 5-7 menu items, or they are chunked appropriately using clear dropdown menus. • There are very few dead/broken links, and they have minimal impact on site navigation. Links are organised and usually optimised based on what links are used most.	It is very easy • Customers can easily see and access the main menu bar to quickly navigate the website. There are no more than 5-7 menu items, or they are chunked effectively using clear dropdown menus. • There are no dead/broken links. Links are organised and optimised based on what links are used most.
Links Does the website have hyperlinks/navigation buttons to help customers find relevant content/information quickly?	It does not • No hyperlinks/navigation buttons are used, making it very difficult for customers to navigate the website and find relevant content.	It mostly does not • Few hyperlinks/navigation buttons are used, making it difficult for customers to navigate the website and find relevant content.	It does, but they are unclear • Some hyperlinks/navigation buttons help customers to find relevant content. • Linked information may not be described clearly.	It does, and they are clear • Hyperlinks/navigation buttons make it easy for customers to find relevant content. • Linked information is described clearly.	It does, and they are very clear • Hyperlinks/navigation buttons make it easy for customers to seamlessly navigate the website and find the content they need. • Linked information is described very clearly.
Ease of use Is the website information easy to access?	It is very difficult to access • Information, images and terminology are inconsistent and unclear to most customers. • Relevant information is scattered across multiple sites and is very hard to find.	It is difficult to access • Information, images and terminology are inconsistent and unclear to some customers. • Relevant information is spread across multiple sites and is hard to find.	It is generally easy to access • Information, images and terminology are consistent and clear to most customers. • Relevant information is spread across one or two other sites, but is mostly easy to find.	It is easy to access • Information, images and terminology are consistent and clear to almost all customers. • All information required to inform, make a decision or progress to the next step is in one place with minimal	It is very easy to access • Information, images and terminology are consistent and clear to all customers. • All information required to inform, make a decision or progress to the next step is in one place with no navigation required.

	- The site does not have a search function. - There are no FAQs (or similar).	- The site has a search function, but it may be difficult to find or difficult to use. Search results are difficult to navigate. - There are FAQs (or similar), but they do not address most common concerns and are difficult to access.	- The site has a search function, but it is sometimes difficult to use. Search results are mostly easy to navigate. - There are FAQs (or similar) that address some common concerns but may not be easily visible and/or accessible.	need for navigation. - The site has a search function that is easy to use. Search results are easy to navigate. - There are FAQs (or similar) that address most common concerns and are visible/accessible.	- The site has a search function that is very easy and intuitive to use. Search results are very easy to navigate. - There are FAQs (or similar) that address all common concerns and are easily visible/accessible.
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2.3 Use phone app

Using a smart phone app to find information and complete tasks

- Using apps like Service NSW, FuelCheck and Opal Travel

2.3.1 Design

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Visual design Is the design of the app clear and consistent?	It is not clear at all The app has a confusing and overwhelming appearance, with a cluttered user interface and inconsistent visual design.	It is not clear The app has a confusing appearance, with a cluttered user interface and inconsistent visual design.	It is mostly clear The app has a mostly clear appearance. The visual design may have some clutter. The user interface is mostly consistent throughout the app, but parts of it may not be distinct from the broader design, making it hard to find.	It is clear The app has a clear and attractive appearance, with minimal clutter. The user interface is distinct and consistent throughout the app.	It is very clear The app has a very clear and attractive appearance, with no clutter. The user interface is very distinct and consistent throughout the app.
Text personalisation Is the text size adjustable?	It is very difficult to read Most text is hard to read and customers cannot adjust the size. Most customers have difficulties reading the text.	It can be difficult to read Some text is hard to read and customers cannot adjust the size. Customers often have difficulties reading the text.	It is generally readable The text is mostly easy to read and customers can usually adjust the size to suit their needs. Customers sometimes have difficulties reading the text.	It is easy to read The text is easy to read and customers can adjust the size to suit their needs. Customers rarely have difficulties reading the text.	It is very easy to read The text is very easy to read. Text size is optimised for screen size and customers can easily adjust it to suit their needs.
Formatting Is formatting used to organise information?	It is not used at all The app does not use headings, making it very hard for customers to find what they are looking for.	It is sometimes used The app uses headings, but they are hard to understand and are not descriptive enough for customers to easily find what they are	It is used The app uses headings, but they are sometimes hard to understand or do not accurately describe the information in the section.	It is used well The app uses short and descriptive headings that generally make it easy for customers to find what they are looking for.	It is used very well The app uses very clear and descriptive headings, making it easy for customers to quickly find what they are looking for.

	- There is limited white space, making it difficult to read or identify key information. - There may be features on the app that distract the customer or are used ineffectively, making it difficult to find or understand information. For example, a floating button that gets in the way of content. - No boxes/tables are used to organise information.	looking for. - There is limited white space, making it difficult to read or identify key information. - Boxes/tables are rarely used to organise information and there is clutter caused by elements being too close together.	- There is some white space around and between text to make it readable. - There are some boxes/tables used to organise information. However, there is some clutter caused by elements being too close together.	- There is white space around and between paragraphs to make the text easy to read. - Boxes/tables are used to organise and highlight key information. However, there may be some clutter caused by elements (e.g. images and text) being too close together.	- There is white space around and between paragraphs to make the text easy to read. - There are graphics and boxes/tables to clearly organise and highlight key information. - There is consistent use of white space to balance elements across the page
Visual techniques Are visual techniques used to highlight and communicate information?	None are used - No visual techniques are used. - Icons, if used, are confusing and do not help customers navigate or understand content. There are no help icons.	Some are used - Some visual techniques are used to highlight key information but they are confusing, overused or unhelpful. - Icons, if used, do not help customers navigate or understand content. Help icons, if present, are not easily recognisable or visible.	They are used - Visual techniques are used to highlight key information, but some may be confusing, overused or unhelpful. - Icons are used to help customers navigate and understand content, but some may be unclear or poorly positioned. Help icons are present throughout the app, but may not be appropriately located or immediately recognisable.	They are used well - Visual techniques are used effectively to make it easy to identify and understand key information. - Icons are used to help customers navigate and understand content, but some may not be immediately recognisable. Help icons are visible throughout the app and are appropriately located.	They are used clearly and effectively - Visual techniques (e.g. colouring, bolding, icons) are used effectively to make it easy to quickly identify and understand key information. - Immediately recognisable icons are used to help customers navigate and understand content. Help icons are visible throughout the app and are appropriately located

2.3.2 Language

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Simplicity Does the app use plain English?	It does not use plain English - The app content is very difficult to understand due to long sentences/words, jargon/inconsistent terms, passive voice and/or no personalisation. - Flesch reading ease score: < 50.	It uses some plain English - Some of the app content is written in plain English, with personalisation. However, most of the content is still difficult to understand (e.g. due to jargon, long sentences/words, inconsistent terms). - Flesch reading ease score: 50-54.	It mostly uses plain English - Most of the app content is written in plain English, with personalisation and short sentences. However, some parts may be hard to understand (e.g. due to jargon and/or long sentences/words and/or inconsistent terms). Some technical terms may not be explained. - Flesch reading ease score: 55-60.	It uses plain English throughout - All app content is written in plain English, with personalisation, consistent language and short sentences. All technical terms are explained, but some explanations may be hard to understand. - Flesch reading ease score: 61-70.	It uses plain English effectively throughout - All app content is written in plain English, with personalisation, consistent language and short sentences. All technical terms are explained consistently and clearly, making it easy for all customers to understand. - The app has different language options for the most common customer

					languages. They are professionally translated and easy to access/switch between. Flesch reading ease score: 70+.
Tone Is tone used effectively to guide customers?	It is not used effectively - Most of the app content is written in passive voice (e.g. "Your application will be reviewed by the Department"). - Content does not use personal pronouns. - Positive framing is not used effectively and encourages actions that are not in the customer's best interests.	It is rarely used effectively - Most of the app content is written in the passive voice. Some active sentences provide limited clarity. - The content uses limited personal pronouns, but they do not direct customers. - Positive framing is not used effectively and does not have any impact on customer behaviour.	It is used somewhat effectively - Some of the app content is written in the active voice to help customers understand key information. - Content uses some personal pronouns, but they do not effectively direct customers. - Some positive framing is used, but it has a limited impact on customer behaviour.	It is mostly used effectively - Most of the app content is written in the active voice. However, some passive sentences are used inappropriately. - Content uses personal pronouns to effectively direct customers. - Positive framing is used to encourage and reward action.	It is used very effectively - Most of the app content is written in the active voice (e.g. "The Department will review your application"). Passive voice is used sparingly and where appropriate. - Content uses personal pronouns to quickly engage and direct customers. - Positive framing is used clearly and consistently to encourage and reward action.

2.3.3 Navigation

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Features Do app features assist with navigation?	There are no app features - The app is very hard to navigate, with a user interface that is not intuitive. - The app does not use progress bars or other features to help customers see where they are in the app. - There are no back buttons, so customers must return to the home page if they make a mistake or want to go back. The app has a main menu, but no shortcuts, forcing customers to return to the main screen whenever they want to do something else in app.	There are few app features - The app is hard to navigate, with a user interface that is not intuitive. - The app does not use progress bars or other features to help customers see where they are in the app. - There are no back buttons. Customers must navigate using links, which may not be present on all pages. The app has a main menu, but no shortcuts, forcing customers to return to the main screen whenever they want to do something else in app.	There are some app features - The app is relatively easy to navigate, with a user interface that is intuitive for at least the main pathway in the app. - The app does not use progress bars or other features to help customers see where they are in the app. - There are back buttons on some pages, but they are not immediately visible and customers cannot always go back to easily correct errors. The app may have menus and shortcuts, but they are either not immediately visible	There are helpful app features - The app is simple and easy to navigate, with an intuitive user interface. - There are progress bars and other features to help customers see where they are within the app itself, but they may not be clear to all customers. - There are back buttons at all stages so customers can easily correct errors, but they may not be immediately visible. The app has menus and shortcuts to assist navigation. - Instructions on how to use the app are easy to access	There are very helpful app features - The app is simple and easy to navigate, with an intuitive user interface. - There are progress bars and other features to help customers see where they are at within the app itself. There are back buttons at all stages so customers can easily correct errors. The app has clear menus and shortcuts to assist navigation. - Instructions on how to use the app are easy to access and are clearly written.

	There are no instructions on how to use the app.	Instructions on how to use the app are only available online (not in app).	Instructions on how to use the app are hard to access/find and may not be clearly written.	and are clearly written.	
Ease Is the app easy to navigate and log into?	It is very difficult to navigate - Most buttons and interactive elements are too small and over-/under- sensitive. Menus and shortcuts are very hard to access. - The login page does not have a 'forgot password' button. Customers must register a new account or call for support if they forget their password.	It is difficult to navigate - Many buttons and interactive elements are too small and over-/under-sensitive. - The login page does not have a 'forgot password' button. Customers must register a new account or call for support if they forget their password.	It is usually easy to navigate - Most buttons and interactive elements are sized and calibrated to be easy to use without accidental pressing/swiping, but some may be too small or over-/under-sensitive. - The login page has a 'forgot password' button, but it may not be immediately visible. The process for resetting/retrieving the password is difficult.	It is easy to navigate - Most buttons and interactive elements are sized and calibrated to be easy to use without accidental pressing/swiping. Menus and shortcuts are easy to access. - The login page has clear 'forgot password' button. However, the process for resetting/retrieving the password may be difficult for some customers.	It is very easy to navigate - All buttons and interactive elements are sized and calibrated to be easy to use without accidental pressing/swiping. Menus and shortcuts are easy to access. - The login page has clear 'forgot password' button. The process for resetting/retrieving the password is simple.

2.3.4 Design system

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Operating system Is the app compatible with major operating systems (OS)?	It is not compatible - The app is not compatible with major phones/OS. - The app requires regular updates, which are often incompatible with older OS. - Updating is very difficult, and takes a long time or leads to issues.	It is mostly compatible, with some issues - The app is compatible with most major phones/OS. - The app requires regular updates, which are sometimes incompatible with older OS. - Updating is often difficult, and may take a long time or lead to issues.	It is mostly compatible - The app is compatible with all major phones/OS. - The app requires occasional updates, which are generally compatible with older OS. - Updating is usually easy, but can sometimes take a long time or lead to issues.	It is compatible - The app is compatible with all commonly used phones/OS. - The app requires occasional updates, which are compatible with older OS. - Updating is usually easy, with few issues.	It is always compatible - The app is compatible with all commonly used phones/OS. - The app does not require regular updates, and updates are compatible with older OS. - Updating is always quick and easy.
Speed Is the app quick to load?	It is very slow - App loading times are long (to start up, within the app, and to close down). - The app always lags when the customer switches between the app and other apps.	It is slow - App loading times are long (to start up, within the app, and to close down). - The app often lags when the customer switches between the app and other apps.	It is sometimes slow - Some app loading times are long enough to be noticeable (either to start up, within the app, or to close down). - The app sometimes lags when the customer switches between the app and other	It is quick - The app loads quickly, but it sometimes lags when in use. - The app rarely lags when the customer switches between the app and other apps.	It is very quick - The app loads quickly and rarely lags when in use. - The app does not lag when the customer switches between the app and other apps.

			apps.		
Smooth functioning	The app has significant errors	The app has some errors	The app has minor errors	The app has few errors	The app does not have errors
Does the app have many errors?	- The app frequently freezes or crashes. - The app has bugs that significantly impact the user experience. - Technical support and error reporting is not available, or is very hard to access.	- The app occasionally freezes or crashes. - The app has bugs that occasionally impact the user experience. - Technical support and error reporting is available, but it is hard to access and fill out.	- The app does not freeze or crash. - The app has minor bugs that do not impact the user experience. - Technical support and error reporting is available, but may be hard to access or fill out.	- The app does not freeze or crash. - The app has no bugs that impact performance and usability. - Technical support and error reporting is easy to access, but may be time consuming to fill out.	- The app does not freeze or crash. - The app has no bugs that impact performance and usability. - Technical support and error reporting is quick and easy to access.

3 Preparing or providing information



In this section

- [3.1 Complete form](#)
- [3.2 Gather documents](#)
- [3.3 Provide documents](#)
- [3.4 Apply for rebate](#)
- [3.5 Provide consent](#)
- [3.6 Login or enter password](#)

Categories



1 Reading and understanding



2 Seeking and navigating



3 Preparing or providing information



4 Interacting



5 Help seeking



6 Waiting



7 Deciding



8 Miscellaneous



9 Non-customer actions

3.1 Complete form

Completing a form to apply for a government service, licence or benefit

- Applying for a licence, like a trade licence or a real estate licence
- Applying for financial assistance, like grants and rebates

3.1.1 Access and requirements

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Ease of access Is the form easy to find and access?	It is very difficult • The form is very difficult to find (e.g. because the hyperlink/button to access it is small and hidden within bulk text). Customers frequently contact support asking for the form or where to find it. • The form is not available online. Only PDF and/or physical/printed formats are available. • If there are multiple variations of the form, they are not labelled or described. Customers are unsure which one they need to complete. Many customers complete wrong form.	It is difficult • The form is difficult to find (e.g. because the hyperlink/button to access it is small and not immediately visible). Customers often contact support asking for the form or where to find it. • The form is available online and in at least one other format (e.g. PDF). Some parts of the form may not work properly in some formats. • If there are multiple variations of the form, they are labelled so customers can identify which one they need to complete. However, the labels are unclear (e.g. because they do not concisely describe who the form is meant for).	It is somewhat easy • The form is easy for most customers to find. Customers sometimes contact support asking for the form or where to find it. • The form is available online and in at least one other format (e.g. PDF). The form works properly in all available formats, but is not fully optimised (e.g. because it scales poorly on small screens). • If there are multiple variations of the form, they are labelled and described so customers can identify which one they need to complete. However, some labels/descriptions are hard to understand (e.g. due to jargon, long sentences).	It is easy • The form is easy to find. Customers rarely contact support asking for the form or where to find it. • The form is available online and in other formats (e.g. PDF and physical/printed). The form works properly in all available formats, but may not be fully optimised (e.g. because the online form scales poorly on small screens). • If there are multiple variations of the form, they are labelled and described clearly so customers can identify which one they need to complete.	It is very easy • The form is very easy to find. Customers almost never (if ever) contact support asking for the form or where to find it. • The form is available online and in other formats (e.g. PDF and physical/printed). The form is optimised to work well in all available formats. • If there are multiple variations of the form (e.g. one for individuals and one for businesses), they are labelled and described clearly so customers can quickly identify which one they need to complete.
Preparation Are customers given information to help them prepare to complete the form?	They are not • Customers are not told what documents and information they need to complete the form. • Customers are either not given an estimate of how long the form takes to complete, or are given a very inaccurate estimate (over- or	They are, but it is unclear • Customers are told what documents and information they need to complete the form, but it is unclear (e.g. because there is not enough detail, and the information is in bulk text). • Customers are not given an estimate of how long the	They are, but it is slightly unclear • Customers are given a list of what documents and information they need to complete the form, but it may be slightly unclear (e.g. because there is not enough detail). • Customers are given an	They are, and it is clear • Customers are given a clear list of what documents and information they need to complete the form. • Customers are given an accurate estimate of how long the form takes to complete. The estimate is based on the perceived time	They are, and it is very clear • Customers are given a very clear list of what documents and information they need to complete the form. • Customers are given a very accurate estimate of how long the form takes to complete. The estimate is informed by user data/user

	under-estimated by over 10 minutes).	form takes to complete.	estimate of how long the form takes to complete, but it may be within a large range (e.g. 10-30 minutes) or slightly inaccurate.	it takes to complete the form.	testing.
Access to support Is it easy to access support?	It is very difficult - No, or very limited assistance/access to support is offered. - Channels for accessing support are inappropriate, and very difficult to access and use - The customer cannot select a preferred channel for further communication	It is difficult - Assistance or access to support is very unclear. - Channels for accessing support are difficult for most customers to access and use. - Other channels are available, but this is not communicated to the customer.	It is mostly easy - Assistance and access to support is offered. - Channels for accessing support are difficult for some customers to access and use. - The customer can choose a preferred channel, but the process is difficult and/or not communicated clearly.	It is easy - Assistance and access to support is clearly signposted in an appropriate location. - Channels for accessing support are easy for most customers to access and use. - The customer can choose a preferred channel and the steps for doing so are communicated.	It is very easy - Assistance and access to support is very clearly signposted in an appropriate location. - Channels for accessing support are easy for all customers to access and use. - The customer can choose a preferred channel and the steps for doing so are very clearly and consistently communicated.

3.1.2 Form design

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Structure Is formatting used to structure information clearly?	It is not used at all - Questions are not broken up into sections, making the form hard to navigate, understand and complete quickly. - There is little white space on the form. It is cluttered and hard to read. - The form uses bulk text. Very few (or no) boxes, lists or tables are used to highlight key information or structure complicated questions/requirements. - The form page is formatted with two or more columns.	It is sometimes used - Questions are broken up into sections, but there are either no headings or the headings are not descriptive (e.g. "Section A"). - There is some white space around and between sections/questions, but it is inconsistent and there is clutter caused by some elements being close together. - Few boxes, lists or tables are used to highlight key information or structure complicated questions/requirements. - The form page is formatted with two columns.	It is used - Questions are broken up into sections with headings, but they may be unclear. - There is white space around and between sections/questions, but there is clutter caused by some elements being too close together. - Some boxes, lists and/or tables are used to highlight key information and structure complicated questions/requirements. - The form page is formatted as a single column.	It is used well - Questions are broken up into clear sections with descriptive headings, making the form easy to navigate, understand and complete. - There is white space around and between sections/questions to make the form easy to read. However it may be slightly inconsistent. - Boxes, lists and/or tables are used to highlight key information and structure complicated questions/requirements. - The form page is formatted as a single column.	It is used very well - Questions are broken up into clear sections with short descriptive headings (e.g. "Your details"), making the form easy to navigate, understand and complete quickly. - There is white space around and between sections/questions to make the form easy to read. - Boxes, lists and/or tables are used to highlight key information and structure complicated questions/requirements. - The form page is formatted as a single column.

Visual techniques Are visual techniques used to highlight and communicate information?	They are not used - No visual techniques are used. - Icons, if used, are confusing and do not help customers navigate or understand content. There are no help icons. - All answer boxes are too small or too large. They cannot be adjusted.	Some are used - Some visual techniques are used to highlight key information/questions but they are confusing, overused or unhelpful. - Icons, if used, are confusing and do not help customers navigate or understand the form. Help icons, if present, are not easily recognisable or visible. - Most answer boxes are too small or too large. For online forms, the boxes adjust slightly, but the customer must do this manually (e.g. by clicking and dragging the corner of the box outwards).	They are used - Visual techniques are used to highlight key information/questions, but some may be confusing, overused or unhelpful. - Icons are used to help customers navigate and understand the form, but some may be confusing. For online forms, there are interactive help icons, but they may not be appropriately located or immediately recognisable. - Some answer boxes are slightly too small or too large, but most customers can fit their answers inside easily. For online forms, the boxes expand slightly when filled.	They are used well - Visual techniques are used effectively to make it easy to identify and understand key information/questions. - Icons are used to help customers navigate and understand the form, but some may not be immediately recognisable. For online forms, interactive help icons are visible throughout the form and are appropriately located. - Most answer boxes are appropriately sized, informed by perceived typical answer lengths. For online forms, the boxes expand automatically when filled.	They are used clearly and effectively - Questions are broken up into clear sections with short descriptive headings (e.g. "Your details"), making the form easy to navigate, understand and complete quickly. - There is white space around and between sections/questions to make the form easy to read. - Boxes, lists and/or tables are used to highlight key information and structure complicated questions/requirements. - The form page is formatted as a single column.
Guidance Does the form provide instructions to help customers understand and respond to questions?	It does not - The form provides no guidance for questions, or the guidance is unclear and misleading. - No example answers are provided.	It does, but it is unclear - The form provides guidance for some questions, but it is unclear and/or misleading. - Guidance is not positioned near the relevant question (e.g. guidance for all questions is provided at the start of the form). - Little to no examples are provided to demonstrate how to answer questions. Customers often provide too much or too little information.	It does - The form provides guidance for some questions. - Guidance is positioned near the relevant question, but it may not be immediately recognisable/visible. - Some example answers are provided to demonstrate how to answer questions, but they lack detail, causing customers to sometimes provide too much or too little information.	It does, and it is clear - The form provides guidance for most questions. - Guidance is positioned directly underneath or next to the relevant question so the customer can quickly reference it as they complete the form. - Clear example answers are provided to demonstrate how to answer questions, but some examples lack detail.	It does, and it is clear and effective - The form provides clear guidance for all questions. - Guidance is positioned directly underneath or next to the relevant question so the customer can quickly reference it as they complete the form. - Clear and detailed example answers are provided to demonstrate how to answer questions (level of detail, format etc.).
Features Does the form use digital features to help customers complete the form quickly and prevent errors?	The form is not available digitally The form is not available online, so does not have digital features like pre-filling, browser autofill, auto-validation, auto-navigation, radio buttons, checkboxes, or dropdown fields.	The form uses very limited digital features No answers are pre-filled using existing customer data. Customers must provide information that they have already provided elsewhere.	The form uses some digital features - Where possible, some answers are pre-filled using existing customer data. Customers may not be able to edit the pre-filled answers. - The form is mostly	The form uses digital features effectively - Where possible, some answers are pre-filled using existing customer data. Customers can edit the pre-filled answers. - The form is compatible with	The form uses digital features very effectively Where possible, answers are pre-filled using existing customer data (e.g. from an existing customer profile or previous form). Customers can edit the pre-filled answers.

		- The form is not compatible with browser autofill. - The form may auto-validate some answers, but it does not display error messages. - There is no auto-navigation. - No radio buttons, checkboxes and dropdown fields are used. Customers must type all answers.	compatible with browser autofill, meaning the browser can suggest and autofill answers for fields like name and email using saved data. - The form auto-validates some answers (e.g. by checking the format of email addresses and phone numbers). The form displays error messages, but they are unclear and do not explain why the answers are invalid nor how to fix them. - There is no auto-navigation. - Some radio buttons, checkboxes and dropdown fields are used to prevent errors. However, some options are unclear or missing.	browser autofill, meaning the browser can suggest and autofill answers for fields like name and email using saved data. - Where possible, the form auto-validates answers (e.g. by checking the format of email addresses and phone numbers). The form displays error messages, but they may not fully explain why the answers are invalid or how to fix them. - Auto-navigation (e.g. auto-scrolling to the next question) mostly works well and is intuitive. - Radio buttons, checkboxes and dropdown fields are used to prevent errors. However, some options may be unclear.	- The form is compatible with browser autofill, meaning the browser can suggest and autofill answers for fields like name and email using saved data. - Where possible, the form auto-validates answers (e.g. by checking the format of email addresses and phone numbers). The form displays clear error messages. - Auto-navigation (e.g. auto-scrolling to the next question) works well and is intuitive. - Radio buttons, checkboxes and dropdown fields are used effectively to prevent errors. All options are inclusive, described clearly, and easy to understand.
Progress Can the customer see and save their progress?	They cannot - There is no progress bar nor page labels (e.g. "Page 1 of 6") to help customers understand how much of the form has been completed and how much is left. - Customers cannot save their progress on the form. If customers leave the form for too long, it times out and resets, forcing them to start again.	They can, but only at certain points - There is no progress bar, but there are page labels (e.g. "Page 1 of 6") that help customers understand where they are in the form and how much is left. - Customers cannot save their progress on the form, but so long as they do not close it, they can come back to it later.	They can, but it may be difficult - There is a progress bar showing how much of the form has been completed, but it is hard to see (e.g. because it is small or low contrast). - Customers can save their progress on the form, close it, and then finish it later, but the process is difficult.	They can, and it is easy - There is a progress bar showing how much of the form has been completed, but it may be slightly hard to see (e.g. because it is small or low contrast). - Customers can save their progress on the form, close it, and then finish it later. The process is relatively easy.	They can, and it is very easy - There is a clear progress bar showing how much of the form has been completed. - Customers can easily save their progress on the form, close it, and then finish it later.

3.1.3 Questions and language

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Clarity Are the questions clear and organised?	They are not More than 10% of questions are long and/or double-barrelled.	They are somewhat More than 5% of questions are long and/or double-barrelled.	They are mostly - All questions are focused, but some may be too long. - Most questions are grouped	They are almost always - All questions are short and clearly focused. - Most questions are clearly	They are all clear and organised All questions are short and clearly focused. There are no double-barrelled questions.

	Questions are not grouped or ordered logically.	Some questions are grouped, but the order is mostly disorganised.	logically, but some are out of place.	grouped and ordered logically.	All questions are clearly grouped and ordered logically.
Necessity Are all questions in the form necessary?	Many questions are unnecessary - More than 10% of questions are irrelevant and/or ask for excessive information. - Most or all information could have been collected from other sources.	Some questions are unnecessary - More than 5% of questions are irrelevant and/or ask for excessive information. - Most information could have been collected from other sources. There may be some duplicate questions.	Most questions are necessary - Almost all questions are relevant and do not ask for excessive information. - Some information could have been collected from other sources. There are no duplicate questions.	Almost all questions are necessary - All questions are relevant and do not ask for excessive information. - Very little information could have been collected from other sources. There are no duplicate questions.	All questions are necessary - All questions are relevant and do not ask for excessive information. - Information is only requested if it cannot reasonably be collected from other sources (e.g. from partner agencies or existing customer profiles). There are no duplicate questions.
Language Is the language in the form clear?	It is very unclear - Most of the form is written with very complex and inconsistent language. The form is very difficult to understand (e.g. due to unexplained jargon, inconsistent terminology). There is a lot of unnecessary information. - No personal pronouns are used to direct customers to sections/questions they need to complete. - Most sentences are written in the passive voice. - Flesch reading ease score: < 50.	It is unclear - Some of the form is written with very complex and inconsistent language. The form is difficult to understand (e.g. due to unexplained jargon, inconsistent terminology). There is a lot of unnecessary information. - Few personal pronouns are used. They do not direct customers to sections/questions they need to complete. - Most sentences are written in the passive voice. Some active sentences provide limited clarity. - Flesch reading ease score: 50-60.	It is somewhat clear - Most of the form is written in plain English, but some parts of the form are difficult to understand (e.g. due to unexplained jargon, inconsistent terminology). There is some unnecessary information. - Some personal pronouns are used, but they do not effectively direct customers to sections/questions they need to complete. - Some of the sentences are written in the passive voice. The active sentences help customers to understand key information. - Flesch reading ease score: 60-70.	It is clear - The whole form is written in plain English. All technical terms are explained consistently. However, there may be some unnecessary information. - Personal pronouns are used to direct customers to sections/questions they need to complete. - Most sentences are written in the active voice. However, some passive sentences are used inappropriately. - Flesch reading ease score: 70-80.	It is very clear - The whole form is written in plain English. All technical terms are explained clearly and consistently. Sentences are clear and concise, with no unnecessary information. - Personal pronouns (e.g. you/your, me/my) are used to direct customers to sections/questions they need to complete. - Most sentences are written in the active voice. The passive sentences are used sparingly and where appropriate. - Flesch reading ease score: 80+ (or 70+ for technical/detailed topics).

3.1.4 Next steps

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Confirmation Is the form submission confirmed quickly?	It is not confirmed, or is confirmed after a very long delay	It is confirmed after a long delay Confirmation is delayed (not within 10 minutes).	It is confirmed after a short delay Confirmation is not	It is confirmed quickly Confirmation is almost instantaneous (1 to 5	It is confirmed very quickly Confirmation is effectively instantaneous (less than 1

	There is no confirmation, or it is very delayed (more than 24 hours).		instantaneous (5 to 10 minutes).	minutes).	minute).
Next steps Are the next steps clear?	The next steps are very unclear No information is provided about the next steps.	The next steps are unclear There is little information provided about the next steps, or it is very unclear and hard to find.	The next steps are sometimes unclear Some information is provided about the next steps either in the confirmation, online, or in other resources. However, some information is unclear or hard to find.	The next steps are clear The confirmation provides clear information about the next steps. However, this information may not be available online and/or in other resources.	The next steps are very clear The confirmation provides clear information about the next steps, including the waiting period, how to check on the status of the form/application, and contact information. This information is also available online and/or in other resources.

3.2 Gather documents

Gathering documents required for an application. Includes actions to prepare documents, like scanning and printing

- Finding and scanning qualifications for an application
- Getting quotes for a service or product

3.2.1 Gather documents

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Checklist Are customers given a checklist or interactive tool to help them gather documents?	No Customers are not given any checklist or tool to help them gather documents. Customers are unsure what documents they need.	Yes, but it is unclear Customers are given a checklist to help them understand what documents they need to gather, but it is unclear and hard to use (e.g. it is a digital checklist where the boxes cannot be 'checked off').	Yes, but it may be unclear Customers are given a checklist to help them understand what documents they need to gather, but it may be slightly unclear or hard to use (e.g. due to small font/boxes, no categorisation).	Yes, and it is clear Customers are guided through the document gathering process by a clear checklist or interactive tool.	Yes, and it is personalised and very clear Customers are guided through the document gathering process by a personalised checklist or interactive tool. It is very clear and easy to use.
Instructions Are there clear instructions?	Instructions are very unclear - Customers are given no instructions, or the instructions are very unclear. They do not specify what documents/file types are accepted, or how customers can provide them. - The instructions are very	Instructions are unclear - Customers are given instructions on what documents are required and how to provide them, but they do not include important information about file types or other requirements. - The instructions are hard to	Instructions may be unclear - Customers are given instructions on what documents are required and how to provide them, but they may be dense or confusing. - Some instructions may be hard to understand due to	Instructions are clear - Customers are given clear instructions on exactly what documents are required and how to provide them. - The instructions are mostly written in plain English and are easy to understand.	Instructions are very clear - Customers are given clear instructions on exactly what documents are required and how to provide them. - The instructions are written in plain English and are very easy to understand.

	hard to understand due to complex language, jargon, and passive voice. It is unclear what documents and file types are valid/invalid. Many customers gather documents that are invalid.	understand due to complex language, jargon, or passive voice. It is unclear what documents and file types are valid/invalid.	complex language, jargon, or passive voice. It may be unclear what documents and file types are valid/invalid.	It is clear what documents and file types are valid/invalid. Some visual techniques are used to show what documents are valid and/or invalid.	It is very clear what documents and file types are valid/invalid. Visual techniques are used to show what documents are valid/invalid (e.g. pictures/photos of examples, tick and cross icons, colouring).
Rationale Is it clear why documents are needed and how they will be used?	It is very unclear - The instructions do not include an explanation for why the documents are needed or how they will be used. - Document requirements are excessive, irrelevant and/or unreasonably intrude on the customer's personal affairs.	It is unclear The instructions include an explanation for why some documents are needed, but it is unclear how they will be used.	It is mostly clear The instructions include an explanation for why each document is needed, but it is unclear how some documents will be used.	It is clear The instructions include a clear explanation for why each document is needed and how it will be used.	It is very clear The instructions include a very clear explanation for why each document is needed and how it will be used.

3.3 Provide documents

Providing documents in person, online, via email, or via other channels

- Uploading documents as part of an application
- Providing proof of identity
- Providing evidence of qualifications, income, address, or other information

3.3.1 Instructions

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Instructions Are there clear instructions on what documents are required and how to provide them?	Instructions are very unclear - There are no instructions, or the instructions are very unclear. They do not specify what documents/formats are accepted, or how customers can provide them. - The instructions are very hard to understand due to complex language, jargon, and passive voice.	Instructions are unclear - There are instructions on what documents are required and how to provide them, but they do not include important information about file types or other requirements. - The instructions are hard to understand due to complex language, jargon, or passive	Instructions may be unclear - There are instructions on what documents are required and how to provide them, but they may not be fully clear or prominent. - Some instructions may be hard to understand due to complex language, jargon, or passive voice.	Instructions are clear - There are clear and prominent instructions on what documents are required and how to provide them. - The instructions are mostly written in plain English and are easy to understand. - It is clear what documents	Instructions are very clear - There are clear and prominent instructions on what documents are required and how to provide them. - The instructions are written in plain English and are very easy to understand. - It is very clear what

	It is unclear what documents and file types are valid/invalid. Many customers provide documents that are invalid.	voice. It is unclear what documents and file types are valid/invalid.	It may be unclear what documents and file types are valid/invalid.	and file types are valid/invalid. Some visual techniques are used to show what documents are valid and/or invalid.	documents and file types are valid/invalid. Visual techniques are used to show what documents are valid/invalid (e.g. pictures/photos of examples, tick and cross icons, colouring).
Rationale Is it clear why documents are needed and how they will be used?	It is very unclear - The instructions do not include an explanation for why the documents are needed or how they will be used. - Most or all documents and information could have been collected from other sources. - Document requirements are excessive, irrelevant and/or unreasonably intrude on the customer's personal affairs.	It is unclear - The instructions include an explanation for why some documents are needed, but it is unclear how they will be used. - Most documents and information could have been collected from other sources.	It is mostly clear - The instructions include an explanation for why each document is needed, but it is unclear how some documents will be used. - Some documents and information could have been collected from other sources.	It is clear - The instructions include a clear explanation for why each document is needed and how it will be used. - Very few documents or information could have been collected from other sources.	It is very clear - The instructions include a very clear explanation for why each document is needed and how it will be used. - Documents are only requested if they cannot be collected from other sources (e.g. from partner agencies or existing customer profiles).
Formatting Are the instructions formatted clearly?	The formatting is very unclear Instructions are cramped and hard to read, with no headings. Important information is hidden within long blocks of text.	The formatting is unclear The instructions are formatted without clear and consistent use of headings, chunking, white space, lists nor tables. Instructions are formatted as paragraphs instead of lists.	The formatting is mostly clear, but has some issues The instructions are formatted using headings, and some chunking and white space. The chunking may be inconsistent (e.g. a long paragraph on two topics then two short paragraphs of one topic each) and some instructions are formatted as paragraphs instead of lists.	The formatting is clear The instructions are formatted using clear headings, chunking, white space, and lists and/or tables. However, some elements are slightly inconsistent (e.g. the spacing between chunks, heading style).	The formatting is very clear The instructions are formatted using clear and consistent headings, chunking, white space, and lists and/or tables.
Links Do instructions link to relevant information and documents?	There are no helpful links The instructions do not contain any links to useful information/documents, or all links are broken.	There are links, but they are mostly unhelpful The instructions may contain links to information/documents, but they are not relevant to most customers. The links go to the website homepage and the relevant webpages are hard to find. Some links may be broken.	There are links, but they are sometimes unhelpful The instructions contain links to information/documents, but they are not always relevant, or the links do not go directly to the relevant webpage.	There are helpful links The instructions contain links to information/documents, but some links do not go directly to the relevant webpage (e.g. the links go to the website homepage and customers must navigate to the relevant webpage).	There are very helpful links The instructions contain direct links to webpages with relevant information/documents (e.g. the privacy policy).

Record keeping Are customers required to maintain a record of their documents?	They are, but are not informed clearly Customers must keep a record of documents but are not provided clear instructions nor reasons for this requirement.	They are, and are somewhat informed Customers must keep a record of documents and are provided instructions and reasons for this requirement. However, some instructions and/or reasons are unclear.	They are, and are informed clearly Customers must keep a record of documents and are provided clear instructions and reasons for this requirement.	They are not, but are not informed clearly Customers do not need to keep any record of documents, but are not clearly informed about potential future documentation needs.	They are not, and are informed clearly Customers do not need to keep any record of documents and are clearly informed about potential documentation needs.
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3.3.2 Channel and process

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Flexibility Can customers verify information in different ways and provide files in different formats?	No, they cannot - Where customers must provide documents to verify information, they are only given 1-2 options to do so. Options are unclear. - Customers cannot provide documents in different file types/formats. Only one file type/format is accepted for each document. - Printed documents or copies of documents must be provided via letter or at a location in-person.	Yes, but there are very few options - Where customers must provide documents to verify information, they are given some limited options to do so (e.g. they can provide an invoice or receipt as proof of purchase, but not an order confirmation). Not all options are listed, so customers may not be aware of them. - Customers can only provide documents in one or two different file types/formats. - Customers cannot provide photos of documents. Documents must be completed digitally or scanned.	Yes, but there are many restrictions - Where customers must provide documents to verify information, they are given multiple options to do so. Not all options are listed, so customers may not be aware of them. - Customers can provide documents in different file formats, but it is restrictive (e.g. customers can only provide an image as a PDF, JPEG, PNG or TIFF). - Customers cannot provide photos of documents. Documents must be completed digitally or scanned.	Yes, but there are some restrictions - Where customers must provide documents to verify information, they are given multiple options to do so. All options are listed, but some may be unclear. - Customers can provide documents in most common file formats, but there are some restrictions (e.g. customers can provide an image as a PDF, JPEG, PNG, TIFF, but not HEIC). - Customers can provide photos of documents, but the process may be complicated (e.g. customers must combine multiple photos into one document before they can send it).	Yes, and there are almost no restrictions - Where customers must provide documents to verify information, they are given multiple options to do so (e.g. they can provide an invoice, order confirmation or receipt as proof of purchase). All options are listed clearly. - Customers can provide documents in all common file formats, including pictures. - Customers can provide photos of documents, and the process is seamless.
Ease Is the channel/platform for providing documents easy to access and use?	It is very hard Customers must provide documents in person, via email or via letter. If there is an online platform for providing documents, it is very hard to access, navigate and use.	It is hard - Customers can either provide documents via email, or via an online platform that is hard to access, navigate and use. - There are no design features to help customers see their progress. - Customers cannot save their	It is somewhat easy - Customers can provide documents via an online platform, but it is sometimes hard to access, navigate or use. - There may be some design features to help customers see their progress (e.g. uploaded documents are listed under each	It is easy - Customers can provide documents via a secure online platform. It is easy to access, navigate and use. - There are design features to help customers see their progress. - Customers can save their progress and come back	It is very easy - Customers can provide documents via a secure online platform. It is very easy to access, navigate and use, with an intuitive user interface. - There are design features to help customers see their progress (e.g. requirements are 'checked off' as

		progress and come back later. Customers may not be able to delete and reupload documents before submitting them.	requirement). - Customers cannot save their progress and come back later. - Customers may not be able to delete and reupload documents before submitting them.	later. Customers can delete and reupload documents before submitting them.	customers upload documents and unmet requirements are highlighted). - Customers can save their progress and come back later. - Customers can delete and reupload documents before submitting them.
Document validation Are documents automatically validated?	They are not, and the manual process is slow All documents are manually reviewed and validated by staff, and the process is slow. Customers are either not informed of any issues, or are informed after a significant delay. Applications may be rejected due to issues with documents, but the reason is not explained.	They are not, but the manual process is efficient All documents are manually reviewed and validated by staff, but the process is fast. Customers are informed of any issues quickly.	They are, but lacks information Where possible, some documents are automatically validated. However, customers may not be informed of potential issues at the time of submission.	They are, with information provided Where possible, most documents are automatically validated. Customers are informed of potential issues at the time of submission.	They are validated immediately, with clear information provided Where possible, all documents are automatically and immediately validated. Customers are clearly informed of all potential issues at the time of submission.

3.4 Apply for rebate

Applying for a rebate, grant or scheme

- Understanding eligibility and requirements for a rebate
- Providing information to apply for a rebate

3.4.1 Rebate

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Eligibility requirements Are the eligibility requirements simple?	They are very complex Customers have to provide a lot of information to determine their eligibility, then complete an application. The application requirements are extensive. The requirements include identity documents and	They are complex Customers have to provide a lot of information to determine their eligibility, then complete an application. The application requirements include identity documents and information that customers may have to	They are somewhat complex Customers have to provide information to check their eligibility, then complete an application. The application requirements include identity documents or information that customers may have to spend time	They are mostly simple Rebate requirements are simple and straightforward, though there may be many of them (e.g. customers have to provide their name, postcode, full address, family details).	They are very simple Rebate requirements are simple and straightforward (e.g. customers only have to provide their name and postcode).

	information that customers may have to spend a lot of time gathering/searching for (family details, previous addresses, past utility bills etc.).	spend time gathering/searching for (family details, previous addresses etc.).	gathering/searching for (family details, previous addresses etc.).		
Clarity Is information about the rebate requirements and process clear?	Information is very unclear - The rebate requirements and process are written with very complex and inconsistent language. The information is very difficult to understand (e.g. due to unexplained jargon, inconsistent terminology). There is a lot of unnecessary information. - Information is cramped and hard to read, with no headings. Important information is hidden within long blocks of text. - No visual techniques are used, making it hard to identify and understand key information. - Flesch reading ease score: < 50.	Information is unclear - The rebate requirements and process are written with complex language. The information is difficult to understand (e.g. due to unexplained jargon, inconsistent terminology). - Information is formatted without clear and consistent use of headings, chunking, white space, lists nor tables. - Some visual techniques are used to highlight key information, but they are confusing, overused or unhelpful. - Flesch reading ease score: 50-60.	Information is somewhat clear - The rebate requirements and process are mostly written in plain English, but some parts of the form are difficult to understand (e.g. due to unexplained jargon, inconsistent terminology). - Information is formatted using headings, chunking and white space, but it is inconsistent. - Visual techniques are used to highlight key information, but some may be confusing, overused or unhelpful. - Flesch reading ease score: 60-70.	Information is clear - The rebate requirements and process are explained in plain English. All technical terms are explained consistently. - Information is formatted using clear headings, chunking, white space, and lists and/or tables. However, some elements are slightly inconsistent (e.g. the spacing between chunks). - Visual techniques are used to help customers identify and understand key information. - Flesch reading ease score: 70-80.	Information is very clear - The rebate requirements and process are clearly explained in plain English. All technical terms are explained clearly and consistently. Sentences are clear and concise, with no unnecessary information. - Information is formatted using clear and consistent headings, chunking, white space, and lists and/or tables. - Visual techniques (e.g. diagrams, icons, bolding, colouring) are used effectively to help customers quickly identify and understand key information. - Flesch reading ease score: 80+ (or 70+ for technical/detailed topics).
Documentation Do customers need to provide complex information to apply for the rebate?	It is very complex - Customers must provide complex financial information (e.g. past utility bills, payslips, bank statements). - Customers must provide information that the rebate issuer already has access to, and this information is complex (e.g. previous addresses, proof of citizenship).	It is complex - Customers must provide some complex financial information (e.g. past utility bills, payslips, bank statements). - Customers must provide information that the rebate issuer already has access to, but this information is not complex (e.g. current address).	It is somewhat complex - Customers must provide some financial information, but nothing more complex than receipts and bank account details. - Customers may have to provide information that the rebate issuer already has access to, but this information is not complex (e.g. current address).	It is mostly simple - Customers must provide some financial information, but nothing more complex than bank account details. - Customers do not have to provide any information that the rebate issuer already has access to.	It is very simple - Customers do not have to provide any complex information (e.g. financial details). - Customers do not have to provide any information that the rebate issuer already has access to.

3.5 Provide consent

Reading a disclosure statement and providing consent before signing on to a service or product

- Providing consent for government to access and use personal information
- Reading about the commercial terms of an agreement

3.5.1 Transparency

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Outcomes Are the outcomes of signing the disclosure statement clear?	They are very unclear • The disclosure statement provides very confusing and unclear information about the potential outcomes of the transaction. It may be misleading. • The disclosure statement is very hard to understand due to jargon, complex language, passive voice etc.	They are unclear • The disclosure statement provides confusing and unclear information about the potential outcomes of the transaction. • The disclosure statement is hard to understand due to jargon, complex language, passive voice etc.	They are somewhat clear • The disclosure statement provides reasonably clear information about the potential outcomes of the transaction.	They are clear • The disclosure statement provides clear information about the potential outcomes of the transaction in plain English.	They are very clear • The disclosure statement provides very clear information about the potential outcomes of the transaction in plain English.
Implications Are the implications clearly highlighted?	They are very unclear and very biased • The disclosure statement is very unclear about the implications of signing on to the service/purchasing the product. • The statement is heavily biased towards presenting only the positives of signing on to the service/purchasing the product.	They are unclear and somewhat biased • The disclosure statement is unclear about the implications of signing on to the service/purchasing the product. • The statement is somewhat biased towards presenting only the positives of signing on to the service/purchasing the product.	They are mostly clear and mostly unbiased • Implications are presented, but they are not communicated effectively (e.g. lack examples). • The statement presents a mostly balanced view of the positives and negatives of signing on to the service/purchasing the product.	They are clear and unbiased • The implications of signing on to the service/purchasing the product are explained (including examples). • The statement presents a balanced view of the positives and negatives of signing on to the service/purchasing the product.	They are very clear and unbiased • The implications of signing on to the service/purchasing the product are clearly explained (including examples). • The statement presents a very balanced view of the positives and negatives of signing on to the service/purchasing the product.
Salience Is the most important information clearly presented?	It is very unclear • Important information is not salient and is purposefully not disclosed or very hard to find. • No visual techniques are used to highlight important information.	It is unclear • Important information is not salient and is difficult to find (e.g. because it is at the bottom of the page). • Few visual techniques, such as infographics or an overall summary, are used.	It is somewhat clear • Important information is highlighted, but may not be immediately salient (e.g. because it is not at the top of the page). • Some visual techniques, such as infographics or an overall summary, are used.	It is clear • Important information is salient and easy to find. • Visual techniques, such as infographics or an overall summary, are used.	It is very clear • Important information is salient and easy to find. • Visual techniques, such as infographics or an overall summary, are used effectively to highlight this information.

Support Is it clear how to access support?	It is very unclear There is no information about how to access support.	It is unclear There is information about how to access support, but it is hard to find and unclear.	It is somewhat clear There is information about how to access support, but it may be hard to find or unclear.	It is clear Information about how to access support is clearly signposted.	It is very clear Information about how to access support is very clearly signposted in an appropriate location.
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3.5.2 Design

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Call to action Does the disclosure statement use a call to action?	No, it does not There is no call to action to prompt customers to read the disclosure statement before signing onto the service or product. Or if there is a call to action, it is likely to backfire.	It does, but it is not prominent nor clear There is a call to action to prompt customers to read the disclosure statement, but it is not prominent nor clear.	It does, but it may not be prominent or clear There is a call to action to prompt customers to read the disclosure statement, but it is either not prominent or unclear.	It does, and it is prominent and mostly clear There is a prominent call to action to prompt customers to read the disclosure statement, but it may be slightly unclear.	It does, and it is very prominent and clear There is a very prominent and clear call to action to prompt customers to read the disclosure statement before signing onto the service or product (e.g. "Read our disclosure statement to learn more about our service before signing up").
Formatting Is formatting used to organise information?	It is not used at all - No subheadings are used to break up information. - There is limited white space on the disclosure statement. There may be elements that distract the customer or are used ineffectively, making it difficult to find or understand information. - Information is not broken up into small chunks. It is bulky, with little to no use of headings, lists, tables or boxes to help customers identify and understand key information quickly.	It is sometimes used - Subheadings are used but they are not descriptive and/or they are too short to describe what is in the paragraph (e.g. "Introduction"). - There is limited white space on the disclosure statement, making it difficult to read or identify key information. It is cluttered. - Information is broken up to make the disclosure statement easier to read, but there are no clear headings, lists, tables or boxes to help customers identify and understand key information quickly.	It is used - Subheadings are used, but they are hard to understand or do not succinctly describe the information in the paragraph. - There is some white space around and between text to make it readable. However, some elements (e.g. images, boxes, tables) are too close together, causing clutter. - Information is structured using chunking, lists, tables and/or boxes, but it can be hard to identify and understand key information quickly.	It is used well - Subheadings are short and descriptive. - White space is used consistently to balance elements across the disclosure statement. However, there may be some clutter caused by other elements (e.g. images, boxes, tables) being too close together. - Information is structured effectively using chunking, lists, tables and/or boxes, making it easy to identify and understand key information quickly.	It is used very well - Subheadings are clear and/or use a question-and-answer format. - White space is used consistently to balance elements across the disclosure statement. - Information is structured effectively using chunking, lists, tables and/or boxes, making it very easy to identify and understand key information quickly.
Visual techniques Are visual techniques used to	None are used No visual techniques are	Some are used Some visual techniques are	They are used Visual techniques are used	They are used well Visual techniques are used	They are used clearly and effectively

highlight and communicate information?	used, making it hard to identify and understand key information.	used to highlight key information but they are confusing, overused or unhelpful.	to highlight key information, but some may be confusing, overused or unhelpful.	effectively to make it easy to identify and understand key information.	Visual techniques (e.g. colouring, bolding, icons) are used effectively to make it easy to quickly identify and understand key information.
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3.5.3 Language

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Simplicity Is the disclosure statement written in plain English?	It is not - Most of the statement is written with very complex and inconsistent language. Most parts of the statement are difficult to understand (e.g. due to unexplained jargon, inconsistent terminology). - Most of the statement is written with long and complex sentences, with a lot of unnecessary information. - Flesch reading ease score: < 50.	It mostly is not - Some of the statement is written with very complex and inconsistent language. Many parts of the statement are difficult to understand (e.g. due to unexplained jargon, inconsistent terminology). - Some of the statement is written with long and complex sentences, with a lot of unnecessary information. - Flesch reading ease score: 50-60.	It mostly is - Most of the statement is written in plain English, however, some parts of the statement are difficult to understand (e.g. due to unexplained jargon, inconsistent terminology). - Most of the statement is written with short sentences, however, there is some unnecessary information. - Flesch reading ease score: 60-70.	Almost all of it is - Almost all the statement is written in plain English. All technical terms are explained, but some explanations may be hard to understand. - The whole statement is written with short sentences, with limited unnecessary information. - Flesch reading ease score: 70-80.	It is - The whole statement is written in plain English, with all technical terms explained clearly and consistently. - The whole statement is written with clear and concise sentences, with limited to no unnecessary information. - Flesch reading ease score: 80+ (or 70+ for technical/detailed topics).
Consistency Is the information consistent throughout the disclosure statement?	It is very inconsistent - Information throughout the statement is inconsistent, redundant and/or contradictory, making it very hard for customers to understand what is true and current. There is unnecessary duplication throughout. - Language and tone are very inconsistent throughout the statement, making it confusing to read.	It is inconsistent - Some information is inconsistent, redundant and/or contradictory, making it hard for customers to understand what is true and current. There may be some unnecessary duplication. - Language and tone are inconsistent throughout the statement, making it confusing to read.	It is mostly consistent - Information is mostly consistent throughout the statement, but there is some redundant information or unnecessary duplication. - Language and tone are relatively consistent throughout the statement.	It is consistent - Information is consistent throughout the statement, but there may be some unnecessary duplication. - Language and tone are mostly consistent throughout the statement.	It is very consistent - All information is consistent throughout the statement. There is no unnecessary duplication. - Language and tone are consistent throughout the statement.
Tone Is the disclosure statement written in active voice*? *In a sentence written in the active	None, or almost none of it is Most of the app content is written in passive voice (e.g. "Your data will be used by	Some part of it is Most of the statement is written in the passive voice. Some active sentences	Some of it is Some of the statement is written in the active voice to help customers understand	Most of it is Most of the statement is written in the active voice. However, some passive	Almost all of it is Most of the statement is written in the active voice (e.g. "The Department will

voice, the subject of sentence performs the action. In a sentence written in the passive voice, the subject receives the action.	the Department to..."). The customer is not referred to with first/second pronouns (I/you).	provide limited clarity. The customer is rarely referred to with first/second pronouns (I/you).	key information. The customer is sometimes referred to with first/second pronouns (I/you).	sentences are used inappropriately. The customer is referred to with first/second pronouns (I/you).	use your data to..."). Passive voice is used sparingly and where appropriate. The customer is referred to with first/second pronouns (I/you).
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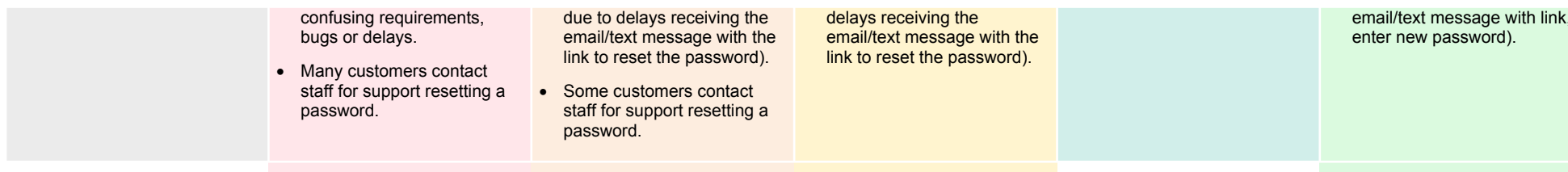
3.6 Login or enter password

Logging in to a profile or application

- Logging into a MyServiceNSW account, or other account
- Logging into an application, or application portal
- Resetting a forgotten password

3.6.2 Security check

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Username and password prompts Are username and password prompts/requirements clear?	There are no prompts - The label for the username field is unclear. For example, it is labelled 'username' when the username can only be an email. - The customer cannot view the password requirements from the login screen. - Customers are not shown any password requirements or common password issues when they enter their password incorrectly.	Prompts are unclear - The label for the username field may be unclear. For example, it may be labelled 'username' when the username can only be an email. - The customer cannot view the password requirements from the login screen. - Customers are shown common password issues when they enter their password incorrectly, but they are unclear.	Prompts are sometimes helpful - The label for the username field is helpful and clear. - The customer cannot view the password requirements from the login screen, or they are hard to find and/or understand. - Customers are shown common password issues when they enter their password incorrectly.	Prompts are mostly clear and helpful - The label for the username field is helpful and clear. - The customer can view the password requirements from the login screen. The password requirements are relatively easy to find and understand. - Customers are shown the password requirements when they enter their password incorrectly, but the unmet requirements are not highlighted.	Prompts are clear and helpful - The label for the username field is helpful and clear. For example, if the username is an email, the username field is labelled 'email'. - The customer can view the password requirements (e.g. "8-15 characters") from the login screen. The password requirements are very easy to find and understand. - Customers are shown the password requirements when they enter their password incorrectly and the unmet requirements are highlighted.
Password reset Is it easy to reset forgotten passwords?	It is difficult and takes a long time The process for resetting the password is difficult and takes a long time due to	It is relatively easy, but takes a long time The process for resetting the password is relatively easy, but can take a long time (e.g.	It is easy, but can sometimes take a long time The process for resetting the password is easy, but may not be fast (e.g. due to	It is easy The process for resetting the password is easy and fast.	It is seamless The process for resetting the password is seamless (e.g. enter email address/username, receive



4 Interacting



In this section

- [4.1 Face-to-face interaction](#)
- [4.2 Receive phone call from Government](#)
- [4.3 Negotiation process](#)
- [4.4 Physical access](#)
- [4.5 Paying for something](#)
- [4.6 Submit complaint](#)

Categories



1 Reading and understanding



2 Seeking and navigating



3 Preparing or providing information



4 Interacting



5 Help seeking



6 Waiting



7 Deciding



8 Miscellaneous



9 Non-customer actions

4.1 Face-to-face interaction

Speaking with government staff in person

- To complete an application or provide documents
- To ask questions and learn about a government service, licence or benefit
- To use a service at a physical location, like a community recycling centre or hospital

4.1.1 Pre-interaction and access

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Flexibility Do customers have the option to do the interaction online, or over the phone?	No, face-to-face is the only option • The customer does not have the option of doing the interaction online or over the phone. Face-to-face is the only option, where the interaction could reasonably be done online or over the phone as well.	Yes, but only in exceptional circumstances • The customer can do the interaction online or over the phone, but this option is only given to customers in exceptional circumstances when they request it (e.g. if they have accessibility needs).	Yes, but the process is unclear and/or difficult • The customer can do the interaction online or over the phone, but the process is difficult and/or unclear.	Yes, but the process may be unclear • The customer can choose to do the interaction online or over the phone if they prefer. However, the process may be unclear.	Yes, and the process is clear and easy • The customer can choose to do the interaction online or over the phone if they prefer. The process for each option is explained clearly.
Preparation Are customers given clear information to help them prepare for the interaction?	No information provided • Little or no information is provided beforehand about the interaction. Customers are unsure how to prepare for the interaction and what to expect.	Some information provided • Some information is provided beforehand about how customers can prepare for the interaction, but it is unclear, and customers may be unsure what to expect.	Information provided • Information is provided beforehand about how customers can prepare for the interaction, but customers may be unsure what to expect.	Clear information provided • Clear information is provided beforehand about how customers can prepare for the interaction and what to expect.	Very clear information provided • Very clear information is provided beforehand about how customers can prepare for the interaction and what to expect (e.g. what to bring, where to go, what the outcomes of the interaction are).
Waiting time Are customers given a clear estimate for how long they can expect to wait?	No estimate is provided, and wait times are very long • The waiting time is not communicated. • Waiting time is usually over 30 minutes.	No estimate is provided, and wait times are long • The waiting time is not communicated. • Waiting time is usually 15-30 minutes.	The estimate is unclear • The waiting time is communicated in non-specific terms (e.g. "You may have to wait for a short period of time"). • Waiting time is usually 10-15 minutes.	The estimate is clear, and expectations are met most of time • The waiting time is communicated in specific terms and this expectation is met most of the time. • Waiting time is usually less than 10 minutes.	The estimate is very clear, and expectations are met almost all of the time • The waiting time is communicated in specific terms (e.g. "Waiting times average between 1-5 minutes"), and this expectation is met almost all the time. • There is usually no waiting time, or it is less than 5

					minutes.
Psychological safety Are customers supported to feel comfortable during the interaction?	Customers are often very uncomfortable - Customers often feel very uncomfortable during the interaction (e.g. they feel rushed, embarrassed, or misunderstood). - Customers often feel ashamed to access the service (e.g. because it is associated with stigma), and there are no strategies in place to help customers feel more comfortable.	Customers are often uncomfortable - Customers often feel uncomfortable during the interaction. - Customers sometimes feel ashamed to access support, and there are no strategies in place to help customers feel more comfortable.	Customers are sometimes uncomfortable - Customers are sometimes uncomfortable during the interaction. - Customers do not frequently feel ashamed to access the service, but there are some strategies in place to help customers feel more comfortable.	Customers are supported to feel comfortable - Customers are supported to feel comfortable during the interaction. - Customers do not often feel ashamed to access the service, but there are strategies in place to help customers feel more comfortable.	Customers are supported to feel very comfortable - Customers are supported to feel very comfortable during the interaction (e.g. treated with empathy and respect, given privacy and personal space). - Where customers might feel ashamed to access the service, there are strategies in place to help customers feel more comfortable.

4.1.2 Engagement and empathy

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Personalisation Is the interaction personalised?	It is not personalised at all - Staff often do not greet customers and do not introduce themselves nor their agency/team. - Staff do not ask for, or use, the customer's name. - Staff ask insensitive questions, or almost fully rely on the customer to explain their situation and needs. - Staff often have an uninviting tone and speak down to the customer. Staff do not empathise with the customer's experiences and act aloof.	It is mostly not personalised - Staff give a basic greeting but do not introduce themselves nor their agency/team. - Staff ask for the customer's name but use it sparingly (at least once). - Staff do not ask the customer many questions and mostly rely on the customer to explain their situation and needs. - Staff often have an uninviting tone and do not empathise with the customer's experiences.	It is somewhat personalised - Staff greet the customer and introduce themselves or their agency/team. However, the greeting/introduction may be slightly unclear or uninviting. - Staff ask for the customer's name and use it a couple times during the interaction (at least at the start/end). - Staff ask the customer questions to understand their situation and needs but may ask for unnecessary information or make assumptions (e.g. based on common customer enquires). - Staff maintain a respectful tone throughout the interaction. Staff empathise with the customer's experiences but do not reflect the same level of concern.	It is personalised - Staff greet the customer and introduce themselves, including what agency/team they are from. - Staff ask for customer's name and use it a few times throughout the interaction. - Staff ask the customer respectful questions to understand their situation and needs. - Staff maintain a respectful tone throughout the interaction. Staff empathise with the customer's experiences but may not reflect the same level of concern.	It is very personalised - Staff greet the customer and clearly introduce themselves, including what agency/team they are from. - Staff ask for the customer's name and use it throughout the interaction. - Staff ask the customer respectful questions to fully understand their situation and needs. - Staff maintain a polite tone, and are patient and respectful throughout the interaction. Staff empathise with the customer's experiences.

Clarity Do staff speak clearly and check understanding?	No, and customers are given no opportunities to clarify - Staff do not speak clearly and often speak too fast. - Staff use unexplained jargon/technical language. - Customers have to provide the same information (e.g. ID) more than once. - Customers are given no opportunities to clarify understanding. - Staff do not take the time to understand the customer's issue. Staff interrupt the customer or prompt them with what they think the issue is rather than actively listening.	No, but customers have a brief opportunity to clarify - Staff do not speak clearly and often speak too fast. - Staff use unexplained jargon/technical language. - Customers have to provide the same information more than once. - Customers are given a brief opportunity to clarify understanding. - Staff acknowledge the customer's issue, but do not demonstrate understanding by summarising, repeating or reframing the main points/overall issue.	Yes, but customers are given few opportunities to clarify - Staff speak clearly most of the time. - Staff use plain language most of the time, but do not define jargon/technical language. - Customer may have to provide the same information more than once. - Customers are given a few brief opportunities to clarify understanding. - Staff demonstrate their understanding by briefly summarising the customer's overall issue.	Yes, and customers have some opportunities to clarify - Staff speak clearly, with a moderate pace. - Staff use plain language most of the time and define most jargon/technical language. - Customers do not have to provide the same information more than once. - Customers are given several opportunities to clarify understanding. - To check understanding and demonstrate active listening, staff repeat and reframe some main points of the customer's issue	Yes, and customers have many opportunities to clarify - Staff speak very clearly, with a moderate pace. - Staff use plain language and clearly define all jargon/technical language. - Customers do not have to provide the same information (e.g. ID) more than once. - Customers are asked whether they understand and are given lots of opportunities to ask clarifying questions. - To check understanding and demonstrate active listening, staff clearly repeat and reframe the main points of the customer's issue.
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4.1.3 Systems and process

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Seamless experience Do staff record enquiry details so the customer does not need to repeat themselves?	There is no system in place and staff do not record notes There is no system or process in place to record notes and look up customer information.	There is no system in place, so staff record individual notes Staff do not have a system to record notes or look up customer information. Staff record individual notes that they can use to look up customer information if they speak to the same customer again.	There is a system in place, but it is not functionally appropriate Staff have a system to record notes and look up customer information, but it is difficult to use and/or does not meet staff needs.	There is a functionally appropriate system in place - Staff have a system to record notes and look up customer information. - Staff use existing customer information to provide relevant information and updates.	There is a system in place that is quick and easy to use - Staff have a system to easily record notes and seamlessly look up customer information (e.g. past interactions). - Staff use existing customer information to quickly provide personalised information and updates.
SOPs Are standard operating procedures (SOPs) used?	No SOPs in place - There are no SOPs in place. - There is no process in place for staff to update their own personal knowledge base nor a shared knowledge base (e.g. notes on common issues and how to address	Limited use of SOPs - SOPs are in place for some parts of the process, but are not clearly defined. Staff only loosely adhere to them. - There is a process for staff update their own personal knowledge base, but there is	Yes, but SOPs are not used consistently - SOPs are in place for the process, but are not clearly defined. Staff adhere to them as needed. - Staff update their shared knowledge base, but there is	Yes, SOPs are used by most staff - SOPs are defined for the process and most staff adhere to them. - Staff have a process in place to regularly update their shared knowledge base.	Yes, SOPs are used by all staff - SOPs are clearly defined for the process and are integrated into daily practice for all staff. - Staff have a systematic process to regularly update their shared knowledge base

	them).	no shared knowledge base.	no process in place to do this regularly.		(e.g. notes on common issues and how to address them).

4.1.4 Outcome and feedback

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Outcome Are customers satisfied with the outcome?	Customers are very unsatisfied with the response - Staff do not explain what support they can provide. Customers are very unsure what to expect. - Staff do not know how to address the issues and/or do not know who to escalate it to. The interaction ends without staff providing, or committing to provide, a full or correct response. - Most customer requests/enquiries are not addressed/answered.	Customers are unsatisfied with the response - Staff explain what support they can provide, but it is unclear and customers are often unsure what to expect. - Staff have problems addressing some moderate/major issues and cannot escalate the issue to someone who can. - Some customer requests/enquiries are addressed/answered (but over an extended period).	Customers are sometimes satisfied with the response - Staff explain what support they can provide, but it is unclear and expectations are sometimes set too high. - Staff have problems addressing some minor/moderate issues, but can escalate the issue to someone who can most of the time. - Most customer requests/enquiries are addressed/answered (within a reasonable period).	Customers are satisfied with the response - Staff explain what support they can provide, though expectations may be set too high. - Staff have some problems addressing minor issues, but can escalate the issue to someone who can most of the time. - Most customer requests/enquiries are addressed/answered in a timely manner.	Customers are very satisfied with the response - Staff clearly set expectations about what support they can provide (under promised and over delivered). - Staff can address all issues and/or can quickly escalate the issue to someone who can. - All customer requests/enquiries are addressed/answered in a timely manner.
Next steps Do staff clearly explain the next steps?	The next steps are very unclear - Staff do not confirm if the request/issue has been resolved or the step has been completed. Many customers are unsure if they need to do anything further. - Staff do not explain the next steps. - Customers almost always enquire again about similar issues. - Customers do not get options for channels of further communication, and the default channel is inappropriate/inconvenient for most customers.	The next steps are unclear - Staff do not confirm if the request/issue has been resolved or the step has been completed. Some customers are unsure if they need to do anything further. - Staff suggest that there are next steps, but do not explain what they are. - Customers often enquire again about similar issues. - Customers do not get options for channels of further communication, and the default channel is inappropriate/inconvenient for some customers.	The next steps are sometimes unclear - Staff usually confirm with the customer that the request/issue has been resolved, or the step has been completed. - Staff mention the next steps, but they may be unclear and/or hard to remember. - Customers sometimes enquire again about similar issues. - Customers do not get options for channels of further communication, but the default channel is generally appropriate/convenient.	The next steps are clear - Staff confirm with the customer that the request/issue has been resolved, or the step has been completed. - Staff explain the next steps, but some steps may be unclear or hard to remember. - Customers rarely enquire again about similar issues. - Customers are given options for channels of further communication, and the default option is generally appropriate/convenient.	The next steps are very clear - Staff confirm with the customer that the request/issue has been resolved, or the step has been completed. - Staff clearly explain the next steps. - Customers almost never enquire again about similar issues. - Customers are given clear and accessible options for channels of further communication, and the default channel is generally appropriate/convenient.
Feedback	No channels for customers to	No clear channels for customers	Customers can provide	Customers can provide	Customers can provide

Are there clear opportunities for customers to provide feedback?	provide feedback Customers cannot provide feedback.	to provide feedback There is no clear way for customers to provide feedback.	feedback but channels are hard to access and not transparent Customers can provide feedback, but the channels are not easily accessible.	feedback through accessible channels Customers can provide feedback through easily accessible channels.	feedback through easily accessible, transparent, channels Customers are encouraged to provide feedback and channels are easily accessible, transparent, and promoted.
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4.2 Receive phone call from Government

Receiving a phone call from government staff

- To request further information
- To provide updates or information about the next steps in a process
- To offer support

4.2.1 Pre-interaction and access

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Communication Do customers receive clear communication in the lead up to the call?	There is no communication - Customers are not notified of the call in advance nor sent any reminders in the lead up to the call. - Customers do not have the option to do the interaction via another channel, even though it could practically be enabled via other channels (e.g. via email or online).	Communication is unclear - Customers are notified of the call in advance via an appropriate channel (e.g. email or text), but it is unclear. Customers are not sent any reminders in the lead up to the call. - Customers do not have the option to do the interaction via another channel, but it would be impractical to enable the interaction via other channels.	Communication is somewhat clear - Customers are notified of the call in advance via an appropriate channel (e.g. email or text). Customers are also sent a reminder in the lead up to the call, but it may be too soon or too late to be helpful. - Customers can request to do the interaction via another channel, but the process is difficult and/or unclear. Generally, it would be impractical to enable the interaction via other channels for all customers.	Communication is clear - Customers are notified of the call in advance via a preferred channel (e.g. email or text). Customers are also sent a reminder in the lead up to the call. - Customers have the option of doing the interaction via another channel if they prefer. The process for choosing a channel is fairly clear and easy. If the interaction must be done over the phone, it is because it cannot practically be done via another channel.	Communication is very clear - Customers are clearly notified of the call in advance via a preferred channel (e.g. email or text). Customers are also sent reminders in the lead up to the call. - Customers have the option of doing the interaction via another channel if they prefer (e.g. email or online). The process for choosing a channel is clear and easy. If the interaction must be done over the phone, it is because it cannot practically be done via another channel.
Preparation Are customers told how to prepare for the call?	No information is available No guidance is available about what customers can expect from the interaction	Some information is available, but it is unclear or hard to find Some guidance is available (e.g. online) about what	Some information is provided Some guidance is provided about what customers can expect from the interaction	Information is provided Guidance is provided about what customers can expect from the interaction and what	Clear information is provided Clear and helpful guidance is provided about what customers can expect from

	and what information they will need to provide.	customers can expect from the interaction and what information they will need to provide. However, it is unclear and/or hard to find.	and what information they will need to provide. However, it is unclear and some important information is missing (e.g. about how long the customer can expect the call to take).	information they will need to provide. However, it may be slightly unclear (e.g. due to some jargon, long sentences).	the interaction and what information they will need to provide.
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4.2.2 Engagement and empathy

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Personalisation Is the call personalised to the customer?	Support is not personalised at all - Staff do not greet the customer by name and do not introduce themselves nor their agency. - Staff have an impersonal and condescending tone. - Staff do not use the customer's name at all. - Staff do not use what they know about the customer to personalise the interaction. - Where empathy would be appropriate, staff dismiss the customer and do not acknowledge their concerns.	Support is not personalised - Staff greet the customer by name, but rely on the customer to correct them if they have called the wrong person. Staff briefly introduce themselves or identify their agency. - Staff have an impersonal tone. - Staff use the customer's name sparingly, but at least once. - Staff rarely use what they know about the customer to personalise the interaction. - Where empathy would be appropriate, staff express little empathy for the customer and do not reflect the same level of concern as the customer.	Support is somewhat personalised - Staff greet the customer by name and confirm they are speaking to the right person. Staff briefly introduce themselves or identify their agency. - Staff maintain a respectful tone throughout most of the call. - Staff use the customer's name sparingly, but at least at the start/end of the call. - Staff sometimes use what they know about the customer to personalise the interaction. - Where appropriate, staff empathise with the customer. However, staff do not reflect the same level of concern as the customer.	Support is personalised - Staff greet the customer by name and confirm they are speaking to the right person. Staff introduce themselves professionally and identify their agency. - Staff maintain a respectful tone throughout the call. - Staff use the customer's name most of the time. - Generally, staff use what they know about the customer to personalise the interaction. - Where appropriate, staff empathise with the customer. However, staff do not entirely reflect the same level of concern as the customer.	Support is very personalised - Staff greet the customer by name and confirm they are speaking to the right person. Staff introduce themselves professionally, and clearly identify their agency. - Staff maintain a polite, patient and respectful tone throughout the call. - Staff use the customer's name throughout the call. - Staff use what they know about the customer to personalise the interaction. - Where appropriate, staff empathise and reflect the same level of concern as the customer.
Clarity Do staff speak clearly and check understanding?	No, and customers are given no opportunities to clarify - Staff do not speak clearly and often speak too fast. - Staff use unexplained jargon/technical language. - Customers have to provide the same information (e.g. ID) more than once.	No, but customers have a brief opportunity to clarify - Staff do not speak clearly and often speak too fast. - Staff use unexplained jargon/technical language. - Customers have to provide the same information more than once.	Yes, but customers are given few opportunities to clarify - Staff speak clearly most of the time. - Staff use plain language most of the time, but do not define jargon/technical language. - Customer may have to provide the same information	Yes, and customers have some opportunities to clarify - Staff speak clearly, with a moderate pace. - Staff use plain language most of the time and define most jargon/technical language. - Customers do not have to provide the same information	Yes, and customers have many opportunities to clarify - Staff speak very clearly, with a moderate pace. - Staff use plain language and clearly define all jargon/technical language. - Customers do not have to provide the same information (e.g. ID) more than once.

	- Customers are given no opportunities to clarify understanding. - Staff do not take the time to understand the customer's responses. Staff interrupt the customer or prompt them with what they think the customer's response is rather than actively listening.	- Customers are given a brief opportunity to clarify understanding. - Staff acknowledge the customer's responses, but do not demonstrate understanding by summarising, repeating or reframing the main points.	more than once. - Customers are given a few brief opportunities to clarify understanding. - Staff demonstrate their understanding by briefly summarising the customer's responses.	more than once. Customers are given several opportunities to clarify understanding. To check understanding and demonstrate active listening, staff repeat and reframe some main points of the customer's responses.	Customers are asked whether they understand and are given lots of opportunities to ask clarifying questions. To check understanding and demonstrate active listening, staff clearly repeat and reframe the main points of the customer's responses.
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4.2.3 Systems and process

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Seamless experience Do staff record enquiry details so the customer does not need to repeat themselves?	There is no system in place and staff do not record notes There is no system or process in place to record notes and look up customer information.	There is no system in place, so staff record individual notes Staff do not have a system to record notes or look up customer information. Staff record individual notes that they can use to look up customer information if they speak to the same customer again.	There is a system in place, but it is not functionally appropriate Staff have a system to record notes and look up customer information, but it is difficult to use and/or does not meet staff needs.	There is a functionally appropriate system in place - Staff have a system to record notes and look up customer information. - Staff use existing customer information to provide relevant information and updates.	There is a system in place that is quick and easy to use - Staff have a system to easily record notes and seamlessly look up customer information (e.g. past interactions). - Staff use existing customer information to quickly provide personalised information and updates.
SOPs Are standard operating procedures (SOPs) used?	No SOPs in place - There are no SOPs in place. - There is no process in place for staff to update their own personal knowledge base nor a shared knowledge base (e.g. notes on common issues and how to address them).	Limited use of SOPs - SOPs are in place for some parts of the process, but are not clearly defined. Staff only loosely adhere to them. - There is a process for staff update their own personal knowledge base, but there is no shared knowledge base.	Yes, but SOPs are not used consistently - SOPs are in place for the process, but are not clearly defined. Staff adhere to them as needed. - Staff update their shared knowledge base, but there is no process in place to do this regularly.	Yes, SOPs are used by most staff - SOPs are defined for the process and most staff adhere to them. - Staff have a process in place to regularly update their shared knowledge base.	Yes, SOPs are used by all staff - SOPs are clearly defined for the process and are integrated into daily practice for all staff. - Staff have a systematic process to regularly update their shared knowledge base (e.g. notes on common issues and how to address them).

4.2.4 Outcome and feedback

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Outcome Are customers satisfied with the	Customers are very unsatisfied with the outcome	Customers are unsatisfied with the outcome	Customers are sometimes satisfied with the outcome	Customers are satisfied with the outcome	Customers are very satisfied with the outcome

outcome?	- Staff do not explain the purpose of the call nor the expected outcomes. Customers are very unsure what to expect. - Most customer requests/enquiries are not addressed/answered.	- Staff explain the purpose of the call, but not the expected outcomes. Customers are unsure what to expect. - Some customer requests/enquiries are addressed/answered (but over an extended period).	- Staff explain the purpose of the call and the expected outcomes, but expectations are sometimes set too high. - Most customer requests/enquiries are addressed/answered (within a reasonable period).	- Staff clearly explain the purpose of the call and the expected outcomes, though expectations may be set too high. - Most customer requests/enquiries are addressed/answered in a timely manner.	- Staff clearly explain the purpose of the call and the expected outcomes (under promised and over delivered). - All customer requests/enquiries are addressed/answered in a timely manner.
Next steps Do staff clearly explain the next steps?	The next steps are very unclear - Staff do not confirm if the request/issue has been resolved or the step has been completed. Many customers are unsure if they need to do anything further. - Staff do not explain the next steps. - Customers almost always follow up to clarify the next steps. - Customers do not get options for channels of further communication, and the default channel is inappropriate/inconvenient for most customers.	The next steps are unclear - Staff do not confirm if the request/issue has been resolved or the step has been completed. Some customers are unsure if they need to do anything further. - Staff suggest that there are next steps, but do not explain what they are. - Customers often follow up to clarify the next steps. - Customers do not get options for channels of further communication, and the default channel is inappropriate/inconvenient for some customers.	The next steps are somewhat clear - Staff usually confirm with the customer that the request/issue has been resolved, or the step has been completed. - Staff mention the next steps, but they may be unclear and/or hard to remember. - Customers sometimes follow up to clarify the next steps. - Customers do not get options for channels of further communication, but the default channel is generally appropriate/convenient.	The next steps are clear - Staff confirm with the customer that the request/issue has been resolved, or the step has been completed. - Staff explain the next steps, but some steps may be unclear or hard to remember. - Customers rarely follow up to clarify the next steps. - Customers are given options for channels of further communication, and the default option is generally appropriate/convenient.	The next steps are very clear - Staff confirm with the customer that the request/issue has been resolved, or the step has been completed. - Staff clearly explain the next steps. - Customers almost never follow up to clarify the next steps. - Customers are given clear and accessible options for channels of further communication, and the default channel is generally appropriate/convenient.
Feedback Are there clear opportunities for customers to provide feedback?	No channels for customers to provide feedback - Customers cannot provide feedback. - Where it would be appropriate, staff do not connect customers with support for their wellbeing.	No clear channels for customers to provide feedback - There is no clear way for customers to provide feedback. - Where appropriate, staff mention that customers can access support for their wellbeing, but it is hard to access and staff do not explain how to access it.	Customers can provide feedback but channels are hard to access and not transparent - Customers can provide feedback, but the channels are not easily accessible. - Where appropriate, staff connect customers with support for their wellbeing, but it may be hard to access.	Customers can provide feedback through accessible channels - Customers can provide feedback through easily accessible channels. - Where appropriate, staff connect customers with accessible support for their wellbeing.	Customers can provide feedback through easily accessible, transparent, channels - Customers are encouraged to provide feedback and channels are easily accessible, transparent, and promoted. - Where appropriate, staff connect customers with clear and accessible support for their wellbeing.

4.3 Negotiation process

Negotiating the terms of an agreement

- Defining the terms of an agreement/contract (e.g. price)
- Defining the roles and responsibilities of an agreement/contract

4.3.1 Access and reason

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Access Is it easy to find information and access channels for negotiation?	It is very difficult • There is little to no information available about the negotiation process. Customers are unsure how to prepare for the negotiation and what to expect. • Channels for negotiation are very difficult to access and use. • The customer can only do the negotiation via one default channel (e.g. over the phone). They cannot choose a preferred channel.	It is difficult • Information is available about the negotiation process, but it is hard to find, and customers may be unsure how they can prepare for the negotiation or what to expect. • Channels for negotiation are difficult for some customers to access and use. • The customer can choose a channel for the negotiation other than the default, but only in exceptional circumstances (e.g. if they have accessibility needs).	It is somewhat easy • Information is provided beforehand about the negotiation process, but customers may be unsure how they can prepare for the negotiation or what to expect. • Channels for negotiation are easy for some customers to access and use. • The customer can choose a preferred channel for the negotiation, but the process is difficult.	It is easy • Clear information is provided beforehand about the negotiation process, including how customers can prepare for the interaction and what to expect. • Channels for negotiation are easy for most customers to access and use. • The customer can choose a preferred channel for the negotiation and the steps for doing so are clearly explained.	It is very easy • Very clear information is provided beforehand about the negotiation process, including how customers can prepare for the negotiation and what to expect. • Channels for negotiation are very easy for all customers to access and use. • The customer can choose a preferred channel for the negotiation and the steps for doing this are very clearly and consistently explained.
Negotiation reason Could the negotiation have been avoided?	The negotiation is unnecessary • Almost all negotiations are unnecessary. In almost all cases, the issue could have been easily resolved earlier.	The negotiation is mostly unnecessary • Most negotiations are unnecessary. In most cases, the issue could have been easily resolved earlier.	The negotiation is sometimes necessary • Some negotiations are necessary. In many cases, the issue could have been resolved earlier.	The negotiation is usually necessary • The negotiation is necessary in most cases. It is unlikely that the issue could have been resolved earlier.	The negotiation is necessary • The negotiation is necessary in all cases. It is very unlikely that the issue could have been resolved earlier.

4.3.2 Transparency and support

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Clarity Is information about the process and potential outcomes clear?	It is very unclear • There is little or no information about the negotiation process and the potential outcomes of the negotiation. Any information	It is unclear • Information about the negotiation process is available, but it is unclear (e.g. due to complex language, unnecessary	It is reasonably clear • Information is available about the negotiation process and the potential outcomes of the negotiation, but it may hard to find or	It is clear • Information is provided about the negotiation process and the potential outcomes of the negotiation. It is mostly written in plain English and is	It is very clear • Information is provided about the negotiation process and the potential outcomes of the negotiation. It is written in plain English and is very

	available is very unclear (e.g. due to complex language, unnecessary information, missing information). - Important information about the process is missing (or purposefully not disclosed), which would likely impact the customer's decision to enter the negotiation. - No information is provided about how a final decision will be made.	information). There is little or no information about the potential outcomes of the negotiation. - Some information about the process is missing that could impact the customer's decision to enter the negotiation. - Some information is provided about how a final decision will be made, but it may be unclear or difficult to find. Customers often do not understand.	slightly unclear (e.g. due to complex language, unnecessary information). - Some information about the process is missing, however, it is unlikely to impact the customer's decision to enter the negotiation. - Information is provided about how a final decision will be made, and it is mostly clear. Customers usually understand.	easy to understand. - Most information provides full and honest account of the negotiation process. - Clear information is provided about how the final decision will be made. Most customers understand.	easy to understand. - Information provides a full and honest account of the negotiation process. - Very clear and detailed information is provided about how the final decision will be made. Customers almost always understand.
Access to support Is it easy to access support?	It is very difficult - No, or very limited assistance/access to support (e.g. staff, supporting materials) is offered. - Channels for accessing support are inappropriate, and very difficult to access and use.	It is difficult - Assistance or access to support is very unclear. - Channels for accessing support are difficult for most customers to access and use.	It is mostly easy - Assistance and access to support is offered. - Channels for accessing support are difficult for some customers to access and use.	It is easy - Assistance and access to support is clearly signposted in an appropriate location. - Channels for accessing support are easy for most customers to access and use.	It is very easy - Assistance and access to support (e.g. staff, supporting materials) is very clearly signposted in an appropriate location. - Channels for accessing support are easy for all customers to access and use.

4.3.3 Outcome

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Expectations Are expectations for the outcome of the negotiation clearly set?	No expectations are set Staff do not set expectations about the possible outcomes of negotiation and when the final decision will be made. Customers are very unsure and often contact support to seek clarification.	Expectations are vague and set too high Staff mention the possible outcomes of the negotiation and when the final decision will be made, but expectations are very vague and set too high.	Expectations are sometimes set too high Staff mention the possible outcomes of the negotiation and when the final decision will be made, but expectations are sometimes set too high.	Expectations are set Staff set expectations about the possible outcomes of the negotiation and when the final decision will be made, but they may set expectations too high.	Clear expectations are set Staff clearly set expectations about the possible outcomes of the negotiation and when the final decision will be made (under promised and over delivered).
Next steps Are the next steps after the negotiation clear?	Next steps are very unclear No information is provided about the next steps. Customers often follow up to ask about the next steps.	Next steps are unclear Some information is provided about the next steps, but it is missing important information about the waiting period, how to	Next steps are mostly clear Information is provided about the next steps, but it may be missing some information about the waiting period, how to check on the status	Next steps are clear Clear information is provided about the next steps, including the waiting period, how to check on the status of the final decision, and	Next steps are very clear Very clear information is provided about the next steps, including the waiting period, how to check on the status of the final decision,

		check on the status on the final decision and contact information.	on the final decision or contact information.	contact information.	and contact information.
Resolution Is the outcome of the negotiation communicated clearly?	Customers almost always follow up - The outcome of the negotiation is not communicated, or is communicated vaguely and intensively. No reasoning for the final decision is provided. - Customers almost always follow up to clarify or dispute the outcome of the negotiation.	Customers often follow up - The outcome of the negotiation is not communicated clearly and/or sensitively, and does not include reasoning for how the final decision was made. - Customers usually follow up to clarify or dispute the outcome of the negotiation.	Customers sometimes follow up - The outcome of the negotiation is communicated clearly and sensitively, but does not include enough reasoning for how the final decision was made. - Customers sometimes follow up to clarify or dispute the outcome of the negotiation.	Customers rarely follow up - The outcome of the negotiation is communicated clearly and sensitively, including reasoning for how the final decision was made. However, it may be missing some detail. - Customers rarely follow up to clarify or dispute the outcome of the negotiation.	Customers almost never follow up - The outcome of the negotiation is communicated very clearly and sensitively, including reasoning for how the final decision was made. - Customers almost never follow up to clarify or dispute the outcome of the negotiation.
Satisfaction Are customers satisfied with the outcome and negotiation process?	Customers are very unsatisfied with the outcome and process Customers are generally very unsatisfied with the reasoning provided for the outcome, and the process (e.g. poorly explained, not transparent).	Customers are unsatisfied with the outcome and process Customers are generally unsatisfied with the reasoning provided for the outcome, and the process (e.g. poorly explained and/or not transparent).	Customers are sometimes unsatisfied with the outcome and process Customers are sometimes unsatisfied with the reasoning provided for the outcome, or the process (e.g. poorly explained).	Customers are satisfied with the outcome and process Customers are generally satisfied with the outcome and process.	Customers are very satisfied with the outcome and process Customers are generally very satisfied with the outcome and process.

4.4 Physical access

Travelling to and accessing a physical location

- Going to a Service NSW Centre
- Reading directions to a physical location

4.4.1 Instructions

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Directions Are customers given clear instructions on how to get to the location?	No instructions provided Customers are not given any instructions on how to get to the location.	Instructions provided, but unclear Customers are given some instructions on how to get to the location, but they are unclear, outdated, missing information or hard to find.	Instructions provided, but sometimes unclear Customers are given instructions on how to get to the location, but they may be slightly unclear, outdated or missing information.	Instructions provided - Customers are given clear instructions on how to get to the location. - The instructions use some maps, diagrams and/or images to help customers	Clear instructions provided - Customers are given very clear and detailed instructions on how to get to the location. - The instructions use maps, diagrams and/or images help

				find the location.	customers find the location.
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4.4.2 Location

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Transport Is the location easy to access?	It is very difficult - The location is remote and impossible or very hard to get to via public transport. - There may be limited parking nearby.	It is difficult - The location is not close to public transport or parking (over 20 minutes walking distance). - There may be limited parking nearby.	It is not difficult - The location is not very close to public transport or parking (10-20 minutes walking distance). - The location does not have parking, but there may be limited parking nearby.	It is easy - The location is close to public transport and parking (5-10 minutes walking distance). - The location has parking and/or there is parking nearby, but it may be limited (e.g. because there are not many spots, or the spots are time restricted).	It is very easy - The location is very close to public transport and parking (less than 5 minutes walking distance). - The location has parking and/or there is parking nearby.
Accessibility Is the venue/building easy to access?	It is very difficult - The building/venue is very hard to access (e.g. with many stairs, heavy doors). It lacks accessibility features, making it hard for many customers to access. - There is little or no signage on or near the building/venue to help customers see it and its entry/exit points.	It is difficult - The building/venue lacks accessibility features, making it hard for some customers to access. - There is signage on or near the building/venue to help customers see it and its entry/exit points. However, the signage is unclear and hard to see from a distance.	It is sometimes difficult - The building/venue has some accessibility features, but it may be hard for some customers to access. - There is signage on and near the building/venue to help customers see it and its entry/exit points. However, the signage might be hard to see from a distance.	It is easy - The building/venue has some accessibility features to make it easy for customers to access. - There is clear signage on and near the building/venue to help customers see it and its entry/exit points.	It is very easy - The building/venue has many accessibility features (e.g. low-slope ramps, power-assisted doors, elevators) to make it very easy for all customers to access. - There is very clear signage on and near the building/venue to help customers see it and its entry/exit points.
Opening hours Do extended opening hours make it easy for customers to schedule their visit?	It is very difficult - The location is only open on some weekdays, with limited opening hours. - Customers usually need to take time off work and/or other commitments to visit.	It is difficult - The location is only open on weekdays, with standard opening hours. - Most customers need to take time off work and/or other commitments to visit.	It is sometimes difficult - The location is only open on weekdays, but with extended opening hours on some/all days. - Some customers need to take time off work and/or other commitments to visit.	It is easy - The location is open 7 days a week, with extended opening hours on weekdays and standard hours on weekends. - Customers do not need to take time off work and/or other commitments to visit.	It is very easy - The location is open 7 days a week with extended opening hours. - Customers do not need to take time off work and/or other commitments to visit.
Travel distance How far do customers have to travel to get to the location?	It is very far for most customers Most customers have to travel very far (more than 1.5	It is far for most customers Most customers have to travel far (45 minutes to 1.5	It is far for some customers Most customers do not have to travel very far (20-45	It is close for most customers Most customers do not have to travel far (10-20 minutes).	It is very close for most customers Most customers do not have

	hours).	hours).	minutes).		to travel far to access the location (usually less than 10 minutes).

4.5 Paying for something

Paying money to government in person, online or via other channels

- Paying to register a vehicle
- Paying a fine

4.5.1 Payment process

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Payment methods Are multiple payment methods available?	It is unclear how to pay • No information is provided about how to pay. Customers are unsure what payment methods are accepted.	Only one option available • Customers can only pay via one channel (e.g. online, in-person or mail). It is unclear how customers can make the payment.	A few options are available • Customers can pay in a few different ways, including at least one online payment method. It may be unclear what payment methods are accepted and preferred.	Multiple options are available • Customers can pay in multiple different ways, including most common online, mail and in-person payment methods. It is mostly clear what payment methods are accepted and preferred.	Multiple options are clearly available • Customers can pay in multiple different ways, including all common online, mail and in-person payment methods. It is clear what payment methods are accepted and preferred.
Confirmation Is confirmation sent immediately after paying?	There is none, or it is very delayed • No confirmation is sent, or is very delayed (i.e. more than 24 hours). Customers have to contact staff to check if their payment has been accepted.	It is delayed • Confirmation is delayed (i.e. not within 10 minutes), or only a physical receipts can be provided.	It is not immediate • Confirmation is not instantaneous (i.e. 5 to 10 minutes). Both physical and digital receipts can be provided.	It is almost immediate • Confirmation is almost instantaneous (i.e. 1 to 5 minutes). Both physical and digital receipts can be provided.	It is immediate • Confirmation is effectively instantaneous. Both physical and digital receipts can be provided
Ease Is the payment process simple and easy?	It is very difficult • Customers must register an account to pay, and the process is difficult or unclear.	It is difficult • Customers must register an account to pay, and the process is sometimes difficult.	It is sometimes difficult • Customers must register an account to pay online, but the process is relatively easy.	It is simple and easy • Customers do not need to register an account to pay. The payment process is easy for most customers.	It is very simple and easy • Customers do not need to register an account to pay. The payment process is very easy.
Navigation Do links take the customer directly to the payment page?	They do not, and the payment page is very hard to find • No hyperlinks are provided, or they are	They do not, and the payment page is hard to find • Hyperlinks take the customer to a website where it is	They do not, but the payment page is relatively easy to find • Hyperlinks take the customer to a website where the	They do not, but the payment page is easy to find • Hyperlinks take the customer to a website where the	They do • Hyperlinks take the customer directly to the payment page (no additional clicks).

	broken/misdirected. Instructions direct the customer to go online and search themselves.	difficult to find the payment page (2+ additional clicks).	customer has to search briefly for the payment page (1-2 additional clicks).	payment page is very easy to find (1 additional click).	
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4.6 Submit complaint

Submitting a complaint, appealing/disputing a decision or providing feedback

- Completing a complaint/feedback form
- Lodging an appeal/dispute

4.6.1 Access and requirements

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Ease and reason Is it easy to submit a complaint and are the reasons for it minor?	It is very difficult, and unnecessary - No contact information is provided online nor in direct communications. - Most customers complain about major issues that could have been resolved earlier in the process. Many different customers complain about the same issues.	It is difficult, and unnecessary - Contact information is provided online and/or in direct communications, but it is unclear or hard to find. - Many customers complain about major issues that could have been resolved earlier in the process. Many different customers complain about the same issues.	It is somewhat easy, and mostly necessary - Contact information is provided online and in direct communications. However, it may be slightly unclear or hard to find. - Some customers complain about issues that could have been resolved earlier in the process. Different customers sometimes complain about the same issues.	It is easy and necessary - Contact information is provided online and in direct communications. It is clear and easy to find. - Generally, customers complain about minor issues that could not have been resolved earlier in the process. Different customers sometimes complain about the same issues.	It is very easy and necessary - Contact information is provided online and in direct communications (e.g. via email). It is clear and easy to find. The preferred option is highlighted. - Generally, customers complain about minor issues that could not have been resolved earlier in the process. Different customers rarely complain about the same issues.
Psychological safety Do customers feel comfortable making a complaint?	Customers are often very uncomfortable - Customers are never encouraged to provide feedback. - Customers often feel very anxious to make a complaint (e.g. because they feel it will impact the outcome of their application), and there are no strategies in place to help customers feel more comfortable.	Customers are often uncomfortable - Customers are rarely encouraged to provide feedback. - Customers sometimes feel anxious to make a complaint, and there are no strategies in place to help customers feel more comfortable.	Customers are sometimes uncomfortable - Customers are sometimes encouraged to provide feedback. - Customers sometimes feel anxious to make a complaint, but there are some strategies in place to help customers feel more comfortable.	Customers are supported to feel comfortable - Customers are often encouraged to provide feedback. - Customers do not often feel anxious to make a complaint, but there are strategies in place to help customers feel more comfortable.	Customers are supported to feel very comfortable - Customers are always encouraged to provide feedback. - Where customers might feel anxious to make a complaint, there are effective strategies in place to help customers feel more comfortable, including the option to remain anonymous.

Access	It is very difficult	It is difficult	It is somewhat easy	It is easy	It is very easy
Is it easy to find and access channels to submit a complaint?	- Channels for submitting complaints are very hard to find and access. - The customer can only submit a complaint via one default channel (e.g. via email). They cannot choose a preferred channel.	- Channels for submitting complaints are hard to find and access. - The customer can choose a channel other than the default, but only in exceptional circumstances (e.g. if they have accessibility needs).	- Channels for submitting complaints are sometimes hard to find and access. - The customer can choose a preferred channel, but the process is difficult.	- Channels for submitting complaints are easy to find and access. - The customer can choose a preferred channel and the steps for doing so are clearly explained.	- Channels for submitting complaints are very easy to find and access. - The customer can choose a preferred channel and the steps for doing this are very clearly and consistently explained.

4.6.2 Form

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Structure Is the complaint form structured clearly?	It is very disorganised and unclear - Questions are not broken up into sections, making the form hard to navigate, understand and complete quickly. - There is little white space on the form. It is cluttered and hard to read. - No visual techniques (e.g. colouring, bolding, icons) are used. - Questions are not grouped or ordered logically.	It is disorganised and unclear - Questions are broken up into sections, but there are either no headings or the headings are not descriptive (e.g. "Section A"). - There is some white space around and between sections/questions, but it is inconsistent and there is clutter caused by some elements being close together. - Some basic visual techniques (e.g. colouring, bolding) are used, but they do not highlight key information/questions. - Some questions are grouped, but the order is mostly disorganised.	It is structured, but unclear - Questions are broken up into sections with headings, but they may be unclear. - There is white space around and between sections/questions, but there is clutter caused by some elements being too close together. - Some basic visual techniques (e.g. colouring, bolding) are used to highlight key information/questions, but it may be inconsistent. - Most questions are grouped logically, but some are out of place.	It is structured clearly - Questions are broken up into clear sections with descriptive headings, making the form easy to navigate, understand and complete. - There is white space around and between sections/questions to make the form easy to read. However it may be slightly inconsistent. - Visual techniques are used to highlight key information/questions. - Most questions are clearly grouped and ordered logically.	It is structured very clearly - Questions are broken up into clear sections with short descriptive headings (e.g. "Your details"), making the form easy to navigate, understand and complete quickly. - There is white space around and between sections/questions to make the form easy to read. - Visual techniques (e.g. colouring, bolding, icons) are used effectively to highlight key information/questions. - All questions are clearly grouped and ordered logically.
Language Is the language in the complaint form easy to understand?	It is very difficult to understand Most of the form is written with very complex and inconsistent language. The form is very difficult to understand (e.g. due to unexplained jargon, inconsistent terminology).	It is difficult to understand Some of the form is written with very complex and inconsistent language. The form is difficult to understand (e.g. due to unexplained jargon, inconsistent terminology).	It is mostly easy to understand - Most of the form is written in plain English, but some parts of the form are difficult to understand (e.g. due to unexplained jargon, inconsistent terminology). - Some example answers are	It is easy to understand - The whole form is written in plain English. Any technical terms are explained. - Clear example answers are provided to demonstrate how to answer questions, but some examples lack detail.	It is very easy to understand - The whole form is written in plain English. Any technical terms are explained clearly and consistently. - Clear and detailed example answers are provided to demonstrate how to answer

	- The form provides no guidance for questions, or the guidance is unclear and misleading. - Flesch reading ease score: < 50.	- Little to no examples are provided to demonstrate how to answer questions. Customers often provide too much or too little information. - Flesch reading ease score: 50-60.	provided to demonstrate how to answer questions, but they lack detail, causing customers to sometimes provide too much or too little information. Flesch reading ease score: 60-70.	Flesch reading ease score: 70-80.	questions (level of detail, format etc.). Flesch reading ease score: 80+ (or 70+ for technical/detailed topics).
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4.6.3 Next steps

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Next steps Are customers told what will happen after they submit their complaint?	The next steps are very unclear - The customer is not given any information about the next steps. Customers often follow up to ask about the next steps. - No, or very limited assistance/access to support (e.g. staff, supporting materials) is offered. - Channels for accessing support are inappropriate, and very difficult to access and use.	The next steps are unclear - The customer is given information about the next steps, but it is unclear. The information may not explain how the complaint will be managed or when the customer can expect a response. Customers sometimes follow up to ask about the next steps. - Assistance or access to support is very unclear. - Channels for accessing support are difficult for most customers to access and use.	The next steps are sometimes unclear - The customer is given information about the next steps, including how the complaint will be managed and when they can expect a response. However, some information is unclear (e.g. due to missing information, jargon, passive voice). - Assistance and access to support is offered. - Channels for accessing support are difficult for some customers to access and use.	The next steps are clear - The customer is given clear information about the next steps, including how the complaint will be managed and when they can expect a response. However, some information may be unclear (e.g. due to jargon, passive voice, long sentences) - Assistance and access to support is clearly signposted in an appropriate location. - Channels for accessing support are easy for most customers to access and use.	The next steps are very clear - The customer is given very clear information about the next steps, including how the complaint will be managed and when they can expect a response. - Assistance and access to support (e.g. staff, supporting materials) is very clearly signposted in an appropriate location. - Channels for accessing support are easy for all customers to access and use.
Waiting time Are customers given a clear estimate for how long they can expect to wait for a response?	No estimate is provided, and wait times are very long - The waiting time is not communicated. - Customers do not receive a response, or receive a significantly delayed response (72+ hours).	No estimate is provided, and wait times are long - The waiting time is not communicated. - Customers receive a response within 72 hours or within a timeframe that is a major delay relative to the timeframe of the entire process.	The estimate is unclear - The waiting time is communicated in non-specific terms (e.g. "We will get back to you soon"). - Customers receive a response within 48 hours or within a timeframe that is a moderate delay relative to the timeframe of the entire process.	The estimate is clear, and expectations are met most of time - The waiting time is communicated in specific terms and this expectation met most of the time. - Customers receive a response within 24 hours or within a timeframe that is a minor delay relative to the timeframe of the entire process.	The estimate is very clear, and expectations are met almost all of the time - The waiting time is communicated in specific terms (e.g. "You will hear back within X hours"), and this expectation is met almost all the time. - Customers receive a response within 4 hours or within a timeframe that is expected relative to the timeframe of the entire process.

					• Clear expectations are set about the response time and what support can be provided.
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4.6.4 Process transparency

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Information Is the information about the complaint handling process clear?	It is very unclear • There is little or no information about the complaint handling process and the potential outcomes of submitting a complaint. Any information available is very unclear (e.g. due to complex language, unnecessary information, missing information).	It is unclear • Information about the complaint handling process is available, but it is unclear (e.g. due to complex language, unnecessary information). There is little or no information about the potential outcomes of submitting a complaint.	It is somewhat clear • Information is available about complaint handling process and the potential outcomes of submitting a complaint, but it may hard to find or slightly unclear (e.g. due to complex language, unnecessary information).	It is mostly clear • Information is available about the complaint handling process and the potential outcomes of submitting a complaint. It is mostly written in plain English and is easy to understand.	It is very clear • Information is available about the complaint handling process and the potential outcomes of submitting a complaint. It is written in plain English and is very easy to understand.
Transparency Is the customer told how their complaint will be managed?	They are never told • Important information about the complaint handling process is missing (or purposefully not disclosed), which would likely impact the customer's decision to submit a complaint. • Customers do not receive updates on the status of their complaint. Customers often follow up to check on the status of their complaint. • Customers cannot check if their complaint will be acted upon.	They are rarely told • Some information about the complaint handling process is missing that could impact the customer's decision to submit a complaint. • Customers receive updates on the status of their complaint, but they are unclear (e.g. due to complex language, unnecessary information) • Customers can check that their complaint will be acted upon and receive feedback, but it is delayed and unclear.	They are sometimes told • Some information about the complaint handling process is missing, however, it is unlikely to impact the customer's decision to submit a complaint. • Customers receive updates on the status of their complaint, but they are slightly unclear (e.g. due to complex language, unnecessary information) • Customers can check that their complaint will be acted upon and receive feedback, but it may be delayed or unclear.	They are usually told • Most information provides full and honest account of the complaint handling process. • Customers receive updates on the status of their complaint. • Customers can check that their complaint will be acted upon and receive clear feedback.	They are always told • Information provides a full and honest account of the complaint handling process. • Customers receive clear updates on the status of their complaint (e.g. a confirmation that it has been received, and that it is being reviewed). • Customers can check that their complaint will be acted upon and receive clear feedback quickly.

4.6.5 Outcome

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Outcome	Customers are very unsatisfied with the response	Customers are unsatisfied with the response	Customers are sometimes satisfied with the response	Customers are satisfied with the response	Customers are very satisfied with the response

Are customers satisfied with the outcome?	- Information does not explain the possible outcomes of the complaint/dispute process. Customers are very unsure what to expect. - Staff do not know how to address the issues and/or do not know who to escalate it to. - Most customer requests/enquiries are not addressed/answered.	- Information explains some possible outcomes of the complaint/dispute process, but customers are often unsure what to expect. - Staff have problems addressing some moderate/major issues and cannot escalate the issue to someone who can. - Some customer requests/enquiries are addressed/answered (but over an extended period).	- Information explains the possible outcomes of the complaint/dispute process, but expectations are sometimes set too high. - Staff have problems addressing some minor/moderate issues but can escalate the issue to someone who can most of the time. - Most customer requests/enquiries are addressed/answered (within a reasonable period).	- Information clearly explains the possible outcomes of the complaint/dispute process, though expectations may be set too high. - Staff have some problems addressing minor issues but can escalate the issue to someone who can most of the time. - Most customer requests/enquiries are addressed/answered in a timely manner.	- Information clearly explains the possible outcomes of the complaint/dispute process, with clearly set expectations (under promised and over delivered). - Staff can address all issues and/or can quickly escalate the issue to someone who can. - All customer requests/enquiries are addressed/answered in a timely manner.
Next steps Are the next steps clear?	The next steps are very unclear - Staff do not confirm with the customer that the complaint/dispute has been resolved. - Customers are not told what they can do next. - The outcome is unclear, and is delivered without explanation nor empathy. - Where it would be appropriate, staff do not connect customers with support for their wellbeing.	The next steps are unclear - Staff typically do not confirm with the customer that the complaint/dispute has been resolved. - Staff suggest that the customer can take next steps, but do not explain what they are. - The outcome is unclear, and is delivered with little explanation and without empathy. - Where appropriate, staff mention that customers can access support for their wellbeing, but it is hard to access and staff do not explain how to access it.	The next steps are somewhat clear - Staff usually confirm with the customer that the complaint/dispute has been resolved. - Staff mention what the customer can do next steps, but they may be unclear and/or hard to remember. - Staff communicate the outcome clearly, but without empathy. - Where appropriate, staff connect customers with support for their wellbeing, but it may be hard to access.	The next steps are clear - Staff confirm with the customer that the complaint/dispute has been resolved. - Staff explain what the customer can do next, but some options may be unclear. - Staff communicate the outcome clearly and somewhat empathetically. - Where appropriate, staff connect customers with accessible support for their wellbeing.	The next steps are very clear - Staff confirm with the customer that the complaint/dispute has been resolved. - Staff clearly explain what the customer can do next. - Staff communicate the outcome clearly and empathetically. - Where appropriate, staff connect customers with clear and accessible support for their wellbeing.

5 Help seeking



In this section

[5.1 Accessing support \(via email\)](#)

[5.2 Accessing support \(via phone\)](#)

Categories



1 Reading and understanding



2 Seeking and navigating



3 Preparing or providing information



4 Interacting



5 Help seeking



6 Waiting



7 Deciding



8 Miscellaneous



9 Non-customer actions

5.1 Accessing support (via email)

Emailing staff or a government agency for support during a process

- To clarify eligibility requirements, or what information to include in an application
- To request a status update on an application

5.1.1 Pre-interaction

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Contact Do customers have what they need to access support?	No information is provided • No contact information is provided online or in other communication channels, or is very difficult to find. • There is no information about what customers should expect from the interaction. • Reasons for accessing support are often major and common, and could have been addressed/resolved previously.	Some information is available, but is unclear and difficult to find • Contact information is provided online and/or in other communication channels, but is difficult to find. • There is no information about what customers should expect from the interaction. • Reasons for accessing support are often major and could have been addressed/resolved previously.	Some information is available, but can be unclear • Contact information is available online and/or in other communication channels. • There is some information about what customers can expect from the interaction and what information they will need to provide, but it is unclear. • Reasons for accessing support are relatively minor and/or are uncommon.	Information is available and easy to find • Contact information is available online and/or in other communication channels. • There is some information about what customers can expect from the interaction and what information they will need to provide. • Reasons for accessing support are relatively minor and uncommon.	Clear information is available and very easy to find • Contact information is clearly available online and/or in other communication channels. Preferred option is highlighted. • There is clear information about what customers can expect from the interaction and what information they will need to provide. • Reasons for accessing support are often minor and uncommon.
Waiting time Are customers given a clear estimate for how long they can expect to wait for a response?	No estimate is provided, and wait times are very long • The waiting time is not communicated. • Customers do not receive a response, or receive a significantly delayed response (72+ hours).	No estimate is provided, and wait times are long • The waiting time is not communicated. • Customers receive a response within 72 hours or within a timeframe that is a major delay relative to the timeframe of the entire process.	The estimate is unclear • The waiting time is communicated in non-specific terms (e.g. "We will get back to you soon"). • Customers receive a response within 48 hours or within a timeframe that is a moderate delay relative to the timeframe of the entire process.	The estimate is clear, and expectations are met most of time • The waiting time is communicated in specific terms and this expectation met most of the time. • Customers receive a response within 24 hours or within a timeframe that is a minor delay relative to the timeframe of the entire process.	The estimate is very clear, and expectations are met almost all of the time • The waiting time is communicated in specific terms (e.g. "You will hear back within X hours"), and this expectation is met almost all the time. • Customers receive a response within 4 hours or within a timeframe that is expected relative to the timeframe of the entire process. • Clear expectations are set

					about the response time and what support can be provided.
Ease of access Are channels for accessing support easy to access?	They are not easy for most customers - Channels for accessing support are very difficult for most customers to access and use. - Customers often feel ashamed to access support and there are no measures in place to help customers feel more comfortable.	They are not easy for some customers - Channels for accessing support are difficult for some customers to access and use. - Customers sometimes feel ashamed to access support and there are no measures in place to help customers feel more comfortable.	They are easy for some customers - Channels for accessing support are appropriate and easy for some customers to access and use. - Customers do not often feel ashamed to access support, but there are some small measures in place to help customers feel more comfortable.	They are easy for most customers - Channels for accessing support are easy for most customers to access and use. - Customers do not often feel ashamed to access support, but there are effective measures in place to help customers feel more comfortable.	They are easy for all customers - Channels for accessing support are very easy for all customers to access and use. - Customers rarely feel ashamed to access support, but there are effective measures in place to help customers feel more comfortable (e.g. customers are offered confidential one-to-one support).

5.1.2 Engagement and empathy

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Personalisation Is support for the customer personalised?	Support is not personalised at all - There is no greeting and staff do not introduce themselves nor their agency. Staff do not ask for the customer's name (if unknown). - The email has an impersonal and condescending tone. - Staff dismiss or downplay the issue and do not acknowledge the customer's concerns. - Staff do not use the customer's name at all.	Support is mostly not personalised - There is a greeting, but staff do not introduce themselves nor their agency. - The email has an impersonal tone, but staff acknowledge the customer's request/enquiry. - Staff express little empathy for the customer and do not treat the issue with same level of concern as the customer. - Staff use the customer's name sparingly, but at least once.	Support is somewhat personalised - Staff vaguely introduce themselves or identify their agency. - Staff maintain a respectful tone throughout most of the email. - Staff empathise with the customer, but do not treat the issue with same level of concern as the customer. - Staff use the customer's name sparingly, but at least at the start/end of the email. - Staff sometimes use what they know about the customer to provide relevant advice.	Support is personalised - Staff introduce themselves professionally and identify their agency. - Staff maintain a respectful tone throughout the email. - Staff empathise with the customer, but do not entirely reflect the same level of concern for the issue as the customer. - Staff use the customer's name most of the time. - Generally, staff use what they know about the customer to provide relevant advice.	Support is very personalised - Staff introduce themselves professionally, and clearly identify their agency. - Staff maintain a polite, patient and respectful tone throughout the email. - Staff empathise and reflect the same level of concern for the issue as the customer. - Staff use the customer's name throughout. - Staff use what they know about the customer to provide tailored advice.
Tell us once Does the customer have to provide the same information	Yes, and they are not prepared Customers have to provide the same information (e.g.	Yes, and they are rarely prepared Customers have to provide	Yes, but they are prepared Customers have to provide the same information more	No, and they are prepared Customers do not have to provide the same information	No, and they are clearly prepared Customers do not have to

more than once?	ID) more than once. Customers are not told in advance what information they will need to provide. The information does not seem relevant and/or is difficult to gather/provide.	the same information more than once. Customers are not told in advance what information they will need to provide, but the information is easy for most customers to gather/provide.	than once. Customers are told in advance what information they will need to provide, but the information may be difficult to gather/provide.	more than once. Customers are told in advance what information they will need to provide, but the information may be difficult to gather/provide.	provide the same information (e.g. ID) more than once. Customers are told in advance what information they will need to provide. The information is easy for most customers to gather/provide.
Empathy Are unfavourable outcomes communicated clearly and empathetically?	The outcome is communicated coldly and without an offer of support - The outcome is unclear and/or misleading and is delivered without explanation nor empathy. - Customers are not offered support.	They are communicated without clear explanation nor empathy - Unfavourable outcomes are communicated without clear explanation nor empathy. - Customers receive an offer of support, but it is unclear and/or hard to access.	They are communicated clearly, but without empathy - Unfavourable outcomes are explained clearly, but without empathy. - Customers receive an offer of support, but it may unclear and/or hard to access.	They are communicated clearly and somewhat empathetically - Unfavourable outcomes are explained clearly with some limited empathy. - Customers receive a clear offer of support.	They are communicated clearly and empathetically - Unfavourable outcomes (e.g. rejections) are explained clearly and empathetically. - Customers are given clear and accessible options to connect with support for their wellbeing.

5.1.3 Systems and process

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Seamless experience Do staff record enquiry details so the customer does not need to repeat themselves?	There is no system in place and staff do not record notes There is no system or process in place to record notes and look up customer information.	There is no system in place, so staff record individual notes Staff do not have a system to record notes or look up customer information. Staff record individual notes that they can use to look up customer information if they speak to the same customer again.	There is a system in place, but it is not functionally appropriate Staff have a system to record notes and look up customer information, but it is difficult to use and/or does not meet staff needs.	There is a functionally appropriate system in place - Staff have a system to record notes and look up customer information. - Staff use existing customer information to provide relevant information and updates.	There is a system in place that is quick and easy to use - Staff have a system to easily record notes and seamlessly look up customer information (e.g. past interactions). - Staff use existing customer information to quickly provide personalised information and updates.
SOPs Are standard operating procedures (SOPs) used?	No SOPs in place There are no SOPs in place.	Limited use of SOPs SOPs are in place for some parts of the process, but are not clearly defined. Staff only loosely adhere to them.	Yes, but SOPs are not used consistently SOPs are in place for the process, but are not clearly defined. Staff adhere to them as needed.	Yes, SOPs are used by most staff SOPs are defined for the process and most staff adhere to them.	Yes, SOPs are used by all staff SOPs are clearly defined for the process and are integrated into daily practice for all staff.

5.1.4 Outcome

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
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Next steps Are the next steps clear?	The next steps are very unclear - Staff do not confirm if the request/issue has been resolved. Many customers are unsure if they need to do anything further. - Staff do not explain the next steps. - Customers regularly enquire again about similar issues. - Customers do not get options for channels of further communication, and the default channel is inappropriate/inconvenient for most customers.	The next steps are unclear - Staff do not confirm if the request/issue has been resolved. Some customers are unsure if they need to do anything further. - Staff suggest that there are next steps, but do not explain what they are. - Customers often enquire again about similar issues. - Customers do not get options for channels of further communication, and the default channel is inappropriate/inconvenient for some customers.	The next steps are sometimes unclear - Staff usually confirm with the customer that the request/issue has been resolved. - Staff mention the next steps, but they may be unclear and/or hard to remember. - Customers sometimes enquire again about similar issues. - Customers do not get options for channels of further communication, but the default channel is generally appropriate/convenient.	The next steps are clear - Staff confirm with the customer that the request/issue has been resolved. - Staff explain the next steps, but some steps may be unclear or hard to remember. - Customers rarely enquire again about similar issues. - Customers are given options for channels of further communication, and the default option is generally appropriate/convenient.	The next steps are very clear - Staff confirm with the customer that the request/issue has been resolved. - Staff clearly explain the next steps. - Customers almost never enquire again about similar issues. - Customers are given clear and accessible options for channels of further communication, and the default channel is generally appropriate/convenient.
Feedback Can customers provide feedback?	No channels for customers to provide feedback Customers cannot provide feedback.	No clear channels for customers to provide feedback There is no clear way for customers to provide feedback.	Customers can provide feedback but channels are hard to access and not transparent Customers can provide feedback, but the channels are not easily accessible.	Customers can provide feedback through accessible channels Customers can provide feedback through easily accessible channels.	Customers can provide feedback through easily accessible, transparent, channels Customers are encouraged to provide feedback and channels are easily accessible, transparent, and promoted.

5.2 Accessing support (via phone)

Calling staff or a government agency for support during a process

- To clarify eligibility requirements, or what information to include in an application
- To request a status update on an application

5.2.1 Pre-interaction

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Contact Do customers have what they need to access support?	No information is provided No contact information is provided online or in other	Some information is available, but is unclear and difficult to find Contact information is	Some information is available, but can be unclear Contact information is	Information is available and easy to find Contact information is	Clear information is available and very easy to find Contact information is clearly

	communication channels, or is very difficult to find. - There is no information about what customers should expect from the interaction. - Reasons for accessing support are often major and common, and could have been addressed/resolved previously.	provided online and/or in other communication channels, but is difficult to find. - There is no information about what customers should expect from the interaction. - Reasons for accessing support are often major and could have been addressed/resolved previously.	available online and/or in other communication channels. - There is some information about what customers can expect from the interaction and what information they will need to provide, but it is unclear. - Reasons for accessing support are relatively minor and/or are uncommon.	available online and/or in other communication channels. - There is some information about what customers can expect from the interaction and what information they will need to provide. - Reasons for accessing support are relatively minor and uncommon.	available online and/or in other communication channels. Preferred option is highlighted. - There is clear information about what customers can expect from the interaction and what information they will need to provide. - Reasons for accessing support are often minor and uncommon.
Waiting time Are customers given a clear estimate for how long they can expect to wait?	No estimate is provided, and the wait time is very long - The customer's position in the call queue and estimated waiting time is not communicated. - Most customers spend over 20 minutes on hold and/or have their call dropped. Most customers have to call back several times before reaching someone.	No estimate is provided, and the wait time is long - The customer's position in the call queue and estimated waiting time is not communicated. - Most customers spend over 10 minutes on hold. Customers may have to call back several times before reaching someone.	The estimate is unclear - The customer's position in the call queue and/or estimated waiting time is communicated in non-specific terms (e.g. "You may have to wait for a short period of time"). - Most customers spend 5-10 minutes on hold. Customers on hold are not given a call back option and must remain on hold to maintain their position in the call queue.	The estimate is clear, and expectations are met most of the time - The customer's position in the call queue and estimated waiting time is communicated in specific terms, and this expectation is met most of time. - Most customers spend 1-5 minutes on hold. Customers on hold are given a call back option where they can hang up but maintain their position in the call queue.	The estimate is very clear, and expectations are almost always met - The customer's position in the call queue and estimated waiting time is communicated in specific terms (e.g. "You are the first caller in the queue. Your estimated wait time is X minutes"), and this expectation is met almost all the time. - Most customers are not put on hold, or spend less than 1 minute on hold. Customers on hold are given a call back option where they can hang up but maintain their position in the call queue. - Clear expectations are set about the response time and what support can be provided.
Ease of access Are channels for accessing support the most appropriate?	They are not easy for most customers - Channels for accessing support are very difficult for most customers to access and use. - Customers often feel ashamed to access support and there are no measures	They are not easy for some customers - Channels for accessing support are difficult for some customers to access and use. - Customers sometimes feel ashamed to access support and there are no measures	They are easy for some customers - Channels for accessing support are appropriate and easy for some customers to access and use. - Customers do not often feel ashamed to access support, but there are some small	They are easy for most customers - Channels for accessing support are easy for most customers to access and use. - Customers do not often feel ashamed to access support, but there are effective	They are easy for all customers - Channels for accessing support are very easy for all customers to access and use. - Customers rarely feel ashamed to access support, but there are effective measures in place to help

	in place to help customers feel more comfortable.	in place to help customers feel more comfortable.	measures in place to help customers feel more comfortable.	measures in place to help customers feel more comfortable.	customers feel more comfortable (e.g. customers are offered confidential one-to-one support).
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5.2.2 Engagement and empathy

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Personalisation Is support personalised to the customer?	Support is not personalised at all - There is no greeting and staff do not introduce themselves nor their agency. Staff do not ask for the customer's name (if unknown). - Staff have an impersonal and condescending tone. - Staff dismiss or downplay the issue and do not acknowledge the customer's concerns. - Staff do not use the customer's name at all.	Support is mostly not personalised - There is a greeting, but staff do not introduce themselves nor their agency. - Staff have an impersonal tone but acknowledge the customer's request/enquiry. - Staff express little empathy for the customer and do not treat the issue with same level of concern as the customer. - Staff use the customer's name sparingly, but at least once.	Support is somewhat personalised - Staff vaguely introduce themselves or identify their agency. - Staff maintain a respectful tone throughout most of the call. - Staff empathise with the customer, but do not treat the issue with same level of concern as the customer. - Staff use the customer's name sparingly, but at least at the start/end of the call. - Staff sometimes use what they know about the customer to provide relevant advice.	Support is personalised - Staff introduce themselves professionally and identify their agency. - Staff maintain a respectful tone throughout the call. - Staff empathise with the customer, but do not entirely reflect the same level of concern for the issue as the customer. - Staff use the customer's name most of the time. - Generally, staff use what they know about the customer to provide relevant advice.	Support is very personalised - Staff introduce themselves professionally, and clearly identify their agency. - Staff maintain a polite, patient and respectful tone throughout the call. - Staff empathise and reflect the same level of concern for the issue as the customer. - Staff use the customer's name throughout. - Staff use what they know about the customer to provide tailored advice.
Tell us once Does the customer have to provide the same information more than once?	Yes, and they are not prepared - Customers have to provide the same information more than once. - Customers are not told in advance what information they will need to provide. The information does not seem relevant and/or is difficult to gather/provide.	Yes, and they are rarely prepared to - Customers have to provide the same information more than once. - Customers are not told in advance what information they will need to provide, but the information is easy for most customers to gather/provide.	Yes, but they are prepared - Customers have to provide the same information more than once. - Customers are told in advance what information they will need to provide, but the information may be difficult to gather/provide.	No, and they are prepared - Customers do not have to provide the same information more than once. - Customers are told in advance what information they will need to provide, but the information may be difficult to gather/provide.	No, and they are clearly prepared - Customers do not have to provide the same information more than once. - Customers are told in advance what information they will need to provide. The information is easy for most customers to gather/provide.
Clarity Do staff speak clearly and check understanding?	No, and customers are given no opportunities to clarify Staff do not speak clearly and often speak too fast.	No, but customers have a brief opportunity to clarify Staff do not speak clearly and often speak too fast.	Yes, but customers are given few opportunities to clarify Staff speak clearly most of the time.	Yes, and customers are given some opportunities to clarify Staff speak clearly, with a moderate pace.	Yes, and customers are given many opportunities to clarify Staff speak very clearly, with a moderate pace.

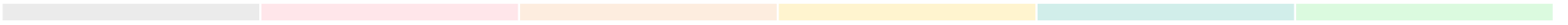
	- Staff use unexplained jargon/technical language. - Customers are given no opportunities to clarify understanding.	- Staff use unexplained jargon/technical language. - Customers are given a brief opportunity to clarify understanding.	- Staff use plain language most of the time, but do not define jargon/technical language. - Customers are given a few brief opportunities to clarify understanding.	- Staff use plain language most of the time and define most jargon/technical language. - Customers are given several opportunities to clarify understanding.	- Staff use plain language and clearly define all jargon/technical language. - Customers are asked whether they understand and are given lots of opportunities to ask clarifying questions.
Empathy Are unfavourable outcomes communicated clearly and empathetically?	The outcome is communicated coldly and without an offer of support - The outcome is unclear and/or misleading, and is delivered without explanation nor empathy. - Customers are not offered support.	They are communicated without clear explanation nor empathy - Unfavourable outcomes are communicated without clear explanation nor empathy. - Customers receive an offer of support, but it is unclear and/or hard to access.	They are communicated clearly, but without empathy - Staff speak clearly most of the time. - Staff use plain language most of the time, but do not define jargon/technical language. - Customers are given a few brief opportunities to clarify understanding.	They are communicated clearly and somewhat empathetically - Unfavourable outcomes are explained clearly with some limited empathy. - Customers receive a clear offer of support.	They are communicated clearly and empathetically - Unfavourable outcomes (e.g. rejections) are explained clearly and empathetically. - Customers are given clear and accessible options to connect with support for their wellbeing.

5.2.3 System and process

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Seamless experience Do staff record enquiry details so the customer does not need to repeat themselves?	There is no system in place and staff do not record notes There is no system or process in place to record notes and look up customer information.	There is no system in place, so staff record individual notes Staff do not have a system to record notes or look up customer information. Staff record individual notes that they can use to look up customer information if they speak to the same customer again.	There is a system in place, but it is not functionally appropriate Staff have a system to record notes and look up customer information, but it is difficult to use and/or does not meet staff needs.	There is a functionally appropriate system in place - Staff have a system to record notes and look up customer information. - Staff use existing customer information to provide relevant information and updates.	There is a system in place that is quick and easy to use - Staff have a system to easily record notes and seamlessly look up customer information (e.g. past interactions). - Staff use existing customer information to quickly provide personalised information and updates.
SOPs Are standard operating procedures (SOPs) used?	No SOPs in place There are no SOPs in place.	Limited use of SOPs SOPs are in place for some parts of the process, but are not clearly defined. Staff only loosely adhere to them.	Yes, but SOPs are not used consistently SOPs are in place for the process, but are not clearly defined. Staff adhere to them as needed.	Yes, SOPs are used by most staff SOPs are defined for the process and most staff adhere to them.	Yes, SOPs are used by all staff SOPs are clearly defined for the process and are integrated into daily practice for all staff.

5.2.4 Outcome

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Outcome Are customers satisfied with the outcome?	Customers are very unsatisfied with the response - Staff do not explain what support they can provide. Customers are very unsure what to expect. - Staff do not know how to address the issues and/or do not know who to escalate it to. The call ends without staff providing, or committing to provide, a full or correct response. - Most customer requests/enquiries are not addressed/answered.	Customers are unsatisfied with the response - Staff explain what support they can provide, but it is unclear and customers are often unsure what to expect. - Staff have problems addressing some moderate/major issues and cannot escalate the issue to someone who can. - Some customer requests/enquiries are addressed/answered (but over an extended period).	Customers are sometimes satisfied with the response - Staff explain what support they can provide, but it is unclear and expectations are sometimes set too high. - Staff have problems addressing some minor/moderate issues, but can escalate the issue to someone who can most of the time. - Most customer requests/enquiries are addressed/answered (within a reasonable period).	Customers are satisfied with the response - Staff explain what support they can provide, though expectations may be set too high. - Staff have some problems addressing minor issues, but can escalate the issue to someone who can most of the time. - Most customer requests/enquiries are addressed/answered in a timely manner.	Customers are very satisfied with the response - Staff clearly set expectations about what support they can provide (under promised and over delivered). - Staff can address all issues and/or can quickly escalate the issue to someone who can. - All customer requests/enquiries are addressed/answered in a timely manner.
Next steps Do staff clearly explain the next steps?	The next steps are very unclear - Staff do not confirm if the request/issue has been resolved. Many customers are unsure if they need to do anything further. - Staff do not explain the next steps. - Customers regularly enquire again about similar issues. - Customers do not get options for channels of further communication, and the default channel is inappropriate/inconvenient for most customers.	The next steps are unclear - Staff do not confirm if the request/issue has been resolved. Some customers are unsure if they need to do anything further. - Staff suggest that there are next steps, but do not explain what they are. - Customers often enquire again about similar issues. - Customers do not get options for channels of further communication, and the default channel is inappropriate/inconvenient for some customers.	The next steps are sometimes unclear - Staff usually confirm with the customer that the request/issue has been resolved. - Staff mention the next steps, but they may be unclear and/or hard to remember. - Customers sometimes enquire again about similar issues. - Customers do not get options for channels of further communication, but the default channel is generally appropriate/convenient.	The next steps are clear - Staff confirm with the customer that the request/issue has been resolved. - Staff explain the next steps, but some steps may be unclear or hard to remember. - Customers rarely enquire again about similar issues - Customers are given options for channels of further communication, and the default option is generally appropriate/convenient.	The next steps are very clear - Staff confirm with the customer that the request/issue has been resolved. - Staff clearly explain the next steps. - Customers almost never enquire again about similar issues. - Customers are given clear and accessible options for channels of further communication, and the default channel is generally appropriate/convenient.
Feedback Can customers provide feedback?	No channels for customers to provide feedback Customers cannot provide feedback.	No clear channels for customers to provide feedback There is no clear way for customers to provide feedback.	Customers can provide feedback but channels are hard to access and not transparent Customers can provide feedback, but the channels are not easily accessible.	Customers can provide feedback through accessible channels Customers can provide feedback through easily accessible channels.	Customers can provide feedback through easily accessible, transparent, channels Customers are encouraged to provide feedback, and channels are easily accessible, transparent, and promoted.



6 Waiting



In this section

6.1 Wait (active)

6.2 Wait (idle)

Categories



1 Reading and understanding



2 Seeking and navigating



3 Preparing or providing information



4 Interacting



5 Help seeking



6 Waiting



7 Deciding



8 Miscellaneous



9 Non-customer actions

6.1 Wait (active)

Waiting in person or on the phone (on hold)

- Waiting at a Service NSW Centre to be served by government staff
- Calling staff or a government agency and waiting on hold

6.1.1 Waiting period

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Set expectations Are customers given a clear estimate for how long they can expect to wait?	No estimate is provided • Customers are not given an estimated waiting time.	The estimate is very unclear • The waiting time is communicated in vague terms (e.g. "soon" or "shortly"), in a very wide range (e.g. between 1-60 minutes), or only when the customer requests it.	The estimate is unclear • The waiting time is communicated in specific terms, but in a wide range (e.g. between 1-20 minutes).	The estimate is clear • The waiting time is communicated in specific terms and in a relatively narrow range (e.g. between 1-10 minutes).	The estimate is very clear • The waiting time is communicated in specific terms and in a narrow range (e.g. 1-2 minutes). The estimate is informed by current data (e.g. call volumes, number of customers waiting).
Accuracy Does the estimated waiting time reflect actual waiting times?	It rarely does • 70-100% of actual waiting times deviate from the estimated waiting time. • 70-100% of actual waiting times are greater than the estimated waiting time. • More than 20% of customers ask about an extended waiting time. • More than 30% of customers drop out during the waiting period.	It sometimes does • 40-70% of actual waiting times deviate from the estimated waiting time. • 40-70% of actual waiting times are greater than the estimated waiting time. • 10-20% of customers ask about an extended waiting time. • 10-30% of customers drop out during the waiting period.	It often does • 20-50% of actual waiting times deviate from the estimated waiting time. • 20-50% of actual waiting times are greater than the estimated waiting time. • 5-10% of customers ask about an extended waiting time. • 5-10% of customers drop out during the waiting period.	It mostly does • Less than 20% of actual waiting times deviate from the estimated waiting time. • Less than 20% of actual waiting times are greater than the estimated waiting time. • Less than 5% of customers ask about an extended waiting time. • Less than 5% of customers drop out during the waiting period.	It almost always does • Less than 1% of actual waiting times deviate from the estimated waiting time. • Less than 1% of actual waiting times are greater than the estimated waiting time. • Less than 1% of customers ask about an extended waiting time. • Customers only drop out during the waiting period due to technical difficulties.
Wait outcome Are customers told what to expect after waiting?	They are rarely told • Customers are rarely told what they are waiting for and what to expect after they are done waiting.	They are sometimes told • Customers are sometimes told what they are waiting for and what to expect after they are done waiting.	They are generally told • Customers are generally told what they are waiting for and what to expect after they are done waiting.	They are told • Customers are told what they are waiting for and what to expect after they are done waiting, except in rare cases where staff are unsure of the issue.	They are told clearly • Customers are always told what they are waiting for and what to expect after they are done waiting.

Flexibility Do customers have the option to leave or hang up and maintain their place in the queue?	No option is given - For calls, customers are not given a call back option. - Customers do not have the option to schedule a preferred call back time. - For in-person interactions, customers must stand in a queue. If they leave, they lose their position in the queue.	Option is sometimes given, but only after a long time - For calls, customers are only given a call back option if the estimated wait time is unusually long, and it is not offered until customers have been on hold for more than 10 minutes. - Customers do not have the option to schedule a preferred call back time. - For in-person interactions, there is a ticket system where customers can get a number and wait in a waiting area until it is their time to be served. However the waiting area is cramped or lacks seating. The ticket system may not be sequential, meaning customers are unsure where they are in the queue and how many people are ahead of them.	Option is given, but only after a long time - For calls, customers on hold are given a call back option where they can hang up but retain their position in the call queue. However, this option is only offered when customers have been on hold for more than 5 minutes. - Customers do not have the option to schedule a preferred call back time. - For in-person interactions, there is a ticket system where customers can get a number and sit comfortably in a waiting area until it is their time to be served. The ticket system is sequential, giving customers an idea of where they are in the queue and how many people are ahead of them.	Option is given after any waiting, and is flexible - For calls, customers on hold are given a call back option where they can hang up but retain their position in the call queue. However, this option is only offered when customers have been on hold for more than 2 minutes. - Customers are able to schedule a preferred call back time if requested. - For in-person interactions customers can join the queue (in-person only) and leave the waiting area until it is their time to be served. They are contacted (via text message or email) when it is almost their time to be served so they can return to the waiting area. However, customers often have to wait more than 5 minutes after returning.	Option is always given after any waiting, and is very flexible - For calls, customers on hold are given a call back option where they can hang up but retain their position in the call queue. This option is offered when it is estimated that the customer will have to wait more than 2 minutes. - Customers are able to schedule a preferred call back time. - For in-person interactions, customers can join the queue (either in-person or online) and leave the waiting area until it is their time to be served. They are contacted (via text message or email) when it is almost their time to be served so they can return to the waiting area.
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6.2 Wait (idle)

Waiting while being able to do other things. Not in person

- Waiting for the outcome of an application
- Waiting for staff to provide more information, or to respond to an enquiry

6.2.1 Waiting period

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Set expectations Are customers given a clear estimate for how long they can expect to wait?	No estimate is provided Customers are not given an estimated waiting time.	The estimate is very unclear The waiting time is communicated in vague terms (e.g. "soon" or "shortly"), a very wide range (e.g. 1-3 weeks), or only	The estimate is unclear The waiting time is communicated in specific terms, but in a wide range (e.g. between 1-5 days).	The estimate is clear The waiting time is communicated in specific terms and in a relatively narrow range (e.g. between 1-3 days).	The estimate is very clear The waiting time is communicated in specific terms and in a narrow range (e.g. tomorrow, between 3-5pm). The estimate is

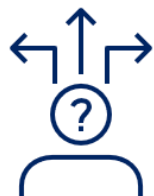
		when the customer requests it.			informed by current data (e.g. number of open requests, number of applications being reviewed).
Accuracy Does the estimated waiting time reflect actual waiting times?	It rarely does 70-100% of actual waiting times deviate from the estimated waiting time. 70-100% of actual waiting times are greater than the estimated waiting time. - More than 20% of customers ask about an extended waiting time.	It sometimes does 40-70% of actual waiting times deviate from the estimated waiting time. 40-70% of actual waiting times are greater than the estimated waiting time. 10-20% of customers ask about an extended waiting time.	It often does 20-50% of actual waiting times deviate from the estimated waiting time. 20-50% of actual waiting times are greater than the estimated waiting time. 5-10% of customers ask about an extended waiting time.	It mostly does - Less than 20% of actual waiting times deviate from the estimated waiting time. - Less than 20% of actual waiting times are greater than the estimated waiting time. - Less than 5% of customers ask about an extended waiting time.	It almost always does - Less than 1% of actual waiting times deviate from the estimated waiting time. - Less than 1% of actual waiting times are greater than the estimated waiting time. - Less than 1% of customers ask about an extended waiting time.
Wait outcome Are customers told what to expect after waiting?	They are rarely told Customers are rarely told what they are waiting for and what to expect after they are done waiting.	They are sometimes told Customers are sometimes told what they are waiting for and what to expect after they are done waiting.	They are generally told Customers are generally told what they are waiting for and what to expect after they are done waiting.	They are told Customers are told what they are waiting for and what to expect after they are done waiting, except in rare cases where staff are unsure of the issue.	They are told clearly Customers are always told what they are waiting for and what to expect after they are done waiting.

6.2.2 Status/Reminder

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Updates Are customers given progress updates and other useful information during the waiting period?	No updates provided - No updates are given. - Customers are not informed of delays.	Updates provided, but only when contacted - Updates are only given when the customer requests it. - Customers are only informed of delays in extreme circumstances. They are not given an updated estimated waiting time.	Updates provided, but on ad hoc basis - Customers are only updated on status on an ad hoc basis, or when the customer requests it. - Customers are informed of delays but are not given an updated estimated waiting time.	Updates provided - Customers are updated on status at key moments in the process. - Customers are quickly and empathically informed of delays, and are given an updated estimated waiting time.	Updates always provided - Customers are updated on status at key moments in the process. Customers can select a preferred channel for these updates. - Customers are quickly and empathically informed of delays, and are given an updated estimated waiting time.
Status visibility Can customers track progress?	They cannot There is no way for	They can, but it is difficult There is no way for	They can, but it can be difficult Customers can track	They can, and it is easy Customers can track	They can, and it is very easy Customers can track

	customers to check on status online. Customers are not given a reference number. No contact information is provided online nor in direct communications.	customers to track progress online. Customers must contact staff to check on status and provide a reference number. Contact information is provided online and/or in direct communications, but it is unclear or hard to find.	progress via a basic online portal, but it does not provide enough detail for customers to clearly understand the status or the remaining estimated waiting time. Updates in the portal may be delayed. Contact information is provided online and in direct communications. However, it may be slightly unclear or hard to find.	progress via an online portal. The portal provides information about status, waiting time, and required actions. However, the information may be slightly unclear, delayed or hard to find. Contact information is provided online and in direct communications. It is clear and easy to find.	progress via an online portal. Important information about status, waiting time and required actions is summarised effectively and it is easy to find and understand. Updates to the portal are live. Contact information is provided online and in direct communications (e.g. via email). It is clear and easy to find. The preferred option is highlighted.
Problem resolution Is it easy to resolve delays and problems?	It is very difficult - Staff are not alerted to customer delays. - There is no process to resolve delays quickly. Staff do not know how to resolve issues causing delays, nor who to pass the issues onto.	It is difficult - Staff are sometimes alerted to customer delays, but it is delayed and/or unclear. - Staff cannot resolve most issues causing delays and do not know who to pass the issues onto.	It is mostly easy - Staff are alerted to customer delays, but it may be delayed or unclear. - Staff cannot resolve most issues causing delays, but can generally pass the issues onto someone who can.	It is easy - Staff are regularly alerted to customer delays. - Staff can quickly resolve most issues causing delays and/or can pass the issues onto someone who can.	It is very easy - Staff are immediately alerted to all relevant customer delays. - Staff can quickly resolve all issues causing delays and/or can pass the issue onto someone who can.

7 Deciding



In this section

7.1 Make a decision

Categories



1 Reading and understanding



2 Seeking and navigating



3 Preparing or providing information



4 Interacting



5 Help seeking



6 Waiting



7 Deciding



8 Miscellaneous



9 Non-customer actions

7.1 Make a decision

Choosing an option or deciding to do something

- Deciding to apply for a service, licence or benefit
- Deciding to dispute/appeal a decision
- Choosing between two different licence types

7.1.1 Decision point

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Decision aid Are customers given a decision aid?	No decision aid provided • No decision aid is provided.	Decision aid provided, but lacks information about each option • A decision aid identifies most options, but it does not provide expectations about the possible pros and cons.	Decision aid provided • A decision aid identifies all available options and provides some expectations about the possible pros and cons to help customers make a decision.	Clear decision aid provided • A decision aid clearly identifies all available options and provides expectations about the possible pros and cons to help customers make a decision.	Clear and comprehensive decision aid provided • A decision aid (e.g. comparison table) clearly outlines all options, including the possible pros of cons of each.
Information Are customer concerns or uncertainties addressed?	Customer concerns are not addressed • There are no FAQs (or similar) to address common customer concerns and uncertainties.	Customer concerns are not addressed well • FAQs (or similar) are available, but they do not address common customer concerns and uncertainties. They are also not easily visible/accessible.	Customer concerns are addressed • FAQs (or similar) are available to address some common customer concerns and uncertainties. However, they may not be easily visible/accessible.	Customer concerns are addressed well • FAQs (or similar) are visible/accessible to address the most common customer concerns and uncertainties.	Customer concerns are addressed very well • FAQs (or similar) are easily visible/accessible to clearly address all common customer concerns and uncertainties.
Access to support Is support for making the decision available?	Support is not provided • No contact information is provided online nor in other communication channels. • Reasons for accessing support are often major and common, and could have been addressed/resolved previously.	Support is available but difficult to find • Contact information is provided online and/or in other communication channels. • Channels for accessing support are difficult for most customers to access and use. • There is no information about what customers should expect from the	Support is available • Contact information is available online and/or in other communication channels. • Channels for accessing support are difficult for some customers to access and use. • There is some information about what customers can expect from the interaction and what information they	Support is available and is easy to find • Contact information is available online and/or in other communication channels. • Channels for accessing support are easy for most customers to access and use. • There is some information about what customers can expect from the interaction	Support is available and very easy to find • Contact information is clearly available online and/or in other communication channels. • Channels for accessing support are easy for all customers to access and use. • There is clear information about what customers can expect from the interaction

		interaction. Reasons for accessing support are often major and could have been addressed/resolved previously.	will need to provide, but it is unclear. Reasons for accessing support are relatively minor and/or are uncommon.	and what information they will need to provide. Reasons for accessing support are relatively minor and uncommon.	and what information they will need to provide. Reasons for accessing support are often minor and uncommon.
Defaults Is a default used that is beneficial to the customer?	No default is used, or the default is not beneficial to the customer No default is used, or it is used but not informed by perceived or known customer benefits. It is very difficult for customers to opt out of the default.	A default is used, but it may not be beneficial to the customer A default is used to simplify the decision. The chosen default is informed by perceived customer benefits. However, it may be difficult for customers to opt out of the default.	A default is used that is likely to be beneficial to the customer A default is used to simplify the decision. The chosen default is informed by perceived customer benefits. Customers can opt out of the default.	A default is used that is beneficial to the customer A default is used to simplify the decision. The chosen default is mostly informed by known customer benefits. Customers can opt out of the default.	A default is used that is very beneficial to the customer A default is used to simplify the decision. The chosen default is strongly informed by known customer benefits. Customers can easily opt out of the default.

8 Miscellaneous



In this section

8.1 Miscellaneous step

Categories



1 Reading and understanding



2 Seeking and navigating



3 Preparing or providing information



4 Interacting



5 Help seeking



6 Waiting



7 Deciding



8 Miscellaneous



9 Non-customer actions

8.1 Miscellaneous step

Captures any behaviour, communication or channel that does not fit into another category and/or is very specific to your process.

- Doing physical labour (e.g. carrying a product)
- Inspecting or reviewing a product/service
- Completing training

8.1.1 General scale

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Information Is clear information provided about this step in the process?	Information is not provided • Customers receive no information that explains where they are in the process, how to complete the step and why the step is necessary. Customers often feel lost and contact staff asking for information.	Information is rarely provided • Customers receive little or no information that explains where they are in the process, how to complete the step and why the step is necessary. However, customers generally understand the step and rarely contact staff asking for information.	Information is provided, but it is unclear • Customers receive information that explains where they are in the process, how to complete the step and why the step is necessary. However some information may be unclear (e.g. due to missing details, jargon, passive voice).	Clear information is provided • Customers receive information that clearly explains where they are in the process, how to complete the step and why the step is necessary.	Very clear information is provided • Customers receive information that very clearly explains where they are in the process, how to complete the step and why the step is necessary.
Next steps Are the next steps clear?	The next steps are very unclear • No information is provided about the next steps in the process. • If the customer must wait, they are not given an estimated waiting time.	The next steps are unclear • There is some limited information available about the next steps in the process, but it is unclear and hard to find. • If the customer must wait, they are generally not given an estimated waiting time.	The next steps are sometimes unclear • Information is available that explains the next steps in the process, but it is unclear or hard to find. • If the customer must wait, they are given an estimated waiting time. However, the waiting time is communicated in non-specific terms (e.g. "We will get back to you soon").	The next steps are clear • The customer is given information that explains the next steps in the process and what they can do. However, some steps may be slightly unclear (e.g. due to passive language, missing details) • If the customer must wait, they are given an estimated waiting time. The waiting time is communicated in specific terms. This expectation met most of the time.	The next steps are very clear • The customer is given information that clearly explains the next steps in the process and what they can do. • If the customer must wait, they are given an estimated waiting time. The waiting time is communicated in specific terms (e.g. "You will hear back within X hours"), and this expectation is met almost all the time.
Frictions Do customers experience frictions at this step?	Significant frictions • Customers experience many	Major frictions • Customers experience some	Moderate frictions • Customers experience some	Minor frictions • Customers may experience	No frictions • Customers do not

	major frictions that make it difficult/stressful to complete the step and move through the process.	major frictions that make it difficult/stressful to complete the step and move through the process.	moderate frictions that make it difficult/stressful to complete the step and move through the process.	some minor frictions that make it difficult/stressful to complete the step and move through the process.	experience any frictions that make it difficult/stressful to complete the step and move through the process.
Necessity Is this step a necessary part of the process?	It is very unnecessary The step is very unnecessary and/or misleading part of the process and should be removed.	It is unnecessary The step is an unnecessary part of the process and should be removed.	It is sometimes necessary The step is sometimes necessary. It may be difficult to remove it from the process.	It is mostly necessary The step is mostly necessary and should not be removed from the process.	It is very necessary The step is a very necessary part of the process and should not be removed.

9 Non-customer actions



In this section

9.1 Government action

9.2 Third-party action or decision

Categories



1 Reading and understanding



2 Seeking and navigating



3 Preparing or providing information



4 Interacting



5 Help seeking



6 Waiting



7 Deciding



8 Miscellaneous



9 Non-customer actions

9.1 Government action

Captures any staff behaviours and decisions (i.e. behaviours that are not done by customers or third parties)

- Processing or reviewing an application, appeal or complaint
- Supporting or contacting a customer
- Doing an internal administrative action, or communicating with other staff

9.1.1 Frictions

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Frictions Do customers and/or staff experience frictions at this step?	Significant frictions • Customers and/or staff experience many major frictions at this step.	Major frictions • Customers and/or staff experience some major frictions at this step.	Moderate frictions • Customers and/or staff experience some moderate frictions at this step.	Minor frictions • Customers and/or staff may experience some minor frictions at this step.	No frictions • Customers and staff do not experience any frictions at this step.

9.2 Third-party action or decision

Captures any third-party behaviours and decisions (i.e. behaviours that are not done by customers or government staff)

- Inspecting a product or service on behalf of the customer
- Providing a service to the customer (required by a government process)

9.2.1 Frictions

Considerations	Very difficult	Difficult	Somewhat difficult	Somewhat easy	Easy
Frictions Do customers and/or the third party experience frictions at this step?	Significant frictions • Customers and/or the third party experience many major frictions at this step.	Major frictions • Customers and/or the third party experience some major frictions at this step.	Moderate frictions • Customers and/or the third party experience some moderate frictions at this step.	Minor frictions • Customers and/or the third party may experience some minor frictions at this step.	No frictions • Customers and the third party do not experience any frictions at this step.

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